

AURIC ARTISAN · USER DOCUMENTATION

Library

An overview of the Auric Artisan library and a map of its documentation.

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Library

An overview of the Auric Artisan library and a map of its documentation.

The Auric Artisan library is the reading and reference side of the site. It brings together six searchable colour libraries, the catalogue of every tool, a course of articles on colour science and accessibility, a user guide for each tool, the blog and the changelog.

The colour libraries are large, browsable collections of generated colour data: 8,192 measured colours, five million palettes, 8,192 gradients, 8,192 colour harmonies, 8,192 shade scales and five million foreground and background pairs scored for contrast. Each one lets you search, filter, inspect and copy or export values for use in your own work.

The rest of the library is for learning and finding your way: Collections lists every tool, Learn teaches the ideas behind them with interactive labs, Documentation explains each tool step by step, and the blog and changelog record what has been built and when.

Who it is for

- Designers and front-end developers who need ready-made, measured colour values.
- Accessibility specialists who need contrast-checked colour pairs.
- Students and colour enthusiasts learning colour science.
- Anyone who wants to find the right Auric Artisan tool, or learn how to use it.

Where to find it

Part	Address
Collections (all tools)	https://auricartisan.com/collections/
Color Library	https://auricartisan.com/library/color/
Palette Library	https://auricartisan.com/library/palette/
Gradient Library	https://auricartisan.com/library/gradient/
Harmony Library	https://auricartisan.com/library/harmony/
Shade Library	https://auricartisan.com/library/shades/
Accessibility Color Pair Library	https://auricartisan.com/library/accessibility/
Learn	https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/
Documentation	https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/
Blog	https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/
Changelog	https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/

The address <https://auricartisan.com/library/> on its own takes you to Collections.

Note: "Your library" — the palettes, gradients and other items you save from the tools — is a different thing. It lives in the Library Kit, a floating panel you can open from any page with **Ctrl + Shift + L**. See the [Library Kit docs](#).

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/collections/> to see every tool in one place.
2. Open a colour library, for example <https://auricartisan.com/library/palette/>, to browse ready-made colour data.
3. Use the library's search and filters to narrow the collection.
4. Open an item to inspect its values, then copy or export them.
5. To learn the ideas behind the values, open <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/> and pick an article.
6. To learn a tool, find its guide at <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/>.
7. To see what changed recently, read <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/>.

What you can do

- Browse and filter tens of thousands of colours, gradients, harmonies and shade scales, and millions of palettes and contrast pairs.
- Copy colour values and export palettes, gradients and scales in formats ready for code and design tools.
- Find, pin and open any of the site's 30 tools.
- Work through the Learn course, with interactive labs inside the articles.
- Read a user guide for a tool before or while you use it.
- Follow the blog and the changelog, including by RSS.

In this folder

Folder	What it covers
colour-libraries/	The six colour libraries: Color, Palette, Gradient, Harmony, Shade and Accessibility.
collections/	The catalogue of every tool: search, filters, pins, recommendations and the card menu.
learn/	The Learn library: the course index, reading articles, labs, "Continue your journey", and a catalogue of every article.
documentation/	The documentation library and how to find a tool's guide.
blog/	The blog and its posts.
changelog/	The changelog and a summary of each release.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > BLOG

Blog

What the Auric Artisan blog contains, where to find it, and how to read and follow it.

The Auric Artisan blog is where the site's author writes, in the page's words, "occasional posts about what is being built and why — roadmaps, product notes, and the odd essay on colour". It is small by design: there are three posts so far. Release-by-release detail lives in the changelog, and long-form colour science in Learn; the blog is for the reasoning and the plans in between.

The blog page shows the newest post large, with its opening paragraph and a **Read the post** link, and lists the earlier posts underneath with their dates, categories and one-line summaries.

Who it is for

- Anyone who wants to know where Auric Artisan is heading and why.
- Existing users who want a readable summary of what has changed, beyond the changelog's lists.

Where to find it

- The blog: <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/>
- From the site header: **Learn** menu > **Blog** ("Articles, ideas & studio news").
- RSS feed: <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/rss.xml>

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/>.
2. Read the opening of the newest post and select **Read the post**.
3. On the post, use the **Table of Contents** or open and close sections as you read.
4. Select ← **Back to Blog** to return, or **Print** to print the post.
5. Add the RSS feed to your news reader to hear about new posts.

What you can do

- Read every post, newest first.
- Follow new posts by RSS.
- Print a post.

In this folder

- [docs/](#)

- [Getting started](#) — the blog page and reading a post.
- [Posts](#) — a summary of every post.
- [FAQ](#).
- [others/](#)
 - [Related](#) — the changelog, Learn and documentation.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > BLOG

Blog: docs

Guides to the Auric Artisan blog and a summary of every post.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	The blog page, reading a post, printing and RSS.
posts.md	Every post with its date, category and a summary.
faq.md	Short answers.

Back to the [Blog overview](#).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > BLOG

Getting started

Read the Auric Artisan blog page and its posts, print a post, and follow new posts by RSS.

The blog page

Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/>.

- The heading **Blog** and the line "Occasional posts about what is being built and why — roadmaps, product notes, and the odd essay on colour", followed by a count such as **Three so far**.
- **The newest post**, shown large: its date (for example **27 July 2026**), its category, its title, its opening paragraph, an illustration and **Read the post**.
- **Earlier** — the other posts, newest first, each with date, category, title and a one-line summary.
- A footer that points to the [changelog](#) for release detail and [Learn](#) for longer colour-science writing, and an **RSS** link.

If the list of posts cannot be loaded, the page shows **The blog could not be loaded.** and a plain list of **All posts** still links to every post.

Reading a post

Each post has:

Part	What it does
Date, Author, Category	When it was written, by whom, and what kind of post it is.
Print	Prints the post.
← Back to Blog	Returns to the blog page.
Overview	A short summary of the post.

Part	What it does
Table of Contents	Links to each section.
Sections	The post itself. Each section heading can be selected to fold the section away or open it again.

Some older posts open with a dated update note, for example to say that much of a roadmap has since shipped.

Follow new posts

Add <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/rss.xml> to your news reader. New posts appear there automatically.

Result

You can read every post, keep it on paper, and hear about the next one.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > BLOG

All posts

A summary of every post on the Auric Artisan blog.

Newest first. Each entry gives the date, the category shown on the post, the link and a summary of what the post says.

What Shipped Since April

- **Date:** 27 July 2026
- **Category:** Product
- **Link:** <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/articles/2026-07-27-what-shipped-since-april>

An honest account of what came out of the April roadmap by late July 2026, with the reasoning, and a list of what was not yet done:

- **One browser extension instead of four.** The colour, accessibility, developer-tools and suite extensions were merged into one product, which gained a side panel, pickers that work on any page, a custom right-click menu and a searchable settings view. Its accessibility checks grew from 20 to 97.
- **The Analyzer's accessibility checks were rebuilt** on a 112-rule engine covering ARIA 1.2, accessible names and APCA contrast, reporting an accessibility tree, a screen-reader transcript, colour-vision simulation and a VPAT export. The rules load only when you open the tab.
- **Payments went live** for one-time purchases, with prices and what you receive both decided by the site rather than the browser. First-party, consent-based analytics arrived at the same time.
- **The VS Code extension reached 0.13.2**, joining the plugins for Figma, Sketch, Penpot, Raycast and Alfred — all free.

- **Not yet done** (as of the post): token top-ups were not on sale; accounts were single-user; cloud sync covered account settings but not saved palettes and projects; there was no single sign-on, white-label embedding or uptime guarantee.

Auric Artisan Roadmap — Next Few Months

- **Date:** 21 April 2026
- **Category:** Roadmap
- **Link:** <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/articles/2026-04-21-auric-artisan-roadmap>

A phased plan for the following months, summarised as **Organize** → **Explain** → **Simplify** → **Optimize** → **Expand**: a clearer start menu with essentials first and advanced tools hidden; a Status Kit showing each tool's stability; a casual versus advanced mode with plain-language tooltips; faster, non-freezing heavy tools; and more customisation, better split-screen work and documentation. It closes with a month-by-month plan for May, June and July 2026. The post now opens with an update noting that much of the roadmap has shipped, with a link to the changelog.

Welcome to the Auric Artisan Blog

- **Date:** 21 April 2026
- **Category:** Blog
- **Link:** <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/articles/2026-04-21-welcome-to-auric-artisan-blog>

Chirag Bansal introduces the blog as a place to share the process behind Auric Artisan, not just finished results. It promises deep dives into colour theory and workflows, behind-the-scenes posts, interactive demos and code, and lessons learned, and invites questions and topic ideas by email or social media, with RSS for new posts.

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [BLOG](#)

Blog FAQ

Short answers about the Auric Artisan blog.

How often are posts published?

Occasionally. The page describes them as "occasional posts". There were three at the time of writing.

What is the difference between the blog, the changelog and Learn?

The blog explains plans and reasoning. The [changelog](#) records what changed in each release. [Learn](#) holds the long-form colour-science course.

Can I comment?

Posts do not have comments. The welcome post invites questions and topic ideas by email or social media; see [Company and legal](#) for contact details.

Is there a feed?

Yes: <https://auricartisan.com/library/blog/rss.xml>.

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [BLOG](#)

Blog: other material

Supporting material for the blog.

File	What it covers
Related	Where to find release detail, the Learn course and tool guides, and what the blog pages store.

Back to the [Blog overview](#).

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [BLOG](#)

Related

Pages related to the blog, and a note on privacy.

- [Changelog](#) — the versioned record of each release.
- [Learn](#) — the long-form colour-science course.
- [Documentation](#) — user guides for every tool.
- [Browser extension](#) and [VS Code extensions](#) — products the posts discuss.

Privacy

The blog page downloads the list of posts, and the newest post's opening paragraph, from auricartisan.com. It stores nothing about what you read. Analytics on the site follow your consent choices; see [Company and legal](#).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > CHANGELOG

Changelog

What the Auric Artisan changelog contains, how to search it, and where to find a summary of each release.

The changelog is the versioned record of Auric Artisan's releases: "Every release, what was in it, and what it touched." It lists eleven entries, from v0.9.0 on 31 December 2025 to v0.9.11 on 12 August 2026, as a timeline, newest first. Each entry opens in place to show what changed and which parts of the platform it touched, with a link to the full release note.

Its search reads the changes themselves, not just the headings, so you can ask it questions such as "when did overage arrive?" and it will find the release and highlight the words where they appear.

Who it is for

- Users who want to know what is new, or when something changed.
- Teams who need to check when a feature, plan change or fix arrived.

Where to find it

- The changelog: <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/>
- From the site header: **Learn** menu > **Changelog** ("Releases & improvements").
- RSS feed: <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/rss.xml>
- A single release: add its version after **#**, for example <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/#0.9.10>

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/>. The newest release is already open.
2. Type a word into the search box, for example **recorder**. Matching releases stay, with the matches marked.
3. Select **Releases** or **Patches** to show only that kind of entry.
4. Select a release's header to open or close it.
5. Under **Touched**, select a tag to see every release that touched the same part.
6. Select **Read the full release note** for the complete write-up.

What you can do

- Read every release, newest first, with its version, type and date.
- Search every change and see matches highlighted.
- Filter by type and by the part of the platform touched.
- Open and close releases one by one, or all at once.

- [Link straight to a release by its version.](#)
 - [Follow new releases by RSS.](#)
-

In this folder

- [docs/](#)
 - [Getting started](#) — using the changelog page.
 - [Releases](#) — a user-facing summary of each release.
 - [FAQ.](#)
- [others/](#)
 - [Related.](#)

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [CHANGELOG](#)

Changelog: docs

Guides to the changelog page and a summary of every release.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	The changelog page: search, type filters, Touched tags, expanding releases, links and RSS.
releases.md	A user-facing summary of each of the eleven releases, newest first.
faq.md	Short answers.

Back to the [Changelog overview](#).

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Getting started

Use the changelog page to find a release, search every change, filter by type and by what was touched, and link to a release.

The page

Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/>.

- **Changelog**, with the line "Every release, what was in it, and what it touched. The search reads the changes themselves, not just the headings — so 'when did overage arrive?' is a question this page can answer."
- A facts line: **11 releases · v0.9.0 → v0.9.11 · 12 August 2026 — the latest**.
- A search box, **Search every change — overage, recorder, dark mode...**, with a clear button.
- Type buttons: **All, Releases, Patches**.
- A count, for example **11 of 11 releases**, and **Expand all**.
- The timeline: one entry per release, newest first. The newest is open when the page loads.

A release entry

The header shows the version (for example **v0.9.10**), a type badge (**release**, **patch**, or another label such as **Changelog**) and the date. Under it, a summary sentence — shortened while the entry is closed, in full when it is open.

Select the header to open or close the entry. Open, it shows:

Part	What it contains
What changed	The list of changes.

Part	What it contains
Notes	Extra notes, where the release has them.
Touched	Tags for the parts of the platform the release touched, such as analyzer or pricing .
Read the full release note	A link to the release's own page.

Search

1. Type a word or phrase. The timeline keeps only releases whose title, summary, changes or notes contain it.
2. Matches are marked where they appear.
3. Select the × in the box to clear the search.

Filter by type

- **Releases** — feature releases.
- **Patches** — fix and clean-up releases.
- **All** — everything.

Filter by what was touched

In an open release, select a tag under **Touched**. The timeline shows only releases that touched the same part, and a button appears beside the count, **touching** and the tag's name. Select that button, or the tag again, to stop filtering.

Clear filters appears whenever a search, type or tag is active; it resets all three. If nothing matches, the page says **No release matches that.** with its own **Clear filters** button.

Open everything

Expand all opens every release currently shown; it then reads **Collapse all**.

Link to a release

Add **#** and the version to the page's address, for example <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/#0.9.11> (a leading **v** also works). The page opens that release and scrolls to it.

Follow releases

Add <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/rss.xml> to your news reader.

If the page cannot load the timeline, it says **The changelog could not be loaded.** with a link, **Read it as a feed instead**, and a plain list of **All releases** still links to every release note.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > CHANGELOG

Release summaries

A user-facing summary of every release in the Auric Artisan changelog, newest first.

A plain-language summary of each release listed in the changelog, newest first. Each heading gives the version and date as published. For the full notes, open the release on <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/>.

vo.9.11 — 12 August 2026 (release)

The REST API became a metered product, and the site gained a recorder.

- **API credits.** API calls are now measured in credits: one credit is one standard request, and heavier endpoints cost more. Specialist includes 1,000,000 credits a month and Industrial Pro 10,000,000, refreshing each billing month. Subscriptions to Industrial Pro started before 12 August 2026 keep their previous allowance.
- **Overage, only if you want it.** Extra usage is opt-in and prepaid at \$1.00 (₹85) per 100,000 credits, so you are never invoiced after the fact. You can set a monthly spend cap, and a hard ceiling of ten times your included allowance always applies.
- **Top-ups.** You can buy credit packs from **Dashboard** → **API keys** → **Add credits**. Purchased credits do not expire at the end of the period.
- **API console** on the dashboard's API Keys tab: burn-down, projection, usage chart, spend by endpoint, credit balance, spend cap, overage switch and a live call feed.
- **New API areas:** colour science (63 colour spaces, colour difference, colour temperature), design tokens (ten export targets), a catalogue, and live usage.
- **API access** is now for Specialist and above; other plans get a clear upgrade message.
- **Recorder.** A site-wide screen, tab, region and canvas recorder, exporting video, animated GIF, PNG frames and posters, with trimming.
- **Tokens and credits are separate:** tokens pay for server-side tool work, credits pay for API calls, and neither pays for the other.

vo.9.10 — 27 July 2026 (release)

- **One browser extension.** The browser extensions were combined into one redesigned product, Auric Studio, with a responsive sidebar, a Side Panel, pickers that upgrade colour inputs on any page, a custom right-click menu and a settings search.
- **Analyzer accessibility.** The Analyzer's A11y+ tab was rebuilt on a 112-rule accessibility engine, with an accessibility tree, a screen-reader transcript, colour vision simulation and a VPAT export. The rules load only when you open the tab.

- **Analytics** that are first-party, consent-based and free of third-party trackers.
 - **Payments.** One-time checkout went live.
 - **VS Code extension 0.13.2**, with colour and accessibility updates.
-

vo.9.9 — 5 June 2026 (release)

- **New libraries:** Font, Palette, Accessibility, Shade, Harmony, Color, Gradient and Icon libraries.
 - **Design System Generator** added.
 - **Documentation, Learn and Blog** content added.
 - **Beta** replaced the "In Development" label across the site.
 - **Installable app (PWA), user settings, guide content**, the **UX Kit**, security improvements and better control of basic and advanced tools.
 - Faster, more consistent interface: colour picker and rendering improvements, keyboard shortcut improvements, and fixes to navigation, lag and library behaviour.
-

vo.9.8 — 2 May 2026 (patch)

- Clearer home page summary and a new logo.
 - Vision Simulation and the Color Science Model moved into the unified panel-based simulation system.
 - News, Libraries and Announcement pages removed to simplify the site.
 - Fixes to the welcome screen, search, and interface consistency; improved Analyzer.
 - Legal pages restructured.
 - The Advanced Kit was improved and control of tool complexity added.
-

vo.9.75 — 19 April 2026 (changelog entry)

- Split-screen fixes: address, refresh, resizing, embedded pages and closing windows.
 - Interface fixes across colour lists, colour overview, conversion tools, contrast panels and the CIE graph.
 - More consistent search results.
 - Ishihara plate generator and the Material Lighting lab added.
 - Accessibility fixes: ARIA, keyboard focus and screen-reader announcements.
 - Fixes to the Menu Kit and Status Kit, illuminant handling in light and dark modes, the Color Formulation Lab, the converter and the Palette Visualizer lab.
-

vo.9.7 — 15 April 2026 (release)

"Deployment — Site marked 'In Development'". The website went live marked as in development, with reliability fixes to delivery, the server and the Analyzer (which now handles malformed pages more gracefully). The ASCII Art Generator and the Ishihara Plate Generator were promoted to beta.

vo.9.6 — 13 April 2026 (release)

"Vision Simulation & Color Model Lab Advancement". More accurate protanopia, deuteranopia and tritanopia simulations; a comparison view for RGB, LAB, OKLab and experimental colour models; side-by-side analysis and sample export in the lab; simulations up to 35% faster on large scenes.

vo.9.6 — 8 April 2026 (release)

"System Integration & Validation". The engine, tools, perception systems and lab were connected into one validated workflow, for fewer failures between parts of the platform.

vo.9.5 — 24 March 2026 (release)

"Spectral & Experimental Layer". Spectral approximation for higher-fidelity colour, experimental interfaces for trying new colour models, and documentation with examples for spectral experiments. Spectral features were marked experimental.

vo.9.4 — 20 February 2026 (patch)

"Tool Accuracy Refinement". Smoother gradients using LAB and OKLab interpolation, palette generation that clashes less and is more accessible, and fixes to rounding and edge cases in colour conversion.

vo.9.0 — 31 December 2025 (release)

"Auric Artisan Pre-Release Stabilization". The platform reached a near-complete state with its engine, tools, rendering and research modules unified, and was tuned for performance and memory ahead of public release.

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Changelog FAQ

Short answers about the Auric Artisan changelog.

Why are there two vo.9.6 entries?

Two entries share version 0.9.6: "System Integration & Validation" (8 April 2026) and "Vision Simulation & Color Model Lab Advancement" (13 April 2026). A link to [#0.9.6](#) opens the newer one.

What is the difference between a release and a patch?

Releases add features; patches fix and tidy. One entry, v0.9.75, is labelled **Changelog** rather than either.

Where do I report a problem with a release?

Release notes ask for steps to reproduce, your browser and operating system, the page or tool affected, and screenshots — and, for API problems, the `x-request-id` header from the response. See [Help](#) for how to get in touch.

Is every change listed?

The changelog lists the notable changes in each release. Smaller changes between releases, and improvements to individual tools, may appear only on the tool's own pages and guides.

Can I follow it?

Yes: <https://auricartisan.com/library/changelog/rss.xml>.

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [CHANGELOG](#)

Changelog: other material

Supporting material for the changelog.

File	What it covers
Related	The blog, account and API documentation, and a note on privacy.

Back to the [Changelog overview](#).

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [CHANGELOG](#)

Related

Pages related to the changelog, and a note on privacy.

- [Blog](#) — the reasoning behind releases, such as "What Shipped Since April".
- [Account and billing](#) — plans, tokens and API credits described in v0.9.11.
- [Public API](#) — the REST API.
- [Browser extension](#) — Auric Studio, consolidated in v0.9.10.
- [Documentation](#) — guides for each tool.

Privacy

The changelog page downloads the list of releases from auricartisan.com and filters it in your browser. It stores nothing about what you search. Analytics follow your consent choices; see [Company and legal](#).

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Collections

What the Collections page is, who it is for, and how to find, pin and open any Auric Artisan tool from it.

Collections is the catalogue of Auric Artisan's tools. It lists every tool, engine and generator on the site — from the URL Analyzer and Vision Simulation to the Font Library, LUT Lab and the Portfolio Builder — as a grid of cards you can search, filter, sort and pin. Each card says what the tool does in one sentence and opens the tool with one click.

The page learns a little from how you use it. Tools you pin stay easy to reach, tools you open often can rise to the top of the **Most used** order, and the **Recommended** order leans on both. All of this is remembered only in the browser you are using; nothing about your pins or opens is sent to an account.

Every tool in the collection is free to use on every plan. The lower part of the page shows the plans, which add conveniences such as cloud sync and watermark-free exports rather than unlocking tools.

Who it is for

- Anyone new to Auric Artisan who wants to see everything the site offers.
- Regular users who want a fast way back to the tools they use most.
- Designers, developers, accessibility specialists and colour-science students who want to browse by category (Accessibility, Colorimetry, Gamut & Rendering, Perception, Spectral and more) or by topic.

Where to find it

- Address: <https://auricartisan.com/collections/>
- From any page: open the **Tools** menu in the site header and choose **All Tools**.
- It works in any modern browser. You do not need an account.

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/collections/>.
2. Look at **Start here** for a short list of three featured tools, or scroll to **All tools**.
3. Type a word such as **gradient** or **contrast** into the **Search tools...** box above the grid.
4. Tick a box under **Category** or **Topics** in the **Filter and sort** panel to narrow the list.
5. Select the pin button on a card to pin that tool; it now appears under the **Pinned** category.
6. Right-click a card to open the card menu: switch **View**, **Density**, **Columns** or **Sort**, or copy the tool's link.
7. Select a card to open the tool.

Note: By default the site shows its Basic tool set, so Collections starts with the beginner-friendly tools. To see all 30 tools, choose **Everything** in the Advanced Kit. See [Show basic or advanced tools](#).

What you can do

- Browse all 30 tools as cards, in a grid or a list.
- Search by name, description, category, address or topic.
- Filter by one or more categories and topics at once.
- Sort by title, category, recommendation, how often you use a tool, pinned first, or most detailed description.
- Pin tools so they stay together under **Pinned** and lead the **Start here** shortlist.
- Right-click a card for quick actions and layout settings (view, density, columns, sort, theme, reading mode).
- Choose whether the catalogue shows basic tools, advanced tools, everything, or your own custom set.
- Compare the plans and switch prices between monthly and annual billing, and between US dollars and Indian rupees.

In this folder

docs/

- [docs/README.md](#) — contents of the docs folder.
- [Getting started](#) — a tour of the page and your first search.
- [Browse, search and filter](#) — find a tool quickly.
- [Pin tools and use recommendations](#) — Pinned, Most used and Recommended, and how to reset them.
- [Use the card menu](#) — the right-click menu on every card.
- [Show basic or advanced tools](#) — why some tools are hidden and how to show them.
- [Reference](#) — every control, sort option and the full tool list.
- [Troubleshooting](#) — symptoms, causes and fixes.
- [FAQ](#) — short answers to common questions.

others/

- [others/README.md](#) — contents of the others folder.
- [Glossary](#) — terms used on this page.
- [Shortcuts](#) — keyboard and mouse actions.
- [Limits and accuracy](#) — what the orders and counts mean, and what they do not.
- [Related](#) — related pages and guides.
- [Privacy](#) — what is stored in your browser and what is not.

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Collections docs

The task guides and reference pages for the Collections tool catalogue.

This folder holds the working guides for the Collections page at <https://auricartisan.com/collections/>. Start with the getting-started tour, then use the task guides for specific jobs. The reference lists every control and every tool in the catalogue.

File	What it covers
Getting started	A tour of the page from top to bottom and a first search.
Browse, search and filter	Searching, category and topic filters, sorting, grid or list, loading more.
Pin tools and use recommendations	Pinning, the Pinned category, Most used, Recommended, and resetting them.
Use the card menu	The right-click menu on a card: card actions, view, density, columns, sort, system toggles.
Show basic or advanced tools	Why the catalogue may show fewer than 30 tools, and how to change that.
Reference	Every control, sort order, filter and the full list of 30 tools.
Troubleshooting	Missing tools, lost pins, the menu not opening and other problems.
FAQ	Short answers to common questions.

Back to the [Collections overview](#).

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Getting started with Collections

Tour the Collections page and find your first tool.

Collections is the page that lists every Auric Artisan tool. This guide walks through the page from top to bottom and ends with you opening a tool you found by search.

Open the page

Go to <https://auricartisan.com/collections/>, or open the **Tools** menu in the site header and choose **All Tools**. You do not need to sign in.

The screen, top to bottom

Hero

The page opens with the heading "All Auric Artisan tools, engines & generators in one place." Under it, three counters show:

- **Tools** — how many tools the catalogue is currently showing.
- **Categories** — how many different categories those tools belong to.
- **Topics** — how many different topic tags those tools carry.

The counters follow your tool-visibility setting (see [Show basic or advanced tools](#)), so they can be lower than the full catalogue of 30 tools.

Beside the heading, three quick links lead to **Tools** (this page), **Learn** (the Learn library) and **Pricing** (the plans page).

Start here

Start here is a shortlist of three featured tools shown as large cards in a slider. Each card shows the tool's name, a one-line description and its category.

- The slider moves on by itself, one card at a time. A thin bar along the bottom fills up to show when the next card is due.
- It pauses while your pointer is over it or while it has keyboard focus.
- Use the previous and next arrow buttons, the dots under the slider, or the **Left** and **Right** arrow keys (with the slider focused) to move between cards. A counter such as **01 / 03** shows where you are.
- If your system asks for reduced motion, the slider does not move by itself.

Tools you pin come first in this shortlist.

All tools

All tools is the full catalogue. On a wide screen it has two columns:

- On the left, the **Filter and sort** panel with three sections you can open and close: **Sort by**, **Category** and **Topics**. On wide screens this panel stays in view as you scroll.
- On the right, the results: a **Search tools...** box, a **Grid / List** switch, and the cards.

On a narrower screen (about 900 pixels wide or less), the filter panel sits above the results instead of beside them.

A line above the grid reports the count, for example **14 tools**, or **3 of 14 tools** when a search or filter is active.

A card

Each card shows:

- the tool's artwork;
- its category above the name, for example **Colorimetry**;
- the tool's name and a one-sentence description;
- the line **Free to use** at the foot, because every tool is free on every plan;
- a pin button in the corner.

Hover over a card to see a tooltip with more detail: the category, the **Mode** (Basic, Advanced or Both), the tool's address on the site, and its topic tags.

Below the catalogue

Further down the page:

- **Featured Highlights** — two short notes on key capabilities (Accessibility & Analysis, Creative Generation).
- The plans section, headed "Every tool here is free. Upgrade for superpowers." It shows the four plans with a **Monthly / Annual** switch and a **USD \$ / INR ₹** currency switch. See [Account and billing](#) for what each plan includes.
- A closing banner, **Explore All Collections**, with links back to this page and to the full pricing page.

Your first search

1. Scroll to **All tools**.
2. Select the **Search tools...** box and type **palette**.
3. Watch the grid update as you type. The count above the grid changes to show how many tools match.
4. Under **Category** in the **Filter and sort** panel, tick **Generators**.
5. The grid now shows only generator tools whose details mention "palette".
6. Select a card, for example **Basic Tools**, to open it.

You now have the tool open. Use your browser's back button to return to Collections. Your pins and your grid or list choice are remembered in this browser for next time.

Next steps

- Learn every way to narrow the list in [Browse, search and filter](#).
- Keep favourite tools at hand with [Pin tools and use recommendations](#).
- Try the right-click menu in [Use the card menu](#).

Browse, search and filter

Narrow the tool catalogue with search, category and topic filters, sort orders and layout options.

The **All tools** section of <https://auricartisan.com/collections/> gives you four ways to narrow the catalogue: a search box, category filters, topic filters and a sort order. They work together, and the grid updates as soon as you change any of them.

Search

The search box sits above the grid and reads **Search tools....**

1. Select the box and start typing.
2. The grid updates on every keystroke; you do not need to press **Enter**.
3. To clear the search, delete the text.

How matching works:

- Matching ignores upper and lower case.
- Each word you type must appear somewhere in the tool's details. **colour vision** finds tools that mention both "colour" and "vision", in any order.
- A word can match part of a longer word. **grad** finds "gradient" and "gradients".
- The details searched are the tool's name, its one-line description, its category, its address on the site, and its topic tags.

Tip: The catalogue uses both spellings in places — some descriptions say "colour" and some tags say "color". If a search finds less than you expect, try the other spelling. Search does not treat them as the same word.

Filter by category

Open **Category** in the **Filter and sort** panel. Each category is a tick box with the number of tools in it. The categories are:

Accessibility, Color Science, Colorimetry, Design Systems, Gamut & Rendering, Generators, Iconography, Perception, Publish, Spectral, Typography and Utilities.

A **Pinned** box appears at the top of the list as soon as you pin at least one tool (see [Pin tools and use recommendations](#)).

Rules:

- With no boxes ticked, every category is shown.
- Tick one box to show only that category.

- Tick several boxes to show tools in any of them. Ticking **Generators** and **Utilities** shows both groups together.
- Untick a box to remove it again.

Categories list only the tools your tool-visibility setting allows. If a category you expect is missing, see [Show basic or advanced tools](#).

Filter by topic

Open **Topics** (it starts closed). Topics are the short tags each tool carries, such as **palette**, **accessibility** or **hdr**. The list shows up to 14 topics — the most common ones among the tools currently in view — each with a count.

- With no topics ticked, all topics are allowed.
- Tick one or more topics to show tools that carry any of them.

How the filters combine

A tool is shown only when it passes all three checks at once:

1. its category is one of the ticked categories (or none are ticked), **and**
2. it carries one of the ticked topics (or none are ticked), **and**
3. every word in the search box appears in its details.

The line above the grid shows the result, for example **4 of 14 tools**. When nothing matches, the grid is replaced by **No matching tools** with the advice to try a shorter search, clear the topic chip, or switch the category back to all tools.

Sort the grid

Open **Sort by** and choose an order from the **Sort** list:

Option	Order
Title A to Z	Alphabetical by tool name.
Category A to Z	Alphabetical by category.
Newest first	Newest first by date. Tools carry no dates, so this keeps the catalogue's own order.
Oldest first	Oldest first by date. Tools carry no dates, so this also keeps the catalogue's own order.
Recommended	Tools most likely to be useful to you first (see Pin tools and use recommendations).
Most used	Tools you open most often, and most recently, first.
Pinned first	Your pinned tools first, then the rest.

Option	Order
Most metadata	Tools with the fullest descriptions and most tags first.

You can also change the order from the right-click card menu (see [Use the card menu](#)).

Grid or list

The **Grid** and **List** buttons beside the search box switch the layout:

- **Grid** shows cards side by side with large artwork.
- **List** shows one tool per row with a smaller picture beside the text, which is easier to scan.

Your choice is remembered in this browser.

Loading more tools

The grid shows 12 tools at first. As you scroll to the bottom of the grid, the next 12 load automatically. A line under the grid says where you are, for example **Showing 12 of 14 tools**, and then **All 14 tools shown**. A thin bar fills up as more of the list comes into view.

If automatic loading is not available in your browser, a **Load 2 more tools** button (the number changes) appears instead; select it to show the next batch.

Search and sort while scrolled down

Once you scroll past the search box and filters, a round search button appears on the right-hand side of the screen, towards the bottom. Select it (its label is "Search and sort tools") to open a small panel with:

- a **Search tools...** box;
- a **Sort** list;
- **Category** and **Topics** sections with the same tick boxes as the main panel.

Everything in this panel stays in step with the main controls. Press **Escape**, or select anywhere outside the panel, to close it. The button hides again when you scroll back up to the main controls.

Result

You see only the tools that match your search, ticked categories and ticked topics, in the order you chose, laid out as a grid or a list.

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Use the card menu

Right-click any tool card to pin, open or copy it, and to change the grid's view, density, columns and sort order.

Every card in the **All tools** grid has its own menu. It gathers the actions for that one tool together with the settings for the whole grid, so you can change the layout without scrolling back to the controls.

Open the menu

1. Scroll to **All tools** on <https://auricartisan.com/collections/>.
2. Right-click any card. On a keyboard, move focus to a card and press the context-menu key or **Shift** + **F10**.
3. The menu opens at the pointer. If there is not enough room, it moves so it stays on screen.

The menu replaces the site's usual right-click menu while you are over a card. Right-click anywhere else on the page to get the site's usual menu (see [Site features](#)).

The top line of the menu shows the card's title. A small pin mark appears before the title when that tool is pinned.

Close the menu

Any of these closes it:

- select anywhere outside the menu;
- press **Escape**;
- scroll the page;
- resize the window;
- choose **Open**, **New tab** or **Copy link**.

The layout settings (**View**, **Density**, **Columns**, **Sort**) keep the menu open so you can try several in a row.

Card

Four buttons act on the card you right-clicked:

Button	What it does
Pin / Unpin	Pins or unpins the tool, exactly like the pin button on the card. The button is highlighted while the tool is pinned.
Open	Opens the tool in the current tab.
New tab	Opens the tool in a new browser tab.
Copy link	Copies the tool's full web address to your clipboard.

View

- **Grid** — cards side by side with large artwork.
- **List** — one tool per row, easier to scan.

This is the same setting as the **Grid** and **List** buttons above the results, and it is remembered in this browser.

Density

- **Cozy** — the normal spacing between cards.
- **Compact** — tighter spacing, so more cards fit on screen.

Remembered in this browser for the Collections page.

Columns

- **Auto** — the grid decides how many columns fit your screen width.
- **2, 3 or 4** — forces that many columns at every screen width.

Columns apply to the grid view; the list view always shows one tool per row. Your choice is remembered in this browser for the Collections page.

Tip: On a phone, **Auto** is usually the right choice. Forcing **4** columns on a narrow screen makes each card very small.

Sort

A row of buttons repeats the page's sort orders. Each shows the first word of the order's name, with a second word added where two would look the same. Hover a button to see its full name.

Button	Sort order
Title	Title A to Z
Category	Category A to Z
Newest	Newest first
Oldest	Oldest first
Recommended	Recommended
Most	Most used
Pinned	Pinned first

Button	Sort order
Most metadata	Most metadata

The highlighted button is the current order. Choosing one here also changes the **Sort** list in the **Filter and sort** panel. See [Browse, search and filter](#) for what each order does.

System

Two switches for the whole site:

- **Theme** — switches between the site's dark and light themes. It is highlighted while the dark theme is on.
- **Reading** — turns reading mode on or off. It is highlighted while reading mode is on.

Footer

- **Reset** — returns the grid to **Grid** view, **Cozy** density, **Auto** columns and the first sort order, **Title A to Z**. It does not unpin tools or clear your usage history.
- **All settings** → — opens the site's settings panel.

Result

From one right-click you can act on a single tool and reshape the whole grid, and the grid keeps your view, density and column choices the next time you visit in this browser.

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Pin tools and use recommendations

Pin the tools you rely on, see your most used tools first, understand the Recommended order, and reset all of it.

Collections can put the tools that matter to you first. It uses two signals, both kept only in the browser you are using:

- **Pins** — tools you have marked yourself.
- **Opens** — how often, and how recently, you have opened each tool from the Collections page.

From these the page builds three groupings: **Pinned**, **Most used** and **Recommended**.

Pin a tool

1. Find the tool's card in **All tools**.
2. Select the pin button in the card's corner. Its label reads "Pin" followed by the tool's name.

3. The button fills in to show the tool is pinned, and the card is marked as pinned.

You can also right-click the card and choose **Pin** in the card menu (see [Use the card menu](#)).

To unpin, select the same button again (its label now reads "Unpin" and the tool's name), or choose **Unpin** in the card menu.

Where pinned tools appear

- **The Pinned category.** A **Pinned** tick box appears at the top of **Category** in the **Filter and sort** panel, with a count. Tick it to see only your pinned tools. When you unpin your last tool, the box disappears and the filter switches itself off.
- **Pinned first.** Choose **Pinned first** in the sort list to bring pinned tools to the top while keeping everything else below them.
- **Start here.** The three-card **Start here** shortlist shows pinned tools before any others. Pin three tools and the shortlist becomes your own.
- **Recommended.** Pinned tools get a strong boost in the **Recommended** order.

Most used

Each time you open a tool by selecting its card on the Collections page — in **All tools** or in **Start here** — the page counts that open. Selecting the pin button does not count as an open.

Choose **Most used** in the sort list to order tools by how much you use them. The order weighs both how many times you opened a tool and how recently:

Last opened	Weight given to each open
Within the last day	Highest
Within 3 days	High
Within a week	Medium
Within 30 days	Low
Longer ago	Lowest

So a tool you opened five times this week can rank above one you opened ten times last year. Tools you have never opened from this page follow, in an order based on your pins, core subjects and description depth.

Note: Only opens from the Collections page count. Visiting a tool from the header menu, a bookmark or a search result does not change **Most used** here.

Recommended

Choose **Recommended** in the sort list for the order the page thinks is most useful to you. It adds up several things:

- **Your pins.** A pinned tool gets a large boost.
- **Your opens.** Tools you open often and recently rise, up to a limit, so one busy afternoon does not bury everything else.
- **Core subjects.** Tools whose details mention central subjects on the site — among them accessibility, WCAG, APCA, contrast, gamut, HDR, ICC, tokens, performance and workflow — rise a little for each one.
- **Description depth.** Tools with fuller descriptions and more tags rise slightly.

With no pins and no history, **Recommended** relies on the last two signals only, so a first-time visitor sees a stable order. Your search words and ticked filters decide which tools are shown, not their order.

Reset your pins and usage

There is no single reset button for pins and usage on the page. You can clear them in these ways:

- **Clear pins one by one.** Tick **Pinned** under **Category** to list your pinned tools, then select each pin button to unpin it.
- **Clear everything the site remembers.** Clear this site's data (sometimes called "cookies and site data") in your browser's settings. This removes your pins, your usage history and your layout choices on this page, along with other preferences the site keeps in your browser.

The **Reset** button in the card menu does not remove pins or usage. It only returns the layout to its defaults: grid view, cozy density, automatic columns and the first sort order (**Title A to Z**).

Important: The site's own settings panel also has a **Reset all** button, but that resets site preferences such as theme and text size. It does not clear your Collections pins or usage.

Result

Your pinned tools are grouped under **Pinned**, lead the **Start here** shortlist and top the **Pinned first** order, and the **Most used** and **Recommended** orders reflect how you actually use the site in this browser.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLLECTIONS

Show basic or advanced tools

Understand why Collections may show fewer than 30 tools, and switch between Basic, Advanced, Everything and a custom set.

Auric Artisan has 30 tools. Some are everyday tools, such as the Image Picker and the Font Library; others are scientific tools, such as Illuminants, Tone Mapping and the Psychophysics Engine. The site lets you choose which of these you see, and Collections follows that choice.

Why you might see fewer than 30 tools

Every tool in the catalogue is labelled with a mode:

- **Basic** — beginner-friendly, everyday tools.
- **Advanced** — scientific, diagnostic and power-user tools.
- **Both** — tools that belong to every set. The URL Analyzer and the Portfolio Builder are the two tools marked this way.

The site-wide tool visibility setting decides which modes are shown. Until you choose otherwise, the site uses **Basic**, so a first visit to Collections shows the basic tools and the two tools marked **Both**. The hero counters, the category counts and the result count all reflect the tools in view, not the full catalogue.

You can see any card's mode in its tooltip: hover over the card and read the **Mode** line.

Tools shown in each setting

Setting	What Collections shows	Number of tools
Basic (the default)	Basic tools plus the two tools marked Both.	14
Advanced	Advanced tools plus the two tools marked Both.	18
Everything	Every tool.	30
Custom	Only the tools you have switched on, one by one.	Your choice

The full list, with each tool's mode, is in the [Reference](#), under **Tool catalogue**.

Change the setting

The setting lives in the **Advanced Kit**, one of the site's floating kits. Its button carries the tooltip "Choose Basic, Advanced, or Everything tool visibility."

1. Open the **Advanced Kit**.
2. Under the tool-visibility choices, select **Basic**, **Advanced**, **Everything** or **Custom**.
3. For **Custom**, use **Choose your tools** to tick the tools you want. You can type in **Filter tools...** to find a tool, or use **Enable all**, **Disable all** and **Reset**.
4. Close the kit.

Collections updates straight away: the grid, the counters, the category list and the **Start here** shortlist all redraw with the tools the new setting allows. You do not need to reload the page.

The setting applies across the site, not only on Collections, and is remembered in this browser. For everything else the Advanced Kit can do, see the [Advanced Kit docs](#).

Result

Collections shows exactly the set of tools you asked for: the basic set, the advanced set, all 30 tools, or your own custom selection.

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Collections reference

Every control, filter, sort order and menu item on the Collections page, and the full catalogue of 30 tools.

This page lists every control on <https://auricartisan.com/collections/> and every tool in the catalogue. For step-by-step help, see the task guides in this folder.

Page sections

Section	What it contains
Hero	The page heading, three counters (Tools , Categories , Topics) and three quick links (Tools , Learn , Pricing).
Start here	A slider of three featured tools, with previous and next buttons, dots and a slide counter.
All tools	The full catalogue with the Filter and sort panel, search box, view switch and cards.
Featured Highlights	Two short notes: Accessibility & Analysis and Creative Generation .
Plans	"Every tool here is free. Upgrade for superpowers." The four plans with billing and currency switches.
Explore All Collections	Closing banner with Browse All Collections and See full pricing & FAQ .

Hero counters

Counter	What it counts
Tools	Tools the catalogue is showing under your tool-visibility setting.
Categories	Different categories among those tools.
Topics	Different topic tags among those tools.

Start here slider

Control	What it does	Values or range	Default
Previous button	Shows the previous featured tool.	—	—
Next button	Shows the next featured tool.	—	—
Dots	Jump to a featured tool. Each dot's label is "Show" and the tool's name.	One dot per tool	—
Slide counter	Shows the current slide and the total.	01 / 03 style	—
Progress bar	Fills while the current slide is shown, then the slider moves on.	—	7 seconds per slide
Left / Right arrow keys	Previous or next slide, while the slider has focus.	—	—
Autoplay pause	Autoplay pauses while the pointer is over the slider or it has focus.	—	—
Reduced motion	With your system's reduced-motion setting on, the slider does not move by itself.	—	—

The shortlist holds three tools. Pinned tools come first; the rest follow in catalogue order.

Filter and sort panel

The panel is headed **Filter and sort** and has three sections you can open or close.

Section	Control	What it does	Default
Sort by	Sort list	Chooses the order of the grid. See the sort table below.	—
Category	Tick boxes with counts	Shows only tools in the ticked categories. None ticked means all.	Open, none ticked
Topics	Tick boxes with counts	Shows only tools with any ticked topic. Up to 14 of the most common topics are listed.	Closed, none ticked

A **Pinned** tick box appears first under **Category** once you have pinned at least one tool.

Categories

Category	Tools in it
Accessibility	2
Color Science	1
Colorimetry	3

Category	Tools in it
Design Systems	1
Gamut & Rendering	4
Generators	5
Iconography	1
Perception	3
Publish	1
Spectral	2
Typography	1
Utilities	6

The counts above are for the full catalogue (**Everything**). The page shows counts for the tools currently in view.

Sort orders

Option	Card-menu button	Order
Title A to Z	Title	Alphabetical by tool name. First in the list, and the order Reset returns to.
Category A to Z	Category	Alphabetical by category.
Newest first	Newest	By date, newest first. Tools have no dates, so this keeps catalogue order.
Oldest first	Oldest	By date, oldest first. Tools have no dates, so this keeps catalogue order.
Recommended	Recommended	By a score built from your pins, your opens, core subjects and description depth.
Most used	Most	By how often and how recently you opened each tool from this page.
Pinned first	Pinned	Pinned tools first, then the rest.
Most metadata	Most metadata	Tools with the fullest descriptions and most tags first.

When the page first opens, the grid is in catalogue order (the order of the tool catalogue below), even though the **Sort** list shows **Title A to Z**. Choose any order to apply it.

Results bar

Control	What it does	Default
Search tools...	Filters as you type. Every word must match the tool's name, description, category, address or tags. Case does not matter; part-words match.	Empty
Grid	Shows cards side by side.	On

Control	What it does	Default
List	Shows one tool per row.	Off
Result count	Shows N tools , or N of M tools while filtering.	—

Cards

Part	What it shows or does
Artwork	An illustration for the tool.
Category line	The tool's category, above its name.
Name and description	The tool's name and one-sentence summary.
Free to use	Shown on every card: every tool is free on every plan.
Pin button	Pins or unpins the tool. Its label reads "Pin" or "Unpin" followed by the tool's name.
Tooltip	On hover: Category , Mode (Basic, Advanced or Both), Route (the tool's address) and topic tags.
Selecting the card	Opens the tool and counts one open towards Most used .

Loading

Behaviour	Detail
First view	12 tools.
Scrolling to the end of the grid	Loads the next 12 automatically.
Status line	Showing 12 of 14 tools , then All 14 tools shown (numbers vary).
Fallback button	Load N more tools , shown only if automatic loading is unavailable.
No results	No matching tools — "Try a shorter search, clear the topic chip, or switch the category back to all tools."
Load failure	The count reads Unable to load and the grid shows "Unable to load tools."

Floating search button

Appears on the right-hand side of the screen once the main controls have scrolled out of view. Its label is "Search and sort tools".

Control	What it does
Search tools...	Same search as the main box; the two stay in step.

Control	What it does
Sort	Same list as the main Sort list.
Category	Same tick boxes as the main panel (open by default).
Topics	Same tick boxes as the main panel (closed by default).
Escape or selecting outside	Closes the panel.

Card menu (right-click)

Right-click a card, or focus it and press the context-menu key or **Shift** + **F10**.

Group	Control	What it does	Values	Default
Header	Title	Shows the card's title, with a pin mark if pinned.	—	—
Card	Pin / Unpin	Pins or unpins the tool.	—	—
Card	Open	Opens the tool in this tab.	—	—
Card	New tab	Opens the tool in a new tab.	—	—
Card	Copy link	Copies the tool's full address.	—	—
View	Grid / List	Switches the layout.	Grid, List	Grid
Density	Cozy / Compact	Changes the space between cards.	Cozy, Compact	Cozy
Columns	Auto / 2 / 3 / 4	Sets the number of columns in grid view.	Auto, 2, 3, 4	Auto
Sort	Sort buttons	Chooses the sort order.	See the sort table	—
System	Theme	Switches the site theme; highlighted while dark.	On, Off	—
System	Reading	Turns reading mode on or off.	On, Off	—
Footer	Reset	Grid view, Cozy, Auto columns, first sort order. Pins and usage are kept.	—	—
Footer	All settings →	Opens the site settings panel.	—	—

Plans section

Control	What it does	Values	Default
Billing switch	Shows monthly or annual prices. The Save 22% badge sits beside it.	Monthly, Annual	Monthly
Currency buttons	Shows prices in US dollars or Indian rupees. The page picks one for your region on your first visit; your own choice is remembered.	USD \$, INR ₹	Set by region

The plans are **Apprentice**, **Artisan**, **Specialist** and **Industrial Pro**. The section lists "No credit card to start", "Every tool free on every plan" and "Cancel anytime · 7-day money-back". For plan details, see [Account and billing](#).

What is remembered

Item	Where	Scope
Pinned tools	This browser	The Collections catalogue
Opens (for Most used and Recommended)	This browser	The Collections catalogue
Grid or list view	This browser	The Collections page
Density and columns	This browser	The Collections page
Tool-visibility setting	This browser	The whole site

Tool catalogue

All 30 tools, in catalogue order.

Tool	Category	Mode	Address	What it does
Analyze URLs	Accessibility	Both	/tool/analyzer/	Accessibility audit, contrast checking, colour vision simulation, palette extraction and reports.
Vision Simulation	Accessibility	Advanced	/tool/vision-simulation/	Simulates colour vision deficiencies, cone isolation and ocular conditions.
Design System Generator	Design Systems	Basic	/tool/design-engine/	OKLCH colour ramps, font pairing, icons, spacing and motion scales, with token exports.
Color Science Lab	Color Science	Advanced	/tool/color-science-lab/	Chromatic adaptation, appearance models, spectral analysis and perceptual spaces.
Basic Tools	Generators	Basic	/tool/basic-tools/	Palettes, gradients, conversions and quick colour utilities.
Personalization Generator	Generators	Basic	/tool/personalization-gen/	Preference-based palettes, gradients, typography, UI pairs and posters.

Tool	Category	Mode	Address	What it does
Image Picker	Utilities	Basic	/tool/general/tools/image-picker/	Samples images and extracts palettes.
Font Library	Typography	Basic	/tool/font/	Browse, preview, download and embed self-hosted fonts.
Icon Library	Iconography	Basic	/tool/icon/	Browse, recolour and self-host about 12,900 open-source icons.
Generate ASCII Art	Generators	Basic	/tool/ascii/	Turns images, webcam captures and text into ASCII art.
Generate Ishihara Plates	Generators	Basic	/tool/ishihara-plate-generation/	Generates Ishihara-style colour vision test plates.
Illuminants	Colorimetry	Advanced	/tool/general/colorimetry/illuminants/	Reference spectra for standard illuminants.
Chromatic Adaptation	Colorimetry	Advanced	/tool/general/colorimetry/chromatic-adaptation-dynamic/	Adaptation transforms and viewing-condition demos.
Gamut Mapping	Colorimetry	Advanced	/tool/general/colorimetry/gamut-map/	Maps colours between gamuts while preserving appearance.
Gamut Explorer	Gamut & Rendering	Advanced	/tool/general/gamut-and-rendering/gamut/	Inspects gamuts in chromaticity and 3D views.
HDR Gamut Plot	Gamut & Rendering	Advanced	/tool/general/gamut-and-rendering/hdr-gamut-plot/	Plots HDR gamuts and exposure effects.
Tonal Steps, Tints & Shades	Gamut & Rendering	Advanced	/tool/general/gamut-and-rendering/tonal-steps-tints-shades/	Builds tonal step-charts.
Tone Mapping	Gamut & Rendering	Advanced	/tool/general/gamut-and-rendering/tone-mapping/	Tone mapping operators for HDR to LDR rendering.
Perception & Vision	Perception	Advanced	/tool/general/perception-and-neuroscience/perception-vision/	Visual phenomena, illusions and appearance models.
Neuroscience	Perception	Advanced	/tool/general/perception-and-neuroscience/neuroscience/	Visual cortex and neural colour processing.
Psychophysics Engine	Perception	Advanced	/tool/general/perception-and-neuroscience/psychophysical-experiment-engine/	Sets up, runs and analyses psychophysical experiments.
Material Lighting	Spectral	Advanced	/tool/general/spectral-tools/material-lighting/	Material reflectance under different illuminants.
Industrial Dye Chemistry	Spectral	Advanced	/tool/general/spectral-tools/industrial-dye-chemistry/	Dye mixture and spectral prediction tools.

Tool	Category	Mode	Address	What it does
LUT Lab	Utilities	Advanced	/tool/general/tools/lut-lab/	Creates and previews lookup tables.
ICC Parser	Utilities	Advanced	/tool/general/tools/icc-profile-parser/	Inspects ICC profiles.
Collage Maker	Utilities	Basic	/tool/general/tools/collage-maker/	Composes image collages and applies palettes.
M-Gradient Palette	Generators	Basic	/tool/general/tools/m-gradient-palette/	Multigradient palette generator and presets.
SVG Recolor	Utilities	Basic	/tool/general/tools/svg-recolor/	Recolours and batch-updates SVG files.
Convert & Export	Utilities	Basic	/tool/general/tools/	Small converters and helper utilities.
Portfolio Builder	Publish	Both	/portfolio/	Builds and publishes a public portfolio page.

All addresses are on <https://auricartisan.com>.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLLECTIONS

Troubleshooting Collections

Fix common problems on the Collections page, from missing tools to lost pins.

Each entry gives the symptom, the reason, and what to do.

A tool I know exists is not in the grid

Why: The site's tool-visibility setting hides tools that do not match it. The default setting, **Basic**, shows 14 of the 30 tools; advanced tools such as Illuminants or LUT Lab are hidden. A **Custom** setting hides every tool you switched off.

What to do: Open the **Advanced Kit** and choose **Everything**, or switch the tool back on in **Custom**. The grid updates at once. See [Show basic or advanced tools](#).

The grid is empty and says "No matching tools"

Why: Your search words, ticked categories and ticked topics together match nothing. Every search word must appear in a tool's details, and a tool must pass the category and topic filters as well.

What to do:

1. Shorten the search, or try the other spelling (**color** or **colour**).
2. Untick all **Topics**.

3. Untick all **Category** boxes, including **Pinned**.

The grid is not in alphabetical order, although Sort shows "Title A to Z"

Why: When the page first opens, the grid is in the catalogue's own order. The **Sort** list shows its first option, **Title A to Z**, but that order has not been applied yet.

What to do: Choose a different order and then **Title A to Z** again, or right-click a card and select **Title** under **Sort**. The card menu's **Reset** button also applies **Title A to Z**.

"Newest first" and "Oldest first" do not change anything

Why: Tools have no publication dates, so both orders keep the catalogue's own order.

What to do: Use **Title A to Z**, **Category A to Z**, **Recommended**, **Most used**, **Pinned first** or **Most metadata** instead.

My pins or usage history have gone

Why: Pins and opens are stored only in this browser. They are not saved to your account and do not follow you to another browser or device. They are lost if you clear this site's data, use a private window, or your browser clears storage automatically.

What to do: Pin the tools again. To keep pins, avoid clearing site data for auricartisan.com and do not rely on private windows.

"Most used" does not show a tool I use every day

Why: Only opens made by selecting a card on the Collections page count. Opening a tool from the header menu, a bookmark, a search result or a link does not.

What to do: Open the tool from its Collections card, or pin it so it always appears under **Pinned** and at the top of **Pinned first**.

Right-clicking a card shows the site's normal menu, not the card menu

Why: The card menu loads a moment after the page. It also only answers right-clicks on cards inside **All tools**, not on the **Start here** slider or the rest of the page. Some privacy or performance settings can stop the page's extra features from loading.

What to do: Wait for the page to finish loading and right-click a card in the **All tools** grid. If it still does not appear, reload the page.

The Columns setting makes cards tiny, or seems to do nothing

Why: **2**, **3** and **4** force that many columns at every screen width, so on a phone the cards become narrow. Columns have no effect in list view, which always shows one tool per row.

What to do: Choose **Auto** under **Columns**, or switch **View** to **Grid** to see the column change.

The featured slider keeps moving while I read it

Why: **Start here** plays automatically.

What to do: Move your pointer over the slider or give it keyboard focus to pause it. If you prefer no movement at all, turn on your system's reduced-motion setting; the slider then stays still.

The page says "Unable to load tools."

Why: The page could not fetch the tool catalogue, usually because the network connection dropped or the page was loaded from an old offline copy.

What to do: Check your connection and reload the page. Meanwhile, you can reach the tools from the site header's **Tools** menu.

Prices show in the wrong currency

Why: On your first visit the page chooses a currency for your region.

What to do: Select **USD \$** or **INR ₹** above the plans. Your choice is remembered.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLLECTIONS

Collections FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Collections tool catalogue.

How many tools are there?

Thirty. With the default **Basic** tool-visibility setting, Collections shows 14 of them; choose **Everything** in the Advanced Kit to see all 30. See [Show basic or advanced tools](#).

Are the tools free?

Yes. Every card says **Free to use**, and the plans section states "Every tool free on every plan". Paid plans add conveniences such as cloud sync, version history, batch power, API access and watermark-free exports.

Do I need an account to pin tools?

No. Pins work without signing in. They are stored in the browser you are using.

Will my pins appear on my phone too?

No. Pins and usage history stay in the browser where you made them. Signing in does not copy them to other devices.

What is the difference between Pinned, Most used and Recommended?

- **Pinned** is the tools you chose yourself.
- **Most used** is the tools you open most often and most recently from this page.
- **Recommended** combines your pins and opens with how central a tool is to the site's main subjects and how fully it is described.

See [Pin tools and use recommendations](#).

Does Auric Artisan see which tools I pin or open here?

The Collections page keeps pins and opens in your browser and does not send them to Auric Artisan. The site's own analytics, which run only with your consent, are covered by the privacy policy. See [Privacy](#).

How do I reset the page to how it was?

Right-click a card and select **Reset** to restore the layout (grid view, cozy density, automatic columns, **Title A to Z**). To clear pins, unpin each tool. To clear usage history as well, clear this site's data in your browser.

Can I share a link to a tool?

Yes. Right-click its card and choose **Copy link**, then paste the address wherever you like.

Why does the right-click menu look different on cards?

Cards have their own menu with card actions and grid settings. Everywhere else on the page, right-clicking opens the site's usual menu.

Why are some categories spelled "Color"?

Official names keep their published spelling, such as "Color Science" and "Colorimetry". Descriptions on the site use British spelling ("colour").

Where do I find guides for each tool?

Each tool has a user guide in the Documentation library. See [Documentation](#).

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Collections: other material

Supporting material for the Collections page: glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages and privacy.

This folder holds the supporting pages for Collections: the terms it uses, its keyboard and mouse actions, what its orders and counts can and cannot tell you, related pages, and what it stores.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Terms such as pin, topic, mode, frequency and density.
Shortcuts	Keyboard and mouse actions on the page.
Limits and accuracy	What the counts, sort orders and recommendations mean, and their limits.
Related	Related pages, kits and libraries.
Privacy	What stays in your browser and what uses the network.

Back to the [Collections overview](#).

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [COLLECTIONS](#)

Collections shortcuts

Keyboard and mouse actions on the Collections page.

Mouse

Action	Result
Select a card	Opens the tool and counts one open towards Most used .
Select a card's pin button	Pins or unpins the tool.
Right-click a card	Opens the card menu.
Right-click elsewhere	Opens the site's usual right-click menu.
Hover a card	Shows a tooltip with category, mode, address and tags.
Hover the Start here slider	Pauses autoplay.

Keyboard

Keys	Where	Result
Tab	Anywhere	Moves between links, buttons and filter boxes.
Left / Right	Start here slider, when focused	Previous or next featured tool.

Keys	Where	Result
Context-menu key, or Shift + F10	A focused card	Opens the card menu.
Escape	Card menu	Closes the menu.
Escape	Floating search panel	Closes the panel and returns focus to its button.
Space	A focused tick box	Ticks or unticks a category or topic.

The site-wide shortcuts, such as **Alt** + **R** for reading mode and **Alt** + **T** to switch theme, also work here. See [Site features](#).

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Collections glossary

Definitions of the terms used on the Collections page.

Term	Meaning
Card	One tool's tile in the grid: artwork, category, name, description and a pin button.
Catalogue order	The fixed order in which tools are listed in the catalogue. The Reference lists all 30 tools in this order.
Category	The broad group a tool belongs to, such as Colorimetry or Utilities. Each tool has exactly one.
Card menu	The menu that opens when you right-click a card, with card actions and grid settings.
Columns	How many cards sit side by side in grid view. Auto fits the screen; 2 , 3 or 4 force a number.
Density	The spacing between cards. Cozy is normal; Compact is tighter.
Everything	The tool-visibility setting that shows all 30 tools.
Frecency	A mix of frequency and recency: how often you opened a tool, weighted towards recent opens. The Most used order is based on it.
Mode	A tool's level: Basic (everyday), Advanced (scientific or power-user) or Both (shown in every setting).
Open	Selecting a card to go to the tool. Each open is counted towards Most used .
Pin	A mark you put on a tool so it is grouped under Pinned and comes first in Start here and Pinned first .
Reading mode	A site setting that makes pages calmer and easier to read. The card menu's Reading switch turns it on and off.
Start here	The slider of three featured tools near the top of the page.
Tool visibility	The site-wide setting, chosen in the Advanced Kit, that decides which tools appear: Basic, Advanced, Everything or Custom.
Topic	A short tag on a tool, such as palette or hdr . A tool can have several. The Topics filter lists up to 14 of the most common.

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Limits and accuracy

What the Collections counts, sort orders and recommendations tell you, and what they do not.

Collections is a catalogue, not a measurement tool. Its numbers and orders are simple, local and predictable. This page says what they mean.

Counts

- The hero counters and category counts cover only the tools your tool-visibility setting shows. With the default **Basic** setting, **Tools** reads 14, not 30.
 - **Topics** counts different tags among the tools in view. The **Topics** filter lists only the 14 most common of them, so a rarer tag cannot be chosen as a filter; type it into the search box instead.
-

Search

- Search is a plain text match. It does not correct typing mistakes and does not know that "color" and "colour" mean the same thing.
 - Every word you type must match. Adding a word can only narrow the results.
-

Sort orders

- **Newest first** and **Oldest first** have no effect, because tools carry no dates.
 - **Most used** counts only opens from the Collections page itself, in this browser. It knows nothing about how you use the tools elsewhere, or on other devices.
 - **Recommended** is a fixed recipe, not a learning system. It adds points for your pins and opens, for mentions of core subjects (such as accessibility, WCAG, contrast, gamut, HDR and ICC) and for how fully a tool is described. It is a starting point, not advice about which tool is right for a job.
 - The boost from your opens is capped, so heavy use of one tool cannot push every other tool to the bottom of **Recommended**.
-

What Collections is not

- It is not a record of your work. Pins and usage are conveniences that can be lost when browser data is cleared.
- It does not sync. Nothing you do on this page follows your account to another browser.
- It does not rate tools. The order of the catalogue and of **Start here** is not a ranking of quality.

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Privacy

What the Collections page stores in your browser and what it fetches over the network.

What stays in your browser

The Collections page remembers a few things in your browser's local storage. None of it is sent to Auric Artisan or saved to your account.

What	Why	How to remove it
Pinned tools	To show Pinned , Pinned first and your Start here picks.	Unpin each tool, or clear this site's data.
Tool opens (count and last time)	To build Most used and part of Recommended .	Clear this site's data.
Grid or list view	To keep your chosen layout.	Choose the other view, or clear this site's data.
Density and columns	To keep your card-menu layout choices.	Select Reset in the card menu.
Tool-visibility setting	To show the tool set you chose in the Advanced Kit.	Change it in the Advanced Kit.

Because these are stored per browser, a private window starts with none of them and forgets them when it closes.

What uses the network

- The page downloads the tool catalogue and card artwork from [auricartisan.com](#) when it loads.
- **Copy link** writes to your device's clipboard only; nothing is sent.
- The page can show advertising. Advertising and analytics on the site follow your cookie and consent choices.

For the site's full privacy policy, consent choices and cookie settings, see [Company and legal](#).

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Related pages

Pages, kits and libraries that work alongside the Collections catalogue.

Settings that change Collections

- [Advanced Kit](#) — chooses **Basic**, **Advanced**, **Everything** or a **Custom** tool set, which decides which tools Collections shows.
- [Site features](#) — the site theme, reading mode, the settings panel and the site's usual right-click menu.

Other libraries

- [Library overview](#) — every part of the Auric Artisan library.
 - [Colour libraries](#) — searchable libraries of colours, palettes, gradients, harmonies, shades and accessible colour pairs.
 - [Learn](#) — articles on colour science and accessibility, many with interactive labs.
 - [Documentation](#) — user guides and references for the tools.
-

Tools in the catalogue

Documentation for some of the tools in the catalogue:

- [URL Analyzer](#) (the **Analyze URLs** card) and [Vision Simulation](#).
 - [Basic Tools](#) and the [Design System Generator](#).
 - [Font Library](#) and [Icon Library](#).
 - [Portfolio Builder](#).
-

Plans

- [Account and billing](#) — the plans shown at the foot of the Collections page.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES

Colour libraries

An overview of the six Auric Artisan colour libraries and a map of their documentation.

Auric Artisan has six colour libraries. Each is a large, searchable collection of generated colour data that you can browse, filter, inspect and copy or export. They share one idea: every item carries its measurements with it, so you can choose colours by what they do — how they contrast, how they step, how they read to people with colour vision deficiencies — and not only by how they look in a thumbnail.

The libraries are free to use and need no account. They open in any modern browser.

The six libraries

Library	What it holds	Address
Color Library	8,192 measured colours, each in seven colour spaces with contrast and colour-blindness data.	https://auricartisan.com/library/color/
Palette Library	5,000,000 generated palettes, filterable by hue, lightness, chroma, harmony method and WCAG.	https://auricartisan.com/library/palette/
Gradient Library	8,192 gradients with OKLCH metadata, 2 to 46 stops, and a measured verdict on banding.	https://auricartisan.com/library/gradient/
Harmony Library	8,192 colour harmonies across 23 colour-theory schemes, plus a tool that names the scheme your own colours form.	https://auricartisan.com/library/harmony/
Shade Library	8,192 OKLCH shade scales with tint and shade tokens and contrast checks.	https://auricartisan.com/library/shades/
Accessibility Library	5,000,000 foreground and background pairs scored against WCAG, APCA and colour vision deficiency.	https://auricartisan.com/library/accessibility/

Which library do I need?

- **One colour, with its numbers:** the Color Library.
- **A set of colours that work together:** the Palette Library, or the Harmony Library if you want a named colour-theory scheme.
- **A smooth blend between colours:** the Gradient Library.
- **One colour taken from light to dark for a design system:** the Shade Library.
- **Text and background colours that pass contrast rules:** the Accessibility Library.

In this folder

- [color-library/](#) — the Color Library.
- [palette-library/](#) — the Palette Library.

- [gradient-library/](#) — the Gradient Library.
- [harmony-library/](#) — the Harmony Library.
- [shade-library/](#) — the Shade Library.
- [accessibility-library/](#) — the Accessibility Color Pair Library.

Back to the [Library overview](#).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > ACCESSIBILITY LIBRARY

Accessibility Library

What the Accessibility Color Pair Library is, who it is for, where to find it, and how to find text colours that pass on any background.

The Accessibility Library — the Accessibility Color Pair Library — answers one question: "What may I write *on this*?" You choose a background colour (the page calls it the **ground**) and a contrast target, and the page draws a map of every foreground colour, with a line showing exactly where text starts to pass. Contrast depends on both colours continuously, so the answer is a territory, not a list, and the boundary moves with hue: at the same lightness, yellow gives far more contrast than blue, so "just make it darker" means different things for different hues.

Around the map, the page gives you a concrete answer — up to twelve foreground colours, one per 30° of hue, that clear your target on your ground, ready to copy as CSS — and an audit for colours you already have: paste your palette and each colour is placed on the map, with how much lighter or darker it would need to be to pass.

Behind all of this is an index of 5,000,000 scored foreground and background pairs. Like the other libraries, it is defined by a seed rather than stored, so any record — for example **acc_91** — can be cited in an audit and recomputed by whoever reads it. Every figure is computed in your browser.

Who it is for

- Designers choosing text, icon and UI colours for a given background.
- Accessibility specialists auditing a palette against a ground, or citing a reproducible pair.
- Developers who want a set of passing foregrounds as CSS custom properties.
- Anyone learning how contrast, lightness and hue interact.

Where to find it

Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/accessibility/> in a current browser. It is also listed as **Accessibility Library** ("Tested accessible color pairs") under **Libraries** in the site header's **Learn** menu. No account is needed.

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/accessibility/>. The ground starts as **#1D2A3E** (a dark navy) and the target as **4.5:1**.
2. Choose a ground: one of the four preset swatches, or the colour picker for any colour.
3. Choose a target: **3:1**, **4.5:1** or **7:1**.
4. Drag on the map. The panel beside it shows your foreground on the ground, its contrast ratio and whether it passes.

5. Read **Territory** to see how much of the colour space passes on this ground.
 6. Scroll to the picks and select **Copy as CSS** to take up to twelve passing colours.
 7. Paste your own palette into **Or bring your own** to see which colours fail and by how much.
-

What you can do

- See, for any background, every foreground colour that reaches 3:1, 4.5:1 or 7:1.
 - Read a colour's WCAG contrast ratio, APCA lightness contrast (Lc), and how well it stays distinct under ten simulated vision conditions.
 - Get up to twelve passing foregrounds across the hue circle, and copy them as CSS custom properties.
 - Audit up to 24 of your own colours against the ground, with the lightness change each failure needs.
 - Swap foreground and ground to ask the question the other way round.
 - Look up any of five million scored pairs by id, and browse pairs that pass.
 - Automate the same answers through the site's REST API.
-

In this folder

- [docs/](#) — how to use the Accessibility Library.
 - [Getting started](#), [Read the contrast map](#), [Use the picks](#), [Check your own colours](#), [Look up and browse the index](#), [Reference](#), [Troubleshooting](#), [FAQ](#).
- [others/](#) — background material.
 - [Glossary](#), [Shortcuts](#), [Limits and accuracy](#), [Related](#), [Privacy](#), [Release notes](#).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > ACCESSIBILITY LIBRARY

Accessibility Library documentation

The task guides, reference, troubleshooting and FAQ for the Accessibility Color Pair Library.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	Opening the page, a tour, and a first set of passing text colours.
read-the-contrast-map.md	Grounds, targets, the map, its lines, the readout, swap and keyboard control.
use-the-picks.md	The twelve suggested foregrounds and Copy as CSS .
check-your-own-colours.md	Or bring your own: pasting a palette and reading what each colour needs.
look-up-and-browse-the-index.md	The five-million-pair index: record lookup and browsing.
reference.md	Every control, output and message.
troubleshooting.md	Symptoms, causes and fixes.
faq.md	Short answers.

Back to the [Accessibility Library overview](#).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > ACCESSIBILITY LIBRARY

Getting started

Open the Accessibility Library, learn the screen, and find passing text colours for a background.

Open the page

Go to <https://auricartisan.com/library/accessibility/>, or open the **Learn** menu in the site header and select **Accessibility Library** under **Libraries**. The map draws straight away; it needs nothing from the network.

A tour of the screen

The heading

Kicker **Auric Artisan · Accessibility**; headline **What may I write on this?**; and a line with **Corpus 5,000,000, Seed 9001, Every figure computed in your browser**, and **Read the API guide** →.

A note starting **Automate this** may appear: the same job is available through the site's REST API — **8 API credits per call to POST /v1/accessibility/map** — with **API docs**. Select × to dismiss it.

The control bar

- **Ground** — four preset swatches (`#0D0D0D` , `#1D2A3E` , `#FFFCF7` , `#1B4D3E`), a colour picker for any other ground, and **Swap**.

- **Target** — **3:1, 4.5:1** or **7:1**.
- **Territory** — the share of the map that passes, as a percentage.

The map and the readout

On the left, the contrast map: hue from left (0°, red) to right (360°), lightness from bottom (0) to top (1.0). Three lines mark where contrast reaches 3:1, 4.5:1 and 7:1, and the part of the map that fails your target is dimmed. A small caret marks your current foreground.

On the right, the readout: a text specimen in your foreground on the ground, the contrast ratio with a verdict, a table of figures, and a sentence of advice.

Below the map

- **N that work on this ground** — up to twelve passing foregrounds, with **Copy as CSS**.
- **Or bring your own** — a box to paste your colours, and a table of results.
- **All of this from your own code** — an example API call and links: **Read the guide**, **Endpoint reference** and **Get a key**.
- **The index** — look up any of five million scored pairs, and browse them.

Your first task: text colours for a dark green banner

1. Select the `#1B4D3E` ground swatch.
2. Keep the target at **4.5:1** (body text).
3. Read **Territory**: the share of colour space that can carry body text on this green.
4. Drag on the map inside the bright (undimmed) region. The ratio turns to a pass, and the verdict reads **clears AA for body text**.
5. Scroll to **N that work on this ground**. Each card shows a sample sentence in a passing colour on your green, with its ratio.
6. Select **Copy as CSS**. The button briefly reads **Copied**.
7. Paste into your stylesheet: you get `--ground` and `--fg-01`, `--fg-02` ... custom properties.

Result: a set of text colours, across the whole hue circle, that are all at least 4.5:1 on your banner colour.

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Check your own colours

Paste your palette into "Or bring your own" to place each colour on the map and see how much lightness each failing colour needs.

Or bring your own audits a palette you already have against the current ground and target.

Steps

1. Choose the ground your palette will sit on, and a target.
2. Click in the box under **Or bring your own** and paste your colours as hex codes, for example `#D3AF37` `#8A6D16` `#6B7280` `#136B39` `#B91C1C`. Separators do not matter: spaces, commas or new lines all work.
3. Wait a moment. Each colour is placed on the map as a pin at its real hue and lightness, and appears in the table.
4. Read the table (below). Failing colours also get a line on the map drawn up (or down) to the target line, showing the move they need.
5. Change the ground or target to re-check the whole palette at once.

Result: every colour in your palette placed on the map, with a pass or fail and the lightness change each failure needs.

The table

Column	Meaning
Colour	The swatch and hex code.
Here	Its contrast ratio against the current ground; failing ratios are marked.
Lightness	Its OKLCH lightness as a percentage.
Needs	nothing if it passes; otherwise +N% lightness , the change needed at its hue to reach the line; or unreachable if no lightness at its hue can pass on this ground.

The "+N%" is the size of the change. On a dark ground it means lighter; on a light ground it means darker.

Rules for pasting

- Colours must be hex codes that start with `#`, with 3 to 6 digits (`#ABC` , `#AABBCC`).
- Repeated colours are shown once.
- Up to 24 colours are placed; any beyond that are ignored.
- Other text in the box is ignored, so you can paste a line from a stylesheet.

With nothing pasted, the table says **Paste hexes above to see them placed against this ground.**

Example

On the default navy ground at **4.5:1**, a mid grey such as `#6B7280` fails and shows a lightness it needs, while a light gold such as `#D3AF37` passes with **nothing** needed.

Look up and browse the index

Look up any of five million scored colour pairs by record id, read its WCAG, APCA and Auric SD scores, and browse pairs that pass.

The index is a set of five million foreground and background pairs, each scored. As the page explains, it is "defined by a seed rather than stored": any record is a function of the seed (9001) and its number, so a record cited in an audit can be recomputed by anyone who reads it.

Look up a record

1. Scroll to **The index**.
2. Type a record id such as `acc_91`, or a plain number such as `325`, into the box (**A record id like `acc_91`, or an index like `325`**).
3. Select **Look up**, or press **Enter**.

Record ids are `acc_` followed by the record's number in base 36; `acc_91` is record 325.

The result shows a specimen of the pair and:

Fact	Meaning
Pair	Foreground on background, for example <code>#4E1229 on #D86062</code> .
Contrast	The WCAG 2 contrast ratio, for example <code>4.00:1</code> .
APCA	The APCA Lc value, rounded, for example <code>35</code> .
Auric SD	Auric Artisan's combined score from 0 to 100 and its grade, for example <code>43.6 · F</code> .
Recommended for	The strongest use the pair supports, for example <code>large-text</code> .

The examples are the real values of `acc_91`. A note underneath gives the seed, the index and the batch it belongs to — "Anyone with the same three numbers recomputes the same pair, which is what makes this citable."

Messages: **Not a record id. They look like `acc_91` — or paste an index.** for unreadable input, and **Out of range. The corpus holds 5,000,000 records.** for a number that is too large.

The Auric SD score

A single score from 0 to 100 that weighs five things: WCAG contrast (30%), APCA contrast (30%), how distinct the pair stays under simulated vision conditions (20%), the gap in OKLCH lightness (10%), and the hue difference weighted by colourfulness (10%). Grades: **S** (90 or more), **A** (80 or more), **B** (70 or more), **C** (60 or more), **D** (50 or more), **F** (below 50).

Recommended for

Value	Meaning
<code>body-text-strict</code>	Passes a strict body-text test: score 85 or more, 7:1 or more, APCA 75 or more, and good separation under every simulated vision condition.
<code>body-text-WCAG3</code>	APCA 75 or more (body text in the draft WCAG 3 approach).
<code>body-text-AA</code>	WCAG 2 contrast 4.5:1 or more.
<code>large-text</code>	3:1 or more.
<code>ui-only</code>	APCA 45 or more.
<code>spot-text</code>	APCA 30 or more.
<code>non-text</code>	APCA 15 or more.
<code>decorative</code>	None of the above.

The list is checked from the top, so a pair gets the first value it qualifies for.

Browse the index

Under the lookup, a grid of pair cards scrolls through the corpus.

- **Pairs that pass** (the default) shows only pairs that clear the current target.
- **Everything** shows every pair, most of which fail.

The line beside the switch counts **N shown · scanned M of 5,000,000**. A note under the grid explains what you are seeing — with **Pairs that pass**, roughly what percentage of scanned pairs clear the target — and that you can keep scrolling without the page slowing down, because only what is on screen is drawn. At the very end it says **That is the end of the corpus**.

Each card shows **Readable** and a sample sentence in the pair, its ratio, "foreground on background" and its record id. Hover for the id and ratio.

Select a card to load that pair into the map: its background becomes the ground, the caret moves to its foreground, and the page scrolls up to the map.

Changing the target while **Pairs that pass** is on restarts the browse from the beginning with the new target.

API

The section **All of this from your own code** shows an example call to the site's public API and links to **Read the guide**, **Endpoint reference** and **Get a key**. See [Public API](#).

Read the contrast map

Choose a ground and a target, explore the contrast map by pointer or keyboard, and read the ratio, APCA value, vision margin and distance to the line.

What the map shows

- **Across:** hue, from 0° (red) through 60° (yellow), 120° (green), 180° (cyan), 240° (blue) and 300° (magenta) to 360°.
- **Up:** OKLCH lightness, from 0 (black) at the bottom to 1.0 (white) at the top.
- **Each point:** the most colourful colour your screen's sRGB range can show at that hue and lightness.
- **Three lines:** where contrast against the ground reaches **3:1** (dashed amber), **4.5:1 body** (solid green) and **7:1 AAA** (dashed pale blue).
- **Dimmed area:** the part of the map that fails your chosen target.

On a dark ground the passing region is above the line (lighter colours); on a light ground it is below (darker colours). Notice that the line is not flat: yellows and greens pass at lower lightness than blues and purples, because they carry more luminance.

Choose a ground

A **ground** is the background your text will sit on.

1. Select one of the preset swatches: **#0D0D0D** (near-black), **#1D2A3E** (dark navy, the default), **#FFFCF7** (warm off-white) or **#1B4D3E** (dark green).
2. Or use the colour picker beside them to choose any ground.

The lines, the dimmed area, **Territory** and the picks all update for the new ground.

Choose a target

Target	Meaning
3:1	Large text and user-interface components such as icons and borders (WCAG AA).
4.5:1	Body text (WCAG AA). The default.
7:1	Body text at WCAG AAA.

Territory shows what share of the map clears the chosen target on this ground — a quick measure of how much freedom the ground leaves you. Near-black leaves most of the colour space usable; a mid-tone leaves a sliver.

Explore

- **Pointer:** press and drag anywhere on the map. The caret follows, and the readout updates.
- **Keyboard:** select the map (or tab to it) and use the arrow keys:

Key	Effect
Left / Right	Hue down or up by 5°.
Up / Down	Lightness up or down by 0.02.
Shift with an arrow	Five times the step (25° or 0.10).
Home	Lightness to 1 (white end).
End	Lightness to 0 (black end).

Screen readers announce the current foreground, ground, ratio and whether it passes.

The readout

The specimen shows "Readable at a glance" and a paragraph in your foreground on the ground.

Under it, the ratio, for example **7.84:1**, and a verdict:

Ratio	Verdict
7:1 or more	clears AAA for body text
4.5:1 to 7:1	clears AA for body text
3:1 to 4.5:1	large text and UI only
Below 3:1	fails every text threshold

Then the figures:

Row	Meaning
Foreground	The colour under the caret, in hex.
Ground	The background, in hex.
Lightness	The foreground's OKLCH lightness, three decimals.
Hue	The foreground's hue in degrees.
APCA	The APCA lightness contrast value (Lc), rounded. Negative values mean light text on a dark ground.
Vision margin	How far apart the two colours stay under ten simulated conditions (eight colour vision deficiencies, cataracts and low vision), taking the worst case, on a scale from 0 (identical) to 1.

Row	Meaning
To the line	How far the caret is from your target's line at this hue, as a percentage of lightness: positive inside the passing region, negative outside, or unreachable at this hue .

Finally, a sentence of advice:

- Inside: **Inside the territory with N% of lightness to spare — room for a later tweak before it drops out.**
- Outside: **Outside by N% of lightness. The line sits above/below you at this hue, so moving straight up/down the column is the shortest way in.**
- No passing lightness at this hue: **No lightness at this hue reaches the target against this ground. Either the ground has to move or the hue does.**

Swap foreground and ground

Select **Swap** to put the current foreground on the ground and move the caret to the old ground colour. Use it to ask the question the other way round — for example, "what backgrounds can hold this brand colour as text?"

Result

You know which foreground colours pass on your ground at your target, how close any colour is to the line, and which way to move it.

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Use the picks

Take up to twelve passing foreground colours for your ground, preview them, and copy them as CSS custom properties.

The section headed **N that work on this ground** (for example **12 that work on this ground**) is the page's concrete answer: foreground colours that clear your target on your ground.

How the picks are chosen

- One pick per 30° of hue, starting at 15°, so up to twelve picks cover the whole colour wheel.
- Each is placed a little inside its hue's line — 10% of lightness into the passing region — so you have room to adjust it later without it dropping out.
- Every pick clears the target. If a hue cannot reach the target on this ground, or a pick would land just under it, that hue is left out, so you may see fewer than twelve.

The text under the heading repeats the target and ground, for example "everything here clears **4.5:1** on **#1D2A3E**".

Steps

1. Choose your ground and target in the control bar (see [Read the contrast map](#)).
2. Scroll to the picks. Each card shows **Readable** and a sample sentence in the pick on your ground, with its ratio and hex code. Hover a card to see its ratio and hue.
3. Select a card to move the map's caret onto that colour and read its full figures.
4. Select **Copy as CSS** to copy the whole set. The button reads **Copied** (or **Copy failed** if your browser blocked the clipboard).

Result: CSS like this on your clipboard:

```
/* Auric Artisan – foregrounds that clear 4.5:1 on #1D2A3E
   sampled across the passing region, one per 30° of hue */
:root {
  --ground: #1D2A3E;
  --fg-01: #...; /* 7.12:1 · hue 15° */
  --fg-02: #...; /* 6.98:1 · hue 45° */
}
```

Each `--fg-NN` line carries its ratio and hue as a comment. The exact colours depend on your ground and target.

Tip: Rename the properties after pasting, for example `--text-accent-red`, and keep the comment so reviewers can see the ratio each was chosen for.

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Accessibility Library reference

Every control, output and message in the Accessibility Color Pair Library.

Everything on <https://auricartisan.com/library/accessibility/>.

Heading

Item	Content
Kicker	Auric Artisan · Accessibility
Headline	What may I write on this?
Facts	Corpus 5,000,000, Seed 9001, Every figure computed in your browser
Read the API guide →	The accessibility corpus API guide.
Automate this note	8 API credits per call to POST /v1/accessibility/map; API docs; × dismisses.

Control bar

Control	What it does	Values	Default
Ground swatches	Set the background.	#0D0D0D, #1D2A3E, #FFFCF7, #1B4D3E	#1D2A3E
Colour picker	Any other ground.	Any colour	—
Swap	Puts the current foreground on the ground and moves the caret to the old ground.	—	—
Target	The contrast threshold.	3:1, 4.5:1, 7:1	4.5:1
Territory	Share of the map that clears the target.	0% to 100%	—

The map

Element	Meaning
Horizontal axis	Hue: 0° red, 60° yellow, 120° green, 180° cyan, 240° blue, 300° magenta, 360°.
Vertical axis	OKLCH lightness, 0 to 1.0.
Colour at each point	The most colourful sRGB colour at that hue and lightness.
Lines	3:1 (dashed amber), 4.5:1 body (solid green), 7:1 AAA (dashed pale blue).
Dimmed area	Fails the current target.
Caret	The current foreground. Starts at hue 190°, lightness 0.78.
Pins	Your pasted colours; failures have a line to the target.

Input	Effect
Press and drag	Moves the caret.
Left / Right	Hue −5° / +5° (×5 with Shift).
Up / Down	Lightness +0.02 / −0.02 (×5 with Shift).
Home / End	Lightness 1 / 0.

Readout

Item	Meaning
Specimen	"Readable at a glance" and a paragraph in the foreground on the ground.
Ratio	WCAG 2 contrast, two decimals.

Item	Meaning
Verdict	clears AAA for body text (≥ 7), clears AA for body text (≥ 4.5), large text and UI only (≥ 3), fails every text threshold.
Foreground, Ground	Hex codes.
Lightness	Foreground OKLCH lightness.
Hue	Foreground hue in degrees.
APCA	Lc, rounded.
Vision margin	Worst-case separation under ten simulated conditions, 0 to 1.
To the line	Lightness distance to the target line, or unreachable at this hue .
Advice	Inside / outside / unreachable sentence.

Picks

Control	What it does
Heading	N that work on this ground , with the target and ground named.
Pick card	Specimen, ratio and hex. Select to move the caret to it.
Copy as CSS	Copies a <code>:root</code> block with <code>--ground</code> and <code>--fg-01 ... --fg-12</code> ; shows Copied or Copy failed .

Up to 12 picks, one per 30° of hue, each 10% of lightness inside the line.

Or bring your own

Element	Meaning
Paste box	Hex codes starting with <code>#</code> , 3 to 6 digits; up to 24; duplicates removed.
Colour	Swatch and hex.
Here	Contrast on the ground.
Lightness	OKLCH lightness as a percentage.
Needs	nothing , +N% lightness , or unreachable .

All of this from your own code

An example `curl` call to `https://api.auricartisan.com/v1/accessibility/corpus/stats` with an API key, and links **Read the guide**, **Endpoint reference**, **Get a key**.

The index

Control	What it does
Lookup box	A record id (acc_...) or a number.
Look up / Enter	Shows the record.
Record	Specimen; Pair , Contrast , APCA , Auric SD , Recommended for ; seed, index and batch.
Pairs that pass / Everything	Browse filter. Default: Pairs that pass .
Count	N shown · scanned M of 5,000,000 .
Pair card	Select to load the pair into the map.

Messages

Message	When
Paste hexes above to see them placed against this ground.	Nothing pasted.
Not a record id. They look like acc_91 — or paste an index.	Unreadable lookup.
Out of range. The corpus holds 5,000,000 records.	Number too large.
That is the end of the corpus.	Browse reached the end.
Copied, Copy failed	After Copy as CSS .

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Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes for problems in the Accessibility Library.

Fewer than twelve picks appear

Why: Some hues cannot reach the target on this ground at any lightness, or their pick would land just under the target. Those hues are left out rather than showing a failing colour.

What to do: Lower the target, or choose a ground further from mid-grey (very dark or very light).

"unreachable at this hue"

Why: On a mid-tone ground, some hues never reach the target however light or dark they are.

What to do: Move to a different hue, change the ground, or use **Swap** to explore from the other side.

Territory is very small

Why: Mid-tone grounds leave little room: text must be much lighter or much darker, and at some hues neither is possible.

What to do: Use a darker or lighter ground if the design allows. **Territory** tells you how much room each ground leaves.

Pasted colours do not appear

Why: Only hex codes that start with `#` are read, with 3 to 6 digits. Names, `rgb()` and hex codes without `#` are ignored. Only the first 24 colours are placed.

What to do: Paste hex codes with `#`, for example `#6B7280`.

A colour passes here but fails in an audit tool

Why: This page measures against the ground you chose, with the WCAG 2 formula. An audit tool may use the actual background behind the text (including images or transparency), text size, or a different method such as APCA.

What to do: Check that the ground matches the real background, and read the **APCA** figure as well as the ratio.

"Copy failed"

Why: Your browser blocked clipboard access.

What to do: Click inside the page and try again, or allow clipboard access for auricartisan.com.

The browse grid shows few cards

Why: With **Pairs that pass**, most random pairs are skipped; at **7:1** even fewer qualify.

What to do: Keep scrolling — the page keeps scanning — or choose **Everything**.

The index lookup says "Not a record id"

Why: Record ids look like `acc_` followed by digits and letters, for example `acc_91`.

What to do: Type the id exactly, or type the record's number.

Accessibility Library FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Accessibility Library.

What contrast do I need?

Under WCAG 2: 4.5:1 for normal body text (AA), 3:1 for large text (at least 18 point, or 14 point bold) and for user-interface components and graphics, and 7:1 for body text at AAA.

What is APCA?

The Advanced Perceptual Contrast Algorithm, a newer contrast measure developed for the draft WCAG 3. It gives a lightness contrast value, L_c , from about -108 to 106 ; the sign shows polarity (negative for light text on dark). Higher absolute values mean more readable text. The page shows it alongside the WCAG 2 ratio.

Why does the line curve?

Because contrast depends on luminance, and luminance depends on hue as well as lightness: yellows and greens are much brighter than blues and purples at the same OKLCH lightness.

What is the Vision margin?

How far apart the two colours stay when viewed as someone with each of eight colour vision deficiencies, cataracts or low vision would see them, taking the worst case, on a 0-to-1 scale. A low margin means the pair can merge for some people even if its contrast ratio passes.

What is the index for?

It is a reproducible set of five million scored pairs. Any record id, such as `acc_91`, always gives the same pair, so you can cite it in an audit.

Is anything sent to a server?

No. Every figure on the page is computed in your browser. See [Privacy](#).

Can I automate this?

Yes, through the site's REST API. The page's **All of this from your own code** section links to the guide and the endpoint reference. See [Public API](#).

Do I need an account?

Not to use the page. An API key (from your dashboard) is needed only for the API.

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Accessibility Library: other material

Supporting material for the Accessibility Library: glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages, privacy and release notes.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Ground, target, territory, APCA, Auric SD and other terms.
Shortcuts	Keyboard control of the map and other keys.
Limits and accuracy	What the figures measure, and what they do not.
Related	Related libraries, tools and Learn articles.
Privacy	What is computed locally and what uses the network.
Release notes	User-facing history.

Back to the [Accessibility Library overview](#).

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Accessibility Library shortcuts

Keyboard control of the contrast map and other keys in the Accessibility Library.

The map (focus it first)

Keys	Effect
Left / Right	Hue -5° / $+5^{\circ}$.
Shift + Left / Right	Hue -25° / $+25^{\circ}$.
Up / Down	Lightness $+0.02$ / -0.02 .
Shift + Up / Down	Lightness $+0.10$ / -0.10 .
Home	Lightness 1 (top).
End	Lightness 0 (bottom).

Elsewhere

Keys or action	Effect
Enter in the index box	Looks up the record.
Select a pick	Moves the caret to it.

Keys or action	Effect
Select an index card	Loads its pair into the map.

The site-wide shortcuts also work here. See [Site features](#).

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Accessibility Library glossary

Definitions of the terms used in the Accessibility Library.

Term	Meaning
AA, AAA	WCAG conformance levels. For normal text, AA needs 4.5:1 and AAA needs 7:1.
APCA (Lc)	Advanced Perceptual Contrast Algorithm; its lightness contrast value Lc runs from about –108 to 106. Larger absolute values are more readable.
Auric SD	Auric Artisan's combined 0–100 score for a pair (WCAG, APCA, vision separation, lightness gap, hue gap), graded S, A, B, C, D or F.
Caret	The marker on the map showing the current foreground.
Contrast ratio	The WCAG 2 measure of the luminance difference between two colours, from 1:1 to 21:1.
Corpus	The five million scored pairs behind the index.
Foreground	The text or icon colour.
Gamut	The range of colours a colour space or screen can show. The map shows the sRGB gamut.
Ground	The background colour you are testing against.
Large text	At least 18 point (24 CSS pixels), or 14 point (about 18.7 CSS pixels) bold.
OKLCH	A perceptual colour space: lightness (0 to 1), chroma and hue.
Pick	One of up to twelve suggested passing foregrounds.
Record id	acc_ followed by a record's number in base 36.
Seed	The fixed number (9001) from which every record is derived.
Target	The contrast threshold you are testing: 3:1, 4.5:1 or 7:1.
Territory	The share of the map that clears the target on the current ground.
Vision margin	Worst-case separation of the two colours under ten simulated vision conditions, 0 to 1.
WCAG	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines.

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Limits and accuracy

What the Accessibility Library measures, how precisely, and what it is not.

The map

- The map is drawn at 72 hue columns (one every 5°), and the lines are found for each column. Between columns the line is drawn straight, so a pick or pin near a sharp bend can sit very slightly on the other side. The ratio in the readout is always exact for the colour under the caret.
 - Each point shows the most colourful colour sRGB allows at that hue and lightness. Less colourful versions of the same hue and lightness have slightly different luminance, so their contrast can differ a little from the map's.
 - **Territory** is the share of this drawn slice that passes; it is a comparison between grounds, not a count of all possible colours.
-

The figures

- **Contrast ratio** uses the WCAG 2 formula exactly.
 - **APCA** is computed by the page's own implementation of the APCA method. APCA is part of draft work towards WCAG 3 and is not yet a formal requirement; use it as a second opinion.
 - **Vision margin** is based on standard simulation matrices for eight colour vision deficiencies plus simple models of cataracts and low vision. Simulations are a design aid, not a diagnosis, and real people vary.
 - The **Auric SD** score and the **Recommended for** labels are Auric Artisan's own combinations of these measures. They are guidance, not a conformance claim.
-

The index

The five million pairs are random foreground and background colours derived from a seed. Most fail AA; they are a reproducible reference set for citing and testing, not a curated palette.

What it is not

- It is not an accessibility audit of a page. Real text sits on real backgrounds, at particular sizes, sometimes over images or transparency; test the finished design too.
- Passing contrast does not guarantee readability for everyone. Font, size, weight, spacing and context still matter.

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Privacy

What the Accessibility Library computes locally and what uses the network.

Computed in your browser

Everything the page shows — the map, the lines, the picks, your pasted colours, the index records and the browse grid — is computed in your browser. The colours you paste and the grounds you try are not sent anywhere and are not remembered after you leave. This page has no saved list.

The only thing it remembers is whether you dismissed the **Automate this** note, so it stays hidden.

What uses the network

- The page itself and a small description of the corpus are downloaded from auricartisan.com. If the description does not arrive, the page uses the same built-in values and carries on.
- **Copy as CSS** writes only to your clipboard.
- The API section links to other pages; an API key is only needed if you call the API yourself.

Advertising and analytics follow your consent choices. See [Company and legal](#).

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Release notes

User-facing history of the Accessibility Library.

0.9.9 — 5 June 2026

The Accessibility Library was added in release 0.9.9 as part of the library expansion. See the [Changelog](#).

The current page

The page has since been rebuilt around the question "What may I write on this?": a contrast map for any ground, twelve passing picks, a palette audit, and the five-million-pair index for lookup and browsing. The earlier version was a catalogue of pair cards with tabs for inspecting, auditing and exporting; the existing Accessibility Library user guide in the documentation library still describes that version. These changes are not listed as a separate changelog release.

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Related

Libraries, tools and Learn articles that work alongside the Accessibility Library.

Other colour libraries

- [Color Library](#) — 8,192 colours with contrast on white and black.

- [Shade Library](#) — scales with a per-token contrast ladder.
 - [Palette Library](#), [Harmony Library](#) and [Gradient Library](#).
-

Tools

- [Contrast Checker](#) — check one pair in detail.
 - [URL Analyzer](#) — audit a whole page.
 - [Vision Simulation](#) — see images through different kinds of colour vision.
 - [Accessibility Checklist](#).
-

Learn articles

- Accessible Color Design and WCAG Contrast — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color>
 - Color Blindness and Color Vision Deficiency — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-24-color-blindness-cvd>
 - Oklab and Oklch: Modern Perceptual Color Spaces — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces>
-

Guides and API

- The accessibility corpus API guide and the endpoint reference, linked from the page.
- [Public API](#).

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Color Library

What the Color Library is, who it is for, where to find it and how to look up your first colour.

The Color Library is a searchable atlas of 8,192 colours. Every colour in it carries the same set of precomputed data: its values in seven colour notations (HEX, RGB, HSL, CIE L*a*b*, OKLab, OKLCH and CMYK), perceptual measures such as chroma and relative luminance, its contrast ratio against white and against black, how it looks to people with three kinds of colour blindness, and five descriptive labels (emotion, art movement, mood, design usage and design tag). The page headline sums it up: "Eight thousand colours, *measured*."

You can use the atlas in three ways. You can paste a colour you already have, in almost any CSS format, and see the five catalogued colours nearest to it and what each of them can do. You can ask for what a colour has to do, such as "readable on white" or "for typography", and see how many colours are left after each requirement. Or you can browse the whole atlas with a search box, eight filters and six sort orders, then open any colour to read everything the atlas knows about it.

Everything you browse is worked out in your browser from data the page downloads. You can copy a colour in six formats, download it as JSON, SVG or PNG, download the whole filtered set in seven formats, and save colours to a list that stays in your browser and also appears in your Library.

Who it is for

- Designers who arrive with a brand colour and want to know what it is good for before they commit to it.
- Front-end developers who need a colour that passes a contrast threshold and want its value in OKLCH, Lab or HSL.
- Accessibility specialists checking how many colours clear WCAG AA or AAA against white or black.
- Students and colour enthusiasts exploring how hue, lightness and chroma are distributed across a large set.

Where to find it

Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/color/> in a current desktop or mobile browser. It is also listed as **Color Library** ("Color science data") under **Libraries** in the site header's **Learn** menu. No installation or account is needed.

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/color/>. The **Start from a colour you already have** field already holds `#D3AF37`, and its nearest neighbours are shown under it.
2. Replace that value with your own colour, for example `oklch(0.62 0.19 29)` or `rebeccapurple`, and select **Find its neighbours**.
3. Read the five nearest colours, their ΔE distance and their contrast on white and on black.

4. Select one of the neighbours. The **The colour** tab opens with its full record.
 5. Scroll down to **Browse the atlas** and choose **Readable on white** in **Or from what it has to do** to narrow the grid.
 6. Select **Export**, then **CSS variables** under **Style formats** to download the matching colours as a stylesheet.
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What you can do

- Find the five nearest atlas colours to any colour you paste, measured as ΔE in CIE Lab.
 - Filter by seven requirement chips that show, before you select them, how many colours each one would leave.
 - Search by hex, atlas id or label, and filter by hue, lightness, chroma, emotion, art movement, mood, design usage and WCAG level.
 - Sort by hue, lightness, chroma or luminance, or shuffle the grid.
 - Read a colour's contrast on white and black, its colour-blindness simulations, every notation and its nearest neighbours.
 - See histograms of hue, lightness, chroma and contrast for the current set.
 - Copy a colour in six formats; download it as JSON, SVG or PNG.
 - Download the whole filtered set as JSON, CSV, plain text, CSS, SCSS or a Tailwind fragment.
 - Save colours in your browser and find them again in the **Saved** tab and in your Library.
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In this folder

- [docs/](#) — how to use the Color Library.
 - [Getting started](#) — open the page, the screen tour and a first lookup.
 - [Find a colour's nearest neighbours](#) — paste any CSS colour and read the matches.
 - [Choose colours by requirement](#) — the seven requirement chips and their counts.
 - [Browse, search and filter](#) — search, filters, sort, shuffle and the grid.
 - [Read a colour](#) — everything on the **The colour** tab.
 - [Read the statistics](#) — the four histograms on the **Stats** tab.
 - [Copy and export](#) — every copy format and download, with examples.
 - [Save colours](#) — the star, the **Saved** tab and your Library.
 - [Reference](#) — every control, filter, sort, output and message.
 - [Troubleshooting](#) — symptoms, causes and fixes.
 - [FAQ](#) — short answers to common questions.
- [others/](#) — background material.
 - [Glossary](#) — terms used in the Color Library.
 - [Shortcuts](#) — keyboard and pointer actions.
 - [Limits and accuracy](#) — what the figures mean and what they are not.
 - [Related](#) — related libraries, tools and Learn articles.

- **Privacy** — what stays in your browser and what uses the network.
- **Release notes** — user-facing history.

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Color Library documentation

The list of task guides, the reference, troubleshooting and FAQ for the Color Library.

This folder holds the task guides for the Color Library, the full reference of its controls and outputs, and the troubleshooting and FAQ pages. Start with Getting started if you have not used the page before. Go to the Reference when you need the exact threshold behind a filter or the exact text a copy button produces.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	Opening the page, a tour of its sections and tabs, and a first lookup
find-nearest-colours.md	Pasting a colour in any CSS format and reading its five nearest atlas colours
choose-by-requirement.md	The seven requirement chips, what each one tests and how the counts work
browse-search-and-filter.md	Search, filter inside results, the eight filters, sort, shuffle, random and reset
read-a-colour.md	The The colour tab: contrast verdict, colour-blindness values, every notation, neighbours
read-the-statistics.md	The four histograms on the Stats tab
copy-and-export.md	Copy formats, single-colour downloads and bulk downloads, with examples
save-colours.md	Saving with the star, the Saved tab and your Library
reference.md	Every control, filter, sort, output, file name and message
troubleshooting.md	What to do when something does not behave as expected
faq.md	Short answers to common questions

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Getting started

Open the Color Library, learn what each section and tab does, and look up your first colour.

This page takes you through opening the Color Library, what you see on screen, and a first task from start to finish.

Open the page

1. Go to <https://auricartisan.com/library/color/>, or open the **Learn** menu in the site header and select **Color Library** under **Libraries**.
2. Wait for the atlas to load. While it loads, the grid area shows **Loading color atlas....** When it is ready, the grid fills with colour tiles and the counter under it reads, for example, **1–48 of 8,192 colours**.

The page needs a network connection to load the atlas. If loading fails you see **Could not load color atlas** with the reason; see [Troubleshooting](#).

A tour of the screen

The page runs top to bottom in this order.

The heading

The kicker reads **Auric Artisan · Colour** and the headline **Eight thousand colours, measured**. A line under it shows **Atlas 8,192, Spaces 7** and **Every figure precomputed**, and a link, **Read the API reference** →, to the site's public REST API documentation.

Under the heading you may see a note that starts **Automate this**. It names the REST API call that does the same job and how many API credits it costs, links to **API docs**, and has a dismiss button (×). Once you dismiss it, it stays hidden in this browser. API credits are separate from the tool tokens on your account; the note says so and links to the pricing page. See [Public API](#) if you want to automate lookups.

Start from a colour you already have

A text field with a colour swatch beside it, and a **Find its neighbours** button. Paste a colour in any CSS format and the atlas shows its five nearest catalogued colours. The field starts with **#D3AF37**, so results are already showing when the page opens. See [Find a colour's nearest neighbours](#).

Or from what it has to do

A row of seven requirement chips, such as **Readable on white** and **For typography**. Each chip shows the number of colours that would remain if you selected it. A line under the chips gives the running total. See [Choose colours by requirement](#).

Browse the atlas

A search box (**Search by hex (#a6e223) or id...**), a **Shuffle** button and an **Open a random colour** button. Under them, a second search row labelled **Filter inside results**, with a **Clear** button.

The tabs

Five tabs sit under the search rows:

Tab	What it shows
Library	The filters, the sort menu and the grid of colour tiles. Its badge shows how many colours match.
The colour	Everything about the colour you last opened.
Stats	Histograms of hue, lightness, chroma and contrast on white for the matching colours.
Export	Copy and download buttons for the open colour and for every matching colour.
Saved	The colours you have saved in this browser. Its badge shows how many.

The Library tab

- A row of filters: **Hue**, **Lightness**, **Chroma**, **Emotion**, **Art movement**, **AI mood**, **Design usage**, **WCAG** and **Sort by**, followed by **Reset** and **Export visible**.
- The grid. Each tile shows the colour with its hex code, the hex code again in the footer, the colour's emotion label and a star you select to save it.
- A counter under the grid, such as **1–48 of 8,192 colours**, and a **Back to top** button. The grid scrolls continuously; there are no pages to step through.

Your first task: find out what your brand colour is good for

1. In **Start from a colour you already have**, select the text field and type your colour, for example **#76CDF6**.
2. Select **Find its neighbours**, or simply pause typing; the result updates on its own.
3. Read the first cell, labelled **your colour**. It shows your colour's contrast **On white** and **On black**. Values of 4.5:1 or more are marked as passing.
4. Read the five cells after it. Each shows an atlas colour, its ΔE distance from yours (for example **ΔE 1.20 — indistinguishable**) and its own contrast figures.
5. Read the sentence under the cells. It tells you whether colours around yours can carry text on a light page, on a dark page, or neither.
6. Select the closest neighbour. The **The colour** tab opens.
7. Read **What it can carry**. The two specimens show a line of text in the colour on white and on black, with the contrast ratio and a one-sentence verdict.

Result: you know whether your colour can be used for body text on light or dark backgrounds, which catalogued colours are visually the same, and where to read its values in every notation.

Next steps

- **Browse, search and filter** to narrow the 8,192 colours.
- **Copy and export** to take values into your code.
- **Save colours** to keep a shortlist.

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Browse, search and filter

Narrow the 8,192-colour atlas with the two search boxes, eight filters and six sort orders, and move around the grid.

The **Browse the atlas** section and the **Library** tab hold everything you need to narrow the atlas and scan it. This page covers each control in the order you meet it.

Search

The first search box reads **Search by hex (#a6e223) or id...**

1. Select the box, or press **/** anywhere on the page (outside a text field) to jump to it.
2. Type part of a hex code, an atlas id, or a label. The grid updates a moment after you stop typing.

A colour matches when every word you type appears in at least one of these: its hex code, its atlas id, its emotion, its art movement, its mood or its design usage. Matching ignores case and accepts part-words, so **a6e** matches **#A6E223**, and **rom** matches both **romantic** and **Romanticism**.

Note: Ids match as text, so typing **12** also finds ids such as **120**, **1203** and **4812**.

Filter inside results

The second row, **Filter inside results**, has its own box (**hex, emotion, mood, usage...**) and a **Clear** button. It works exactly like the first search box; the words in both boxes are combined, and every word must match. Use it to add a narrowing word without editing the first search. **Clear** empties only this second box.

The eight filters

The filters sit at the top of the **Library** tab. Each is a drop-down list; choose a value to keep only matching colours.

Filter	Options	What it tests
Hue	All hues, Red, Orange, Yellow, Green, Cyan, Blue, Purple, Pink, Neutral / Gray	The colour's HSL hue angle, in fixed ranges (see the Reference). Neutral / Gray keeps colours with very low chroma, and the hue options skip them.
Lightness	Any lightness, Dark (L < 35)**, **Mid (35–70)**, **Light (> 70)	The colour's CIE L* lightness, from 0 (black) to 100 (white).
Chroma	Any chroma, Muted, Balanced, Vivid	The colour's OKLCH chroma: Muted below 0.07, Balanced 0.07 to 0.15, Vivid above 0.15.
Emotion	All emotions and ten labels	The colour's emotion label.
Art movement	All movements and eight movements	The art movement it is associated with.
AI mood	All moods and ten moods	The colour's mood label.
Design usage	All usages and ten usages	The use it was labelled for, such as typography or ui-surface .

Filter	Options	What it tests
WCAG	Any WCAG, AA on white, AAA on white, AA on black, AAA on black	The contrast ratio on white or black: AA is 4.5:1 or more, AAA is 7:1 or more.

All filters combine with AND, and they also combine with the search boxes and the requirement chips.

Note: The **Chroma** filter's bands are not the same as the **Vivid** and **Muted** requirement chips. The chip **Vivid** needs chroma 0.18 or more, the filter **Vivid** needs more than 0.15. Use whichever cut suits you.

Sort

Sort by decides the order of the grid:

Option	Order
Sort: original	The atlas's own order, by id. This is the default.
Hue (rainbow)	By HSL hue, from 0° (red) round to 360°.
Lightness ↑	Darkest first, by OKLCH lightness.
Lightness ↓	Lightest first.
Chroma ↓	Most colourful first.
Luminance ↓	Highest relative luminance first.
Random	A random order.

Shuffle, random and reset

- **Shuffle** sets the sort to **Random** and reorders the grid. Select it again for a new order.
- **Open a random colour** picks any one of the 8,192 colours, ignoring your filters, and opens it on **The colour** tab.
- **Reset** empties both search boxes, sets every filter back to its "all" or "any" option and the sort back to **Sort: original**. It does not clear the requirement chips; select a highlighted chip to turn it off.
- **Export visible** switches to the **Export** tab, where you can download every colour that currently matches. See [Copy and export](#).

Moving around the grid

- The grid scrolls continuously. There are no pages.
- Under the grid, a line such as **1–48 of 2,998 colours** says which colours you are looking at and how many match. When nothing matches it reads **Nothing to show**, and the grid shows **No colors match**

these filters with the hint **Try clearing the search or selecting "Any" on filters.**

- **Back to top** returns to the first colour.
- The **Library** tab's badge shows the number of matching colours.
- Select a tile, or focus it and press **Enter** or **Space**, to open the colour on **The colour** tab.
- Select the star on a tile to save or unsave it without opening it. See [Save colours](#).

Result

The grid shows only the colours that match your chips, searches and filters, in the order you chose, and the counter under it tells you how many there are.

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Choose colours by requirement

Use the seven requirement chips to narrow the atlas by what a colour has to do, and read what each requirement costs.

The **Or from what it has to do** section lets you ask for a job rather than for coordinates. Instead of "hue 199, chroma 0.10", you ask for "readable on white" or "for typography". Each requirement is a chip, and each chip shows how many colours would be left if you selected it, so you can see the cost of one more requirement before you add it.

The seven requirements

Chip	A colour passes when	Colours that pass on their own
Readable on white	Its contrast on white is 4.5:1 or more (WCAG AA for body text).	2,998
Readable on black	Its contrast on black is 4.5:1 or more.	5,344
Vivid	Its OKLCH chroma is 0.18 or more.	2,707
Muted	Its OKLCH chroma is below 0.06.	695
Calm	Its emotion label is calm .	843
For typography	Its design-usage label is typography .	819
As an accent	Its design-tag label is accent .	822

The last column is the number each chip shows when no other chip is selected, out of 8,192.

Steps

1. Scroll to **Or from what it has to do**.
2. Read the numbers on the chips. Each is the count you would get by selecting that chip now.

3. Select a chip, for example **Readable on white**. It is highlighted, and the grid in **Browse the atlas** now shows only colours that pass.
4. Read the line under the chips. It now says, for example, **2,998 of 8,192 colours meet all of it — 36.6%**.
5. Read the other chips again. Their numbers have changed: each now shows how many colours would remain if you added it to the ones already selected.
6. Select a second chip, for example **Vivid**. The grid keeps only colours that pass both.
7. To remove a requirement, select its chip again.

Result: the grid shows only colours that meet every selected requirement, and the line under the chips states how many that is, as a count and a percentage of the atlas.

How the chips combine

- Selected chips combine with AND: a colour must pass every one.
- **Vivid** and **Muted** cannot both be true, so selecting both leaves 0 colours. The chip shows this before you select it.
- The chips work together with everything else in **Browse the atlas**: the search boxes, the eight filters and the sort order. The chips are applied first, then the search and filters.
- The chips' own counts consider only the other chips, not the search or the filters, so the count on a chip can be higher than what the grid shows.
- With nothing selected, the line under the chips reads **8,192 colours. Add a requirement to see what it costs.**

Tip: Selecting **Readable on white** is the reliable way to keep only colours with at least 4.5:1 on white. It applies the same threshold as the WCAG filter's **AA on white** option.

Where the labels come from

Calm, **For typography** and **As an accent** test the descriptive labels each colour carries in the atlas. Those labels were assigned when the atlas was generated; they are a convenience for browsing, not a measurement. The contrast and chroma chips, by contrast, test measured values. See [Limits and accuracy](#).

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Copy and export

Copy one colour in six formats, download it as JSON, SVG or PNG, and download every matching colour in seven formats.

The **Export** tab has two parts: **Selection**, for the one colour you have open, and **Visible set**, for every colour that currently matches your chips, searches and filters. You can reach the tab directly, or select **Export visible** on the **Library** tab.

Copy or download one colour

1. Open a colour (select its tile). See [Read a colour](#).
2. Select the **Export** tab. The first card is headed **Selection** • and the colour's hex code.
3. Under **Copy formats**, select a format. The text goes to your clipboard and a short message confirms it, such as **HEX copied**.
4. Under **Download**, select a file type. Your browser saves the file.

If no colour is open, the card reads **No color selected. Click any tile in the Library tab to enable selection exports**.

Copy formats

Examples are for the atlas colour **#76CDF6**.

Button	What is copied	Example
HEX	The hex code in capitals.	#76CDF6
RGB	A CSS rgb() value with commas.	rgb(118, 205, 246)
HSL	A CSS hsl() value, whole numbers.	hsl(199 88% 71%)
Lab	A CSS lab() value, two decimals.	lab(78.56% -15.21 -28.22)
OKLCH	A CSS oklch() value.	oklch(80.89% 0.102 230.17)
CSS variables	A :root block with four custom properties.	See below

The **CSS variables** button copies:

```
:root {
  --color-hex: #76cdf6;
  --color-rgb: 118, 205, 246;
  --color-hsl: 199 88% 71%;
  --color-oklch: 80.89% 0.102 230.17;
}
```

Downloads for one colour

Button	File	Contents
JSON (full metadata)	The hex code without # , for example 76cdf6.json	The colour's complete record: every notation, metric, label and colour-blindness value.
SVG	For example 76cdf6.svg	A 480 × 280 rectangle of the colour with its hex code written near the bottom in black or white, whichever reads better.
PNG	For example 76cdf6.png	An 800 × 480 image of the same design.

Download every matching colour

1. On the **Library** tab, narrow the grid with the chips, searches and filters.
2. Select **Export visible**, or the **Export** tab.
3. Read the **Visible set** card's badge. It shows how many colours will be exported, for example **2,998 colors**.
4. Select a format under **Bulk download** or **Style formats**. Your browser saves the file.

Files are named `color-library-` followed by the number of colours and the date, for example `color-library-2998-2026-09-24.css`. The message **Downloaded** and the file name confirms each download. If nothing matches, the page says **Nothing to export**.

Bulk formats

Button	File type	Contents
JSON (all metadata)	<code>.json</code>	The export time, a source note, the count, and a list of the colours with the fields the browser holds for them: id, hex, RGB, hue, lightness, chroma, luminance, contrast on white and black, and the five labels.
JSON (compact: id + hex)	<code>.json</code>	The count and a list of id and hex pairs.
CSV (flat)	<code>.csv</code>	Meant to hold one row per colour with a header row: id, hex, RGB, HSL, Lab, OKLCH, luminance, chroma and four labels. If no file arrives, see Troubleshooting .
<code>.txt</code> (one hex per line)	<code>.txt</code>	Hex codes in capitals, one per line.

Style formats

Button	File type	Contents
CSS variables	<code>.css</code>	A <code>:root</code> block with one custom property per colour, named by atlas id.
SCSS variables	<code>.scss</code>	One Sass variable per colour, named by atlas id.
tailwind.config.js fragment	<code>.js</code>	A Tailwind CSS configuration that adds each colour to <code>theme.extend.colors</code> , named <code>c</code> plus the atlas id.

Examples, for a set containing colour 0:

```
:root {
  --color-0: #76CDF6;
}
```

```
$color-0: #76CDF6;
```

```
module.exports = {  
  theme: { extend: { colors: {  
    "c0": "#76CDF6"  
  } } }  
};
```

Tip: Variable names use the atlas id, not a descriptive name. After exporting, rename the variables you keep to names that mean something in your project, such as `--brand-accent`.

Note: Exports are built in your browser from the data already loaded, so they work without a further download. A large set can take a moment.

Result

You have the colour value on your clipboard, or a file on your computer that you can paste into a stylesheet, a Tailwind configuration, a spreadsheet or a design tool.

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Find a colour's nearest neighbours

Paste a colour in any CSS format and read the five catalogued colours closest to it, with their distance and contrast.

The **Start from a colour you already have** section answers the question most people arrive with: "I have this colour — what is it, and what can it do?" It finds the five atlas colours closest to yours and shows what each of them carries.

Steps

1. Select the field under **Start from a colour you already have**. It starts with `#D3AF37`.
2. Replace the value with your colour. You can type or paste it in any of these forms:
 - hex, with or without `#`, in 3, 4, 6 or 8 digits: `#76cdf6`, `76cdf6`, `#abc`;
 - `rgb()` or `rgba()`: `rgb(118 205 246)`, `rgb(118, 205, 246)`;
 - `hsl()` or `hsla()`: `hsl(199 88% 71%)`;
 - `hwb()`: `hwb(199 46% 4%)`;
 - `lab()` and `lch()`: `lab(78.6 -15.2 -28.2)`, `lch(78.6 32 241)`;
 - `oklab()` and `oklch()`: `oklab(0.81 -0.07 -0.08)`, `oklch(0.81 0.1 230)`;
 - `color()` in the `srgb`, `srgb-linear` or `display-p3` space: `color(display-p3 0.5 0.8 0.95)`;
 - any of the 148 CSS colour names, such as `rebeccapurple`;

- three bare numbers read as RGB: **118 205 246**.
3. Select **Find its neighbours**, or stop typing for a moment. The swatch beside the field changes to your colour and the results update.
 4. Read the results (described below).
 5. To learn more about one of the matches, select its cell. The **The colour** tab opens with that colour's full record.

Result: six cells in a row — your colour first, then the five nearest atlas colours in order of distance — and a sentence about the neighbourhood.

Reading the results

The heading line

Nearest in the atlas is followed by a note such as **Read as oklch. Distance is ΔE in CIE Lab; under 2.3 is a difference most eyes will not see.**

- **Read as** names the format the page recognised: **hex**, **named**, **rgb**, **hsl**, **hwb**, **lab**, **lch**, **oklab**, **oklch**, **color(srgb)**, **color(srgb-linear)** or **display-p3**. Check it if the result surprises you.
- If your colour lies outside the sRGB range a screen can show (for example a very saturated **oklch()** or **display-p3** value), the note adds **outside sRGB, brought to the edge of it**. The page moved your colour to the nearest displayable colour before matching, and it tells you so rather than doing it silently.

The cells

Cell	What it shows
First cell	Your colour's hex code, the note your colour , and its contrast On white and On black
Next five cells	An atlas colour's hex code, its distance from yours (for example ΔE 3.41 — a close match), and its contrast On white and On black

Contrast ratios of 4.5:1 or more are marked as passing; lower values are marked as failing. 4.5:1 is the WCAG AA threshold for normal-size text.

The word after each ΔE value describes the size of the difference:

ΔE	Word shown
Under 2.3	indistinguishable
2.3 to under 5	a close match
5 to under 10	visibly different
10 or more	a different colour

ΔE is the straight-line distance between two colours in CIE Lab (the CIE76 formula). A value around 2.3 is often quoted as a just-noticeable difference.

The sentence under the cells

The page averages the five neighbours' contrast and writes one of three sentences:

- **Colours around this one average N:1 on white — it is a colour you can write in on a light page.** The neighbourhood averages at least 4.5:1 on white.
- **Colours around this one average N:1 on white and N:1 on black. This is a colour to draw with on a light page, and to write in on a dark one.** It fails on white but averages at least 4.5:1 on black.
- **Colours around this one clear neither white nor black as body text. It is decoration wherever it lands.**

If the field does not accept your colour

When the text is not a colour the page can read, the results are replaced by: **Not a colour this reads. It takes #76cdf6, rgb(118 205 246), hsl(199 88% 71%), hwb(199 46% 4%), lab(78.6 -15.2 -28.2), lch(78.6 32 241) and the rest of the CSS colour formats.** An empty field shows nothing.

Common causes are a missing closing bracket, a `color()` space other than the three listed above, or a CSS variable such as `var(--brand)`. See [Troubleshooting](#).

Note: Transparency is ignored. A colour with an alpha value, such as `#76cdf680` or `rgb(118 205 246 / 50%)`, is matched as the solid colour.

Tip: Hues in `hsl()`, `hwb()`, `lch()` and `oklch()` can be written in degrees, `rad`, `grad` or `turn`. Percentages work wherever CSS allows them.

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Read a colour

Everything on The colour tab: the contrast verdict, the colour-blindness values, every notation and metric, and the nearest neighbours.

The colour tab shows the full record of one colour. It puts the verdict first — what the colour can carry as text — then the evidence, then the raw numbers.

Open a colour

Any of these opens a colour on **The colour** tab:

- select a tile in the grid, or focus it and press `Enter` or `Space`;
- select one of the five neighbour cells under **Start from a colour you already have**;

- select **Open a random colour**;
- select a tile on the **Saved** tab.

The tab switches straight away; the full record loads a moment later. If you open the tab before choosing a colour, it says **No colour open** with the hint **Pick one from the atlas, or paste a hex above to find its neighbours**.

The identity block

At the top left:

- a large swatch of the colour;
- its hex code in capitals, for example **#76CDF6**;
- a line with **Atlas id** and the id number, followed by the colour's labels (emotion, art movement, mood, design usage and design tag), separated by dots.

The block also shows **Copy** and **Save** buttons. To copy values or save the colour, use the **Export** tab or the star on the colour's tile; see [Troubleshooting](#) if these two buttons do not respond.

What it can carry

Two specimens show the sentence "The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog." written in the colour:

- on a white background, with the contrast ratio and the words **on white**;
- on a black background, with the ratio and **on black**.

Ratios of 4.5:1 or more are marked as passing, lower ratios as failing.

Under the specimens, one sentence sums the colour up:

Situation	Sentence
4.5:1 or more on both	Rare: it carries body text on either ground.
4.5:1 or more on white only	A dark-on-light colour. Use it for text on a light page; on black it disappears.
4.5:1 or more on black only	A light-on-dark colour. It is not a body-text colour on a light page and no weight will make it one — but on black it is one of the strongest in the atlas.
Below 4.5:1 on both	It carries body text on neither white nor black. This is a colour to draw with, not to write in.

Under other eyes

Four chips show the colour as it appears to different kinds of colour vision:

Chip	Note	Meaning
Normal vision	the colour as stored	The colour itself.
Protanopia	red-blind	No working red-sensitive cones.
Deuteranopia	green-blind	No working green-sensitive cones.
Tritanopia	blue-blind	No working blue-sensitive cones.

Each chip shows its hex code. As the page says, "The atlas stores the simulated colour, not a filter over the swatch — so these are values you can copy." You can use these hex codes to check whether two colours in a design stay distinct for colour-blind readers.

Every space, and the metrics

A table of the colour's values:

Row	What it shows
RGB	Red, green and blue, each 0 to 255.
HSL	Hue in degrees, saturation and lightness as percentages.
CIE L*a*b*	Lightness L (0 to 100) and the a (green to red) and b (blue to yellow) axes.
OKLab	The same idea in the newer OKLab space: L, a and b.
OKLCH	OKLab as lightness L, chroma C and hue h in degrees.
CMYK	Cyan, magenta, yellow and black, as percentages.
Relative luminance	How much light the colour gives off, from 0 (black) to 1 (white). Contrast ratios are built from this.
Chroma	Colourfulness, as OKLCH chroma.
Vividness	A precomputed measure of how vivid the colour is.
Perceptual uniformity	A precomputed score stored with the colour.

Values are shown to two, four or more decimal places. A dash means the value is not in the record.

Nearest in the atlas

The last block shows the five atlas colours closest to this one, each with its hex code and its distance, for example **ΔE 2.10 — indistinguishable**. The distance words mean the same as in [Find a colour's nearest neighbours](#).

Result

You know whether the colour can carry body text on white or black, what it becomes for red-, green- and blue-blind readers, its value in every notation, and which catalogued colours are near it.

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Read the statistics

Use the four histograms on the Stats tab to see how hue, lightness, chroma and contrast are spread across the colours you have filtered.

The **Stats** tab draws four histograms of the colours that currently match your chips, searches and filters. A histogram splits a range of values into equal bands and counts how many colours fall in each band, so you can see at a glance where a set is crowded and where it is thin.

Steps

1. Narrow the grid on the **Library** tab, or leave it unfiltered to see the whole atlas.
2. Select the **Stats** tab.
3. Read the four cards. Each card's heading carries a badge with the number of colours it describes.
4. Select a card's heading to fold it away, and again to unfold it.

Result: four bar charts that describe the set you filtered.

The four histograms

Card	Range	Bands	What it tells you
Hue (HSL)	0° to 360°	12 bands of 30°	Which hue families the set contains.
Lightness (Lab L*)	0 to 100	10 bands of 10	How dark or light the set is.
Chroma	0 to 0.40	10 bands of 0.04	How muted or colourful the set is.
Contrast on white	1:1 to 21:1	10 bands of 2	How much of the set can be used as text on white.

Each row shows the band's range, a bar scaled to the fullest band, and the count. Values beyond the last band are counted in it.

Keeping it up to date

The histograms are drawn when you open the tab. If you change a search or a chip while the tab is open, select the **Stats** tab again to redraw them.

If nothing matches your filters, the tab shows **No colors** and **Adjust filters to populate histograms**.

Example

Select the chip **Readable on white**, then open **Stats**. The **Contrast on white** card shows no colours below 4.5:1, and the **Lightness (Lab L*)** card shows every colour in the bands below 50 — a colour has to be fairly dark to carry text on white.

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Save colours

Save colours with the star, find them on the Saved tab, and reach them again from your Library.

You can keep a shortlist of atlas colours. Saved colours are listed on the **Saved** tab and are also copied into your Library, the site-wide collection of things you save from any tool.

Save a colour

1. Find the colour's tile in the grid.
2. Select the empty star (☆) in the tile's footer. It becomes a filled star (★), and the **Saved** tab's badge goes up by one.

Selecting the star does not open the colour, so you can save several colours in a row while you scan the grid.

See your saved colours

1. Select the **Saved** tab.
2. Your saved colours appear as tiles, in the atlas's own order.
3. Select a tile to open it on **The colour** tab, or select its star to unsave it.

A note above the tiles says they are **Also saved to your Library workspace with image previews**, with a link.

When you have saved nothing, the tab says **No saved colors yet** and explains how to save one.

Remove a colour

Select the filled star (★) on the colour's tile, in the grid or on the **Saved** tab. The star empties, the tile leaves the **Saved** tab, and the copy in your Library is removed too.

Your saved colours in your Library

Each saved colour is also added to your Library as a colour item named by its hex code, with its emotion and art movement as the description and a picture of the colour as the preview. In the Library you can browse it

alongside palettes, gradients and other items you have saved from the rest of the site.

Open your Library from any page with **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **L**, or through the link on the **Saved** tab. See the [Library Kit docs](#).

Where saves are kept

Saved colours are kept in this browser. They stay after you close the tab, but they are not tied to your account and do not appear in another browser or on another device. Clearing this site's data in your browser removes them. See [Privacy](#).

Result

The colours you care about are one tab away on the Color Library, and also in your Library next to everything else you have saved.

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Color Library reference

Every control, filter, sort order, tab, output, file name and message in the Color Library.

This page lists everything on <https://auricartisan.com/library/color/>. For step-by-step help, see the task guides in this folder.

Heading

Item	What it shows or does
Kicker	Auric Artisan · Colour
Headline	Eight thousand colours, measured.
Atlas	The number of colours: 8,192.
Spaces	7 (HEX, RGB, HSL, CIE L*a*b*, OKLab, OKLCH, CMYK).
Every figure precomputed	The figures come stored with each colour.
Read the API reference →	Opens the site's API documentation at https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/api/ .
Automate this note	Names the API call for the same job and its credit cost; links to API docs ; can be dismissed.

Start from a colour you already have

Control	What it does	Values	Default
Colour field	Takes a colour in any CSS format; results update as you type.	Hex (3, 4, 6, 8 digits), <code>rgb()</code> , <code>hsl()</code> , <code>hwb()</code> , <code>lab()</code> , <code>lch()</code> , <code>oklab()</code> , <code>oklch()</code> , <code>color()</code> (<code>srgb</code> , <code>srgb-linear</code> , <code>display-p3</code>), 148 CSS names, three bare numbers	#D3AF37
Swatch	Shows the colour the field was read as.	—	—
Find its neighbours	Runs the match now.	—	—
Result cells	Your colour, then the five nearest atlas colours with ΔE and contrast. Select a neighbour to open it.	—	—
Neighbourhood sentence	One of three verdicts on whether nearby colours carry text.	—	—

ΔE words

ΔE (CIE76)	Word
Under 2.3	indistinguishable
2.3 to under 5	a close match
5 to under 10	visibly different
10 or more	a different colour

Or from what it has to do

Chip	Test	Count alone
Readable on white	Contrast on white 4.5:1 or more	2,998
Readable on black	Contrast on black 4.5:1 or more	5,344
Vivid	OKLCH chroma 0.18 or more	2,707
Muted	OKLCH chroma below 0.06	695
Calm	Emotion label <code>calm</code>	843
For typography	Design usage <code>typography</code>	819
As an accent	Design tag <code>accent</code>	822

Chips combine with AND. Each chip's number is what would remain if you toggled it. The line under the chips reports the matching count and its percentage of 8,192.

Browse the atlas

Control	What it does	Default
Search by hex (#a6e223) or id...	Every word must match the hex, id, emotion, art movement, mood or design usage. Part-words match.	Empty
Shuffle	Sets the sort to Random .	—
Open a random colour	Opens any colour from the whole atlas.	—
Filter inside results box	A second search, combined with the first.	Empty
Clear	Empties the Filter inside results box.	—

Tabs

Tab	Badge	Contents
Library	Number of matching colours	Filters, sort, grid.
The colour	—	The open colour's full record.
Stats	—	Four histograms of the matching colours.
Export	—	Selection and visible-set exports.
Saved	Number of saved colours	Your saved colours.

Filters (Library tab)

Filter	Options	Test
Hue	All hues	No test.
	Red	HSL hue 340° to under 20°
	Orange	20° to under 50°
	Yellow	50° to under 80°
	Green	80° to under 160°
	Cyan	160° to under 200°
	Blue	200° to under 260°
	Purple	260° to under 300°
	Pink	300° to under 340°

Filter	Options	Test
	Neutral / Gray	OKLCH chroma below 0.04 (the hue options above need 0.04 or more)
Lightness	Any lightness, Dark (L < 35)** , **Mid (35–70)** , **Light (> 70)	CIE L*
Chroma	Any chroma, Muted (below 0.07), Balanced (0.07 to 0.15), Vivid (above 0.15)	OKLCH chroma
Emotion	All emotions , calm, cheerful, cool, elegant, energetic, melancholy, mysterious, playful, romantic, warm	Emotion label
Art movement	All movements , Art Deco, Bauhaus, De Stijl, Fauvism, Impressionism, Minimalism, Pop Art, Romanticism	Art movement label
AI mood	All moods , dark, dreamy, futuristic, industrial, intense, joyful, luxurious, nostalgic, organic, serene	Mood label
Design usage	All usages , data-viz, gradient-end, gradient-start, icon-fill, illustration, packaging, shadow, typography, ui-surface, web-hero	Design usage label
WCAG	Any WCAG, AA on white, AAA on white, AA on black, AAA on black	AA: 4.5:1 or more; AAA: 7:1 or more

The design tag (CTA, accent, background, earth-tone, jewel-tone, muted, neutral, pastel, primary, vibrant) has no filter of its own; the **As an accent** chip tests one of its values.

Sort by

Option	Order
Sort: original	By atlas id (default).
Hue (rainbow)	By HSL hue, ascending.
Lightness ↑	By OKLCH lightness, darkest first.
Lightness ↓	Lightest first.
Chroma ↓	Highest chroma first.
Luminance ↓	Highest relative luminance first.
Random	Shuffled.

Library tab buttons and grid

Control	What it does
Reset	Empties both searches, resets every filter and sets Sort: original . Chips are kept.
Export visible	Opens the Export tab.

Control	What it does
Tile	Shows the colour and hex; select it, or press Enter or Space on it, to open the colour.
Tile footer	Hex code, emotion label, save star (☆ to save, ★ to unsave).
Range line	For example 1–48 of 8,192 colours; Nothing to show when empty.
Back to top	Scrolls the grid to its first colour.

The colour tab

Block	Contents
Identity	Swatch, hex, Atlas id and labels; Copy and Save buttons.
What it can carry	Text specimens on white and black with ratios; a one-sentence verdict.
Under other eyes	Normal vision , Protanopia (red-blind), Deutanopia (green-blind), Tritanopia (blue-blind), each with a hex code.
Every space, and the metrics	RGB , HSL , CIE L*a*b* , OKLab , OKLCH , CMYK , Relative luminance , Chroma , Vividness , Perceptual uniformity .
Nearest in the atlas	Five nearest colours with ΔE and a word.

Stats tab

Card	Range	Bands
Hue (HSL)	0° to 360°	12
Lightness (Lab L*)	0 to 100	10
Chroma	0 to 0.40	10
Contrast on white	1:1 to 21:1	10

Select a card's heading to fold or unfold it.

Export tab

Selection

Group	Button	Output
Copy formats	HEX	#76CDF6 style
	RGB	rgb(118, 205, 246) style
	HSL	hsl(199 88% 71%) style

Group	Button	Output
	Lab	lab(78.56% -15.21 -28.22) style
	OKLCH	oklch(80.89% 0.102 230.17) style
	CSS variables	:root block with --color-hex, --color-rgb, --color-hsl, --color-oklch
Download	JSON (full metadata)	<hex>.json
	SVG	<hex>.svg, 480 × 280
	PNG	<hex>.png, 800 × 480

Visible set

Group	Button	File
Bulk download	JSON (all metadata)	color-library-<count>-<date>.json
	JSON (compact: id + hex)	color-library-<count>-<date>.json
	CSV (flat)	color-library-<count>-<date>.csv
	.txt (one hex per line)	color-library-<count>-<date>.txt
Style formats	CSS variables	color-library-<count>-<date>.css (--color-<id>)
	SCSS variables	color-library-<count>-<date>.scss (\$color-<id>)
	tailwind.config.js fragment	color-library-<count>-<date>.js (c<id>)

Messages

Message	When
Loading color atlas...	While the atlas loads.
Could not load color atlas	The atlas failed to load; the reason follows.
No colors match these filters	Nothing matches; with the hint Try clearing the search or selecting "Any" on filters.
Not a colour this reads.	The colour field could not read your text.
No colour open	The colour tab before any colour is opened.
No color selected.	Export before any colour is opened.
No colors	Stats with nothing matching.
No saved colors yet	Saved with nothing saved.
HEX copied, RGB copied, HSL copied, Lab copied, OKLCH copied, CSS variables copied	After a copy.

Message	When
Downloaded and a file name	After a bulk download.
PNG downloaded	After a PNG download.
Could not encode PNG	The browser could not make the PNG.
Nothing to export	A bulk export with no matching colours.

Keyboard

Key	Action
/	Focus the main search box (when not typing in a field).
Enter or Space	Open the focused tile.
Tab	Move between controls and tiles.

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Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes for problems in the Color Library.

"Could not load color atlas"

Why: The page downloads the atlas when it opens. The download failed — usually because the network connection dropped, a content blocker stopped it, or the site was opened from an old offline copy.

What to do: Check your connection, allow auricartisan.com in any content blocker, and reload the page.

"Not a colour this reads."

Why: The text in **Start from a colour you already have** is not a colour format the page understands.

What to do:

- Check brackets and separators: `rgb(118 205 246)` or `rgb(118, 205, 246)`.
- Use one of the supported `color()` spaces: `srgb`, `srgb-linear` or `display-p3`.
- Replace a CSS variable such as `var(--brand)` with its actual value.
- Remove anything after the colour, such as a trailing semicolon or comment.

My colour shows "outside sRGB"

Why: The colour you entered, for example a strong `oklch()` or `display-p3` value, cannot be shown on a standard sRGB screen. The page brings it to the nearest displayable colour before matching.

What to do: Nothing is wrong. The matches are for the nearest displayable version of your colour. If you need a colour inside sRGB, use one of the neighbours.

"No colors match these filters"

Why: Your requirement chips, search words and filters together exclude every colour. For example, **Vivid** and **Muted** together always leave nothing, and **Neutral / Gray** with **Vivid** chroma does too.

What to do: Select **Reset** to clear the searches and filters, then turn off the highlighted requirement chips one at a time until colours return. The count on each chip shows what turning it off would give you.

The WCAG filter "AA on white" shows no colours

Why: On the current page, this option can return no colours even though thousands of colours reach 4.5:1 on white.

What to do: Set **WCAG** back to **Any WCAG** and select the **Readable on white** requirement chip instead. It applies the same 4.5:1 threshold. **AAA on white**, **AA on black** and **AAA on black** work as described.

CSV (flat) does not download

Why: On the current page, the **CSV (flat)** bulk export may produce no file.

What to do: Use **JSON (all metadata)** for the full set of fields, or **.txt (one hex per line)** for a plain list, and convert it in your spreadsheet or code.

The Copy and Save buttons on The colour tab do nothing

Why: On the current page these two buttons may not respond.

What to do: To copy the colour, open the **Export** tab and use the **Copy formats** buttons under **Selection**. To save it, select the star on its tile in the grid.

The nearest colours on The colour tab cannot be opened

Why: The five cells under **Nearest in the atlas** on **The colour** tab show values only.

What to do: Copy the hex code into **Start from a colour you already have**; the cells there open the colour when selected. Or search for the hex code in **Search by hex (#a6e223) or id...**

The Stats tab does not reflect my latest filter

Why: The histograms are drawn when the tab is opened.

What to do: Select the **Stats** tab again to redraw them.

Searching for an id finds many colours

Why: Ids are matched as text, so **12** also matches **120**, **312**, **4812** and so on.

What to do: Scroll to the colour whose id you want, or add a second word such as part of its hex code.

My saved colours have disappeared

Why: Saved colours are kept in this browser only. They are lost if you clear this site's data, use a private window, or switch browser or device.

What to do: Save them again. To keep a permanent copy, export them: filter the grid down to them and use **Export visible**, or keep them in your Library.

Copy does not reach the clipboard

Why: Some browsers block clipboard access on pages that are not in focus, or when a permission is denied.

What to do: Click inside the page and try again. If your browser asks for clipboard permission, allow it.

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Color Library FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Color Library.

How many colours are in the atlas?

8,192. The number never changes as you filter; the counters show how many of the 8,192 match.

Does it cover every colour?

No. The atlas is a fixed, generated set of 8,192 colours spread across the sRGB range. Your exact colour may not be in it, which is why **Start from a colour you already have** finds the nearest ones.

Which contrast formula does it use?

The WCAG 2 contrast ratio, from 1:1 to 21:1, measured against pure white (`#FFFFFF`) and pure black (`#000000`). 4.5:1 is the AA threshold for normal body text and 7:1 is AAA.

What is ΔE ?

A number for how different two colours look. The Color Library uses CIE76, the straight-line distance between two colours in CIE Lab. Under about 2.3, most people cannot see a difference.

Can I test a colour against a background other than white or black?

Not in the Color Library. Use the Contrast Checker or the Accessibility Library for any pair of colours. See [Related](#).

Are the emotion, mood and art-movement labels scientific?

No. They are descriptive labels assigned when the atlas was generated, useful for browsing by feel. The contrast, luminance and chroma figures are measurements.

Do I need an account?

No. Everything works signed out. Saved colours stay in your browser.

Can I use the colours commercially?

Colour values themselves are not ownable. For the terms that apply to the site and its content, see [Company and legal](#).

Is there an API?

Yes. The heading links to the site's API reference, and the **Automate this** note names the API call that does the same job. See [Public API](#).

Does it work offline?

It needs a connection to load the atlas. Once loaded, filtering, sorting and exporting happen in your browser. Opening a colour's full record may fetch a little more data.

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Color Library: other material

Supporting material for the Color Library: glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages, privacy and release notes.

This folder holds the background material for the Color Library: the terms it uses, its keyboard actions, what its figures mean and do not mean, where to go next, what it stores, and its history.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Colour terms used on the page, from chroma to ΔE .
Shortcuts	Keyboard and pointer actions.
Limits and accuracy	What the atlas measures, how, and what it is not.
Related	Related libraries, tools and Learn articles.
Privacy	What stays in your browser and what uses the network.
Release notes	User-facing history of the Color Library.

Back to the [Color Library overview](#).

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Color Library shortcuts

Keyboard and pointer actions in the Color Library.

Keyboard

Keys	Where	Result
/	Anywhere, when you are not typing in a field	Moves the cursor to Search by hex (#a6e223) or id...
Enter or Space	A focused tile in the grid	Opens the colour on The colour tab.
Tab	Anywhere	Moves between controls, chips and tiles.

Pointer

Action	Result
Select a tile	Opens the colour.
Select a tile's star	Saves or unsaves the colour without opening it.
Select a neighbour under Start from a colour you already have	Opens that colour.
Select a card heading on Stats	Folds or unfolds the card.

Action	Result
Pause typing in the colour field	Updates the nearest matches without pressing Find its neighbours .

The site-wide shortcuts also work on this page. See [Site features](#).

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Color Library glossary

Definitions of the colour terms used in the Color Library.

Term	Meaning
AA, AAA	WCAG contrast levels. For normal-size text, AA needs a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 and AAA at least 7:1.
Atlas	The fixed set of 8,192 colours the Color Library holds.
Atlas id	A colour's number in the atlas, from 0 to 8,191.
Chroma	How colourful a colour is, compared with a grey of the same lightness. The page uses OKLCH chroma, which runs from 0 (grey) to about 0.4 for the most vivid screen colours.
CIE L*a*b* (Lab)	A colour space designed so that equal distances look roughly like equal differences. L is lightness (0 to 100); a runs from green to red; b from blue to yellow.
CIE76	The simplest ΔE formula: the straight-line distance between two colours in Lab.
CMYK	Cyan, magenta, yellow and black: the four inks of process printing. The values are a simple conversion, not a print profile.
Colour vision deficiency (CVD)	Reduced ability to tell some colours apart, often called colour blindness.
Contrast ratio	The WCAG 2 measure of how much two colours differ in brightness, from 1:1 (none) to 21:1 (black on white).
Deuteranopia	A form of colour blindness with no working green-sensitive cones ("green-blind").
ΔE (delta E)	A number for how different two colours look. Under about 2.3 is usually invisible.
Hue	The kind of colour — red, yellow, blue and so on — given as an angle from 0° to 360°.
HSL	Hue, saturation and lightness: a simple rearrangement of RGB used in CSS.
Lightness	How light or dark a colour looks. The page uses CIE L* (0 to 100) for the Lightness filter and OKLCH L (0 to 1) for sorting.
OKLab, OKLCH	A modern perceptual colour space (2020). OKLCH expresses OKLab as lightness, chroma and hue, and is supported in CSS as <code>oklch()</code> .
Protanopia	A form of colour blindness with no working red-sensitive cones ("red-blind").
Relative luminance	How much light a colour gives off, from 0 (black) to 1 (white), weighted for human vision. Contrast ratios are built from it.

Term	Meaning
Requirement chip	One of the seven buttons under Or from what it has to do , such as Readable on white .
sRGB	The standard colour space of the web and most screens. Every atlas colour is inside it.
Tritanopia	A rare form of colour blindness with no working blue-sensitive cones ("blue-blind").
WCAG	The Web Content Accessibility Guidelines, the international standard for accessible web content.

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Limits and accuracy

What the Color Library's figures measure, how precisely, and what they are not.

What is measured

- **Contrast ratios** use the WCAG 2 formula against pure white and pure black. They are exact for those two backgrounds, rounded to two decimals. They say nothing about any other background.
- **Relative luminance, Lab, OKLab, OKLCH and HSL** are standard conversions from each colour's sRGB value, assuming a D65 white point.
- **CMYK** is a simple arithmetic conversion. It is not a print separation and does not account for paper, ink or a print profile. Use a proper colour-managed workflow for print.
- **Colour-blindness values** are simulations of complete protanopia, deuteranopia and tritanopia. People with milder colour vision deficiencies see something between the original and the simulation. Simulations are a design aid, not a diagnosis.

How distance is measured

- **ΔE** in the Color Library is CIE76: the straight-line distance in Lab. It is fast enough to recompute as you type, and the page names it so it is not mistaken for a newer formula. CIE76 over-states differences between very saturated colours compared with CIEDE2000, so treat the words **a close match** and **visibly different** as guides.
- The 2.3 threshold for **indistinguishable** is a commonly quoted just-noticeable difference for CIE76, not a guarantee for every viewer or screen.

What the labels are

The emotion, art movement, mood, design usage and design tag labels were assigned when the atlas was generated. They are descriptive aids for browsing. They are not survey data and do not describe how any particular audience responds to a colour.

The atlas is a sample

The atlas holds 8,192 colours, not every colour. A colour you need may sit between two atlas colours. Counts and percentages (for example "36.6% of colours are readable on white") describe the atlas, not all possible colours.

Your screen

What you see depends on your display, its settings and the room's light. The numbers are the same on every screen; the swatches are not. Colours you enter outside sRGB are moved to the nearest sRGB colour before matching, and the page tells you when it does this.

What the Color Library is not

- It is not an accessibility audit. A passing contrast ratio is one requirement among many; text size, weight, focus styles and context also matter.
- It is not a certified colour measurement. Nothing here replaces a spectrophotometer or a calibrated proof.

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Privacy

What the Color Library keeps in your browser and what it fetches over the network.

What stays in your browser

What	Why	How to remove it
Saved colours	To fill the Saved tab and mark stars on tiles.	Unsave each colour, or clear this site's data.
A copy of each saved colour in your Library	So saved colours appear alongside your other saved items.	Unsave the colour, or remove it in the Library.
Whether you dismissed the Automate this note	So it stays hidden.	Clear this site's data.

The colours you type into **Start from a colour you already have**, your searches, filters and chip choices are worked out in your browser and are not sent anywhere. They are not remembered after you leave the page.

What uses the network

- When the page opens, it downloads the atlas from auricartisan.com.
- When you open a colour, it may download that colour's full record from auricartisan.com.

- Downloads you make (JSON, SVG, PNG, CSS and so on) are created in your browser and saved straight to your device.
- Copying writes to your device's clipboard only.

The page can show advertising, and the site's analytics run only with your consent. See [Company and legal](#) for the privacy policy and your consent choices.

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Release notes

User-facing history of the Color Library.

0.9.9 — 5 June 2026

The Color Library was added to the site as part of the library expansion in release 0.9.9, alongside the Palette, Gradient, Harmony, Shade and Accessibility libraries and the Font and Icon libraries. See the release entry on the [Changelog](#).

The current page

The page as documented here opens with three routes into the atlas — **Start from a colour you already have**, **Or from what it has to do** and **Browse the atlas** — and gathers everything about one colour on a single tab, **The colour**. The changelog does not list these changes as a separate release.

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Related

Libraries, tools and Learn articles that work alongside the Color Library.

Other colour libraries

- [Palette Library](#) — sets of colours that work together.
- [Shade Library](#) — one colour taken through lightness, for design-system scales.
- [Accessibility Library](#) — foreground and background pairs scored for contrast against any ground, not only white and black.
- [Harmony Library](#) and [Gradient Library](#).

Tools

- [Contrast Checker](#) — test any two colours against each other.
- [Vision Simulation](#) — see whole images as people with colour vision deficiencies do.
- [Basic Tools](#) — pickers, converters and palette tools.

- **Your Library** — where saved colours also appear.
-

Learn articles

- CIELAB and LCH Explained — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-24-cielab-and-lch-explained>
 - Oklab and Oklch: Modern Perceptual Color Spaces — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces>
 - Accessible Color Design and WCAG Contrast — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color>
 - Color Blindness and Color Vision Deficiency — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-24-color-blindness-cvd>
 - ΔE Metrics from CIE76 to CIEDE2000 and ΔE_{ITP} — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-26-delta-e-metrics-cie76-ciede2000-itp>
 - Color in CSS: Modern Color in the Browser — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-07-16-color-in-css-modern-color-in-the-browser>
 - Color Naming and Categorical Perception — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-18-color-naming-and-categorical-perception>
-

API

- **Public API** — look up atlas colours from your own code.

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Gradient Library

What the Gradient Library is, who it is for, where to find it, and how to check your own gradient and export one from the collection.

The Gradient Library is a collection of 8,192 generated colour gradients, each with its colour stops, the colour space it was blended in, its easing, a quality score and — the thing a thumbnail cannot show — a measured verdict on whether it bands. The page headline puts it plainly: "Eight thousand ramps, *and which of them band.*" About 77% of the collection is measured as smooth.

Banding is when a gradient that should flow shows visible steps or a hard edge. It often happens at the dark end of a ramp, or where two stops are far apart in lightness. The library measures every gradient for it, lets you filter by the verdict, and — through **Will your gradient band?** at the top of the page — applies the same measurement to any stops you type in. That makes the collection useful not only to shop from, but to check your own work against.

For any gradient in the collection you can read its stops and metrics, preview it under four kinds of colour vision deficiency and low vision, test text colours on top of it, and take it away as CSS, a CSS class, JSON, SVG, PNG, a Tailwind token or design tokens for eight platforms, or as a share link.

Who it is for

- Designers and front-end developers choosing a gradient for a hero, button or background.
- Anyone who has a gradient already and wants to know whether it will band before shipping it.
- Accessibility specialists checking whether text on a gradient stays readable across the whole ramp.
- Students learning how interpolation space and easing change a blend.

Where to find it

Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/gradient/> in a current browser. It is also listed as **Gradient Library** ("Perceptual gradients") under **Libraries** in the site header's **Learn** menu. No account is needed.

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/gradient/>.
2. In **Will your gradient band?**, read the verdict for the starting ramp (black, navy, white): it steps at the dark end.
3. Replace the stops with your own colours, in any CSS format, and read the new verdict.
4. Scroll to **Browse the collection** and set **Banding** to **Low banding risk**.
5. Select a card to open it on the **Inspect** tab.
6. Select **Copy CSS** and paste the `linear-gradient(...)` into your stylesheet.
7. Open the **Pair** tab and check that your text colour passes across the whole gradient.

What you can do

- Measure any gradient you type in for banding, and see where its worst step is.
- Browse, search and filter 8,192 gradients by method, scheme, complexity, number of stops, interpolation space, easing, score and banding.
- Sort by score, complexity, number of stops or dominant hue, or shuffle.
- Inspect a gradient's stops, CSS and generator metrics.
- Preview it under deuteranopia, protanopia, tritanopia, achromatopsia and low vision.
- Measure contrast across 17 points of the ramp, and test any text colour over it.
- Explore the collection by tags, and read distributions on the **Stats** tab.
- Copy CSS; download a CSS class, JSON, SVG, PNG or Tailwind token; export design tokens; share a link.
- Save gradients in your browser and your Library, and download whole filtered sets.

In this folder

- [docs/](#) — how to use the Gradient Library.
 - [Getting started](#), [Check your own gradient](#), [Browse, search and filter](#), [Inspect a gradient](#), [Test vision, contrast and text](#), [Tags and statistics](#), [Copy, export and share](#), [Save gradients](#), [Reference](#), [Troubleshooting](#), [FAQ](#).
- [others/](#) — background material.
 - [Glossary](#), [Shortcuts](#), [Limits and accuracy](#), [Related](#), [Privacy](#), [Release notes](#).

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Gradient Library documentation

The task guides, reference, troubleshooting and FAQ for the Gradient Library.

This folder holds the task guides for the Gradient Library, the full reference of its controls and outputs, and the troubleshooting and FAQ pages.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	Opening the page, a tour of the screen, and a first gradient from check to export.
check-your-gradient.md	Will your gradient band? : entering stops, reading the verdict and fixing a step.
browse-search-and-filter.md	Searching, the eight filters, sorting, cards and the grid.
inspect-a-gradient.md	The Inspect tab: preview, quick facts, CSS, stops and generator metrics.
test-vision-contrast-and-text.md	The Vision , Accessibility and Pair tabs.
tags-and-statistics.md	The Tags and Stats tabs.
copy-export-and-share.md	Every copy, download, design-token and share option, one gradient or many.
save-gradients.md	Saving, the Saved tab and your Library.
reference.md	Every control, option, output, file name and message.
troubleshooting.md	Symptoms, causes and fixes.
faq.md	Short answers.

[Back to the Gradient Library overview.](#)

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Getting started

Open the Gradient Library, learn what each part of the screen does, and check, pick and export a first gradient.

Open the page

1. Go to <https://auricartisan.com/library/gradient/>, or open the **Learn** menu in the site header and select **Gradient Library** under **Libraries**.
2. While the collection loads, the grid area shows **Loading gradient library...**
3. When it is ready, the grid fills with gradient cards and the counter under the grid reads, for example, **1–24 of 8,192**.

If loading fails you see **Could not load gradient library** and the reason. See [Troubleshooting](#).

A tour of the screen

The heading

The kicker reads **Auric Artisan · Gradient** and the headline **Eight thousand ramps, and which of them band**. The line under it shows **Collection 8,192, Smooth 77%** and **Measured in OKLab**, and a link, **Read the API guide** →, to the Gradient Library's API guide.

A note starting **Automate this** may appear. It says browsing the collection is also available through the site's REST API — **3 API credits per call to GET /v1/gradient/library** — and links to **API docs**. Select × to dismiss it.

Will your gradient band?

A row of colour stops, each with a colour swatch you can click to pick a colour and a text field you can type into, plus **Add a stop** and **Measure it**. Under them, the verdict for the ramp: a preview strip with a marker at the worst step, a word (**Smooth**, **Some compression** or **It will step**) and the numbers behind it. See [Check your own gradient](#).

Browse the collection

A search box (**Search by name, hex or scheme...**), **Shuffle**, **Open a random gradient**, and a second search row, **Filter inside results**, with **Clear**.

The tabs

Tab	What it shows
Library	Filters, sort and the gradient grid. The badge shows how many gradients match.
Inspect	The gradient you last opened: preview, facts, CSS, stops, metrics and quick exports.
Vision	The open gradient under five kinds of vision.
Accessibility	Contrast measured across the open gradient.
Pair	A text colour tested over the open gradient.
Tags	Every method, scheme, complexity, interpolation space, easing and banding value, with counts.
Stats	Distributions for the gradients that match your filters.
Export	Exports for the open gradient and for every matching gradient.
Saved	Gradients you have saved. The badge shows how many.

A card

Each card shows the gradient as a large preview with its name (for example **Aurora Simple #00001**), its scheme and interpolation space, and its score in the corner. Under the preview, a strip of its stops. The footer

has a banding chip (**Smooth**, **Compresses** or **Steps**), the number of stops, and two buttons: **CSS** (copy the CSS) and **Save**.

Your first task: choose a smooth gradient for a hero banner with white text

1. In **Browse the collection**, set **Banding** to **Low banding risk**.
2. Set **Stops** to **2 to 4 stops** for a simple ramp.
3. Scan the cards and select one you like. The **Inspect** tab opens.
4. Open the **Pair** tab. The text colour starts as white.
5. Read **Status**. If it says **Passes AA in every sampled region**, white body text is readable across the whole gradient.
6. If it does not, try **Black**, or go back and pick a darker gradient.
7. Return to **Inspect** and select **Copy CSS**.
8. Paste the value into your stylesheet as the banner's **background**.

Result: a gradient measured as smooth, with a text colour that passes AA everywhere on it, in your stylesheet.

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Browse, search and filter

Narrow 8,192 gradients by search, method, scheme, complexity, stops, interpolation, easing, score and banding, and sort the results.

Search

The box **Search by name, hex or scheme...** filters as you type. Every word must appear in at least one of these: the gradient's name, its type, its angle, any stop's hex code, its scheme, method, complexity, interpolation space, easing or banding label.

Examples:

- **aurora** — gradients of the Aurora scheme.
- **#7b36** — gradients with a stop whose hex starts **7B36**.
- **oklch smooth** — gradients blended in an OKLCH space and measured as smooth.

The **Filter inside results** row has its own box (**name, hex, scheme...**) and a **Clear** button. Its words are combined with the first box's.

Press **/** anywhere outside a text field to jump to the search box.

Filters

All filters sit on the **Library** tab and combine with each other and with the search.

Filter	Options	Meaning
Method	All methods and twelve methods: Analogous, Aurora, Chaotic, Complementary, Duotone, Golden, Monochrome, Nebula, Prismatic, Spectral, Terrain, Thermal	How the gradient's colours were chosen.
Scheme	All schemes and the same twelve names	The scheme family, which also forms the first word of each gradient's name.
Complexity	Any complexity, Simple, Detailed, Extreme	How elaborate the gradient is.
Stops	Any stops, 2 to 4 stops, 5 to 8 stops, 9 to 16 stops, 17 to 32 stops, 33+ stops	Number of colour stops. The collection ranges from 2 to 46.
Interpolation	Any interpolation, Lch Short, Linear Rgb, Oklab, Oklch Long, Oklch Short	The colour space the stops were blended in when the gradient was generated.
Easing	Any easing, Cubic In Out, Linear, Quart In Out, Sine In Out, Smootherstep	How the blend accelerates between stops.
Score	Any score, Top quality (0.70 or more), Balanced+ (0.55 or more), Wild / experimental (below 0.55)	The gradient's quality score, from 0 to 1.
Banding	Any banding, Low banding risk, Medium banding risk, High banding risk	The measured banding verdict: smooth, subtle compression or visible step risk.

Tip: Banding is the filter the page recommends starting with: it is the one that narrows 8,192 gradients down to the ones you can use large on screen.

In the full collection, 6,342 gradients are measured as low risk, 330 as medium and 1,520 as high.

Sort by

Option	Order
Sort: original	Collection order (default).
Score high to low	Highest quality score first.
Complexity high to low	Highest complexity score first.
Stops high to low	Most stops first.
Stops low to high	Fewest stops first.

Option	Order
Dominant hue	By the gradient's overall hue, from 0°.
Random	Shuffled.

Buttons

- **Shuffle** — sets the sort to **Random**.
- **Open a random gradient** — opens any gradient from the whole collection on **Inspect**.
- **Reset** — clears both searches, every filter, and sets **Sort: original**.
- **Export visible** — opens the **Export** tab.
- **Back to top** — scrolls to the first card.

The grid and cards

The grid scrolls continuously. The counter under it reads, for example, **1–24 of 1,212**, or **Nothing to show** when nothing matches; the grid then says **No gradients match** and **Try clearing a filter or searching a broader method, color, or complexity**.

Each card shows:

Part	Meaning
Preview	The gradient, with its name and "scheme / interpolation space".
Score	The quality score, top right.
Stop strip	Up to 18 of its stops as flat colour.
Banding chip	Smooth , Compresses or Steps .
Stops chip	For example 7 stops .
CSS	Copies the gradient's CSS (CSS copied).
Save / Saved	Saves or unsaves the gradient.

Select a card, or focus it and press **Enter** or **Space**, to open it on **Inspect**.

Result

The grid shows only gradients that match your search and filters, in the order you chose.

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Check your own gradient

Enter your gradient's stops in "Will your gradient band?", read the verdict, find the worst step and fix it.

Will your gradient band? applies the collection's own banding measurement to stops you give it.

What banding is

A gradient bands when part of it changes colour much faster than the rest, so the eye sees a step or an edge instead of a smooth flow. It is common at the dark end of a ramp: standard sRGB spends few of its values on the darkest shades, so a black-to-colour blend often lurches just after black.

How the check measures

1. The page paints your stops the way a browser paints a plain CSS **linear-gradient**: evenly spaced, blended straight between neighbouring stops in sRGB.
2. It takes 96 samples along the ramp.
3. It measures the colour difference between each pair of neighbouring samples in OKLab, a colour space where equal distances look like roughly equal differences.
4. It divides the largest step by the average step. This **step ratio** is the verdict's basis. A perfectly even ramp has a ratio of 1.

Step ratio	Verdict	Meaning
Below 3.2	Smooth	No transition is large enough to read as a step.
3.2 to below 5.5	Some compression	One part of the ramp is noticeably faster than the rest.
5.5 or more	It will step	Expect a visible step.

The page explains the thresholds: across 3,000 gradients the collection had already labelled, the ratio's median was 1.55 for smooth ones and 5.09 for step risks, and 3.2 and 5.5 are where those groups separate.

Steps

1. Scroll to **Will your gradient band?**. It starts with three stops: **#000000**, **#0B3D91** and **#FFFFFF**.
2. For each stop, either click the swatch and pick a colour, or type into the text field. The field accepts any CSS colour: hex, **rgb()**, **hsl()**, **hwb()**, **lab()**, **lch()**, **oklab()**, **oklch()**, **color()** or a colour name.
3. To add a stop, select **Add a stop**. The new stop is added at the end, coloured halfway between the last two stops. You can have up to 12 stops.
4. To remove a stop, select × on it. A gradient keeps at least two stops, so × disappears when only two are left.
5. The verdict updates as you type. **Measure it** measures again on demand.
6. Read the result (below).

Result: a verdict, the step ratio, and the position of the worst step, marked on a preview of your ramp.

Reading the result

- **The preview strip** shows your stops, evenly spaced, with a marker above the worst transition.
- **The verdict word** — **Smooth**, **Some compression** or **It will step** — with **step ratio** and the ratio to two decimals.
- **A note** that says what to do:
 - **No transition is large enough to read as a step.**
 - If the worst step is at the very start: **The largest step is at the dark end. sRGB compresses its darkest values, so even a plain black-to-white ramp steps there — interpolate in OKLCH, or start from a lifted black rather than #000.**
 - Otherwise: **The largest step is at N% along the ramp. Adding a stop near there, or interpolating in OKLCH, is usually the fix.**
- **The numbers:**

Row	Meaning
Mean step	The average OKLab distance between neighbouring samples.
Largest step	The biggest one.
Worst transition at	Where the biggest step is, as a percentage along the ramp.
Sampled	96 steps, sRGB.

While you are typing

A half-typed colour, such as `#12`, is not yet a colour. The stop keeps its last valid colour, is marked as invalid, and a warning says, for example, **Stop 2 is not a colour yet — still measuring with its last one**. When you leave the field without finishing, the field is put back to the colour being measured.

Fixing a gradient that steps

1. Note **Worst transition at**.
2. Add a stop close to that position with an in-between colour, or replace a pure black `#000000` start with a slightly lifted dark colour.
3. Measure again.
4. If the verdict is still **It will step**, consider blending in OKLCH in your CSS (for example `linear-gradient(in oklch, ...)` in browsers that support it) and compare with gradients in the library that use **OkIch Short** or **Oklab** interpolation.

Note: The check always measures plain sRGB blending with evenly spaced stops, because that is how a basic CSS gradient is painted. It does not know about stop positions or interpolation settings you might add in your own CSS.

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Copy, export and share

Copy a gradient's CSS, download it as a CSS class, JSON, SVG, PNG or Tailwind token, export design tokens, share a link, and export whole filtered sets.

One gradient

You can export the open gradient from three places: the **Inspect** tab, its **Quick Export** card, and the **Active Gradient** card on the **Export** tab. If no gradient is open, the **Export** tab says **Select a gradient to enable active exports.** and its buttons reply **Select a gradient first.**

The examples use the first gradient in the collection, **Aurora Simple #00001**. File names are made from the gradient's name in lower case with dashes, for example `aurora-simple-00001`.

Button	Where	Output
Copy CSS / Copy CSS gradient	Inspect, CSS card, Export	Copies the CSS value (CSS copied).
Download CSS / Download CSS class	CSS card, Export	<code>aurora-simple-00001.css</code> , a ready-made class.
Download JSON	Quick Export, Export	<code>aurora-simple-00001.json</code> : angle, type, stops (position, hex, OKLCH), name and all metadata.
Download SVG	CSS card, Export	<code>aurora-simple-00001.svg</code> , a 1440 × 900 image using an SVG linear gradient at the same angle.
Download Tailwind / Download Tailwind token	Quick Export, Export	<code>aurora-simple-00001.tailwind.txt</code> , one <code>"name": "css"</code> line for a Tailwind configuration (for example under <code>backgroundImage</code>).
Download PNG / Download PNG preview	Quick Export, Export	<code>aurora-simple-00001.png</code> , 1600 × 1000 pixels.
Copy share link	Quick Export, Export	Opens the Share link dialog.
Design tokens...	Quick Export, Export	Opens the design tokens dialog.

The **Current CSS** card on the **Export** tab shows the open gradient's CSS.

Examples

The CSS value:

```
linear-gradient(0deg, #723c2d 0%, #7b3600 100%)
```

The CSS class:

```
.aa-gradient-aurora-simple-00001 {  
  background: linear-gradient(0deg, #723c2d 0%, #7b3600 100%);  
}
```

The Tailwind token:

```
"aurora-simple-00001": "linear-gradient(0deg, #723c2d 0%, #7b3600 100%)"
```

Design tokens

1. Select **Design tokens....** A dialog opens with the gradient's name as its title.
2. Set **Token prefix** (default **brand**).
3. Choose a format tab: **W3C Design Tokens**, **CSS Variables**, **SCSS**, **Tailwind Config**, **Style Dictionary**, **Material UI Theme**, **iOS (SwiftUI)** or **Android colors.xml**.
4. Select **Copy**, **Download**, or **Download all** for a ZIP of every format.

File names are **tokens.json**, **tokens.css**, **tokens.scss**, **tailwind.config.js**, **style-dictionary.tokens.json**, **theme.ts**, **Colors.swift** and **colors.xml**. Close with **×**, **Escape** or by selecting outside the dialog.

Share a link

1. Select **Copy share link**. The **Share link** dialog opens, titled with the gradient's name.
2. Select **Copy** (it shows **Copied!**), **Share via...** where your device offers it, or **Open in new tab**.
3. Select **Close**.

Anyone opening the link sees the Gradient Library with that gradient open on **Inspect**. The link itself carries the gradient; nothing is uploaded. If the gradient cannot be found, the page says **Shared gradient not in current library**.

Many gradients

The **Visible Set** card on the **Export** tab exports every gradient that matches your search and filters. Its badge shows how many.

Button	File	Contents
JSON with metadata	gradient-library-<count>-<date>.json	Export time, source, count and every gradient in full.
Minified JSON	gradient-library-<count>-<date>.json	Each gradient's name, CSS and stop hex codes, on one line.
CSS classes	gradient-library-<count>-<date>.css	One <code>.aa-gradient-...</code> class per gradient.
CSV index	gradient-library-<count>-<date>.csv	One row per gradient: id, name, type, angle, stops, scheme, method, complexity, interpolation, easing, score, complexity_score, banding and CSS.
Tailwind tokens	gradient-library-<count>-<date>.txt	An object of <code>"name": "css"</code> pairs.

If nothing matches, the page says **Nothing to export**.

Tip: Filter first. With no filter, a bulk export includes all 8,192 gradients.

Result

The gradient is on your clipboard, in a file for your code, design tool or presentation, in design tokens for your platform, or in a link someone else can open.

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Inspect a gradient

Read the Inspect tab: the preview, twelve quick facts, the CSS, the colour stops, the generator metrics and quick exports.

Open a gradient

- Select a card, or focus it and press `Enter` or `Space`.
- Select **Open a random gradient**.
- Select a card on the **Saved** tab.
- Open a share link (see [Copy, export and share](#)).

Before you open one, the tab says **No gradient selected** and describes what you will see.

Preview and quick facts

At the top, a large preview of the gradient with its name and a line "scheme / interpolation space / easing", and a **Copy CSS** button.

Beside it, twelve quick facts:

Fact	Meaning
Type	Linear. Every gradient in the collection is linear.
Angle	The direction in degrees, as in CSS (0deg points up, 90deg to the right).
Stops	Number of colour stops.
Method	How the colours were chosen.
Complexity	Simple, Detailed or Extreme.
Score	Quality score from 0 to 1, three decimals.
Space	The interpolation space used when the gradient was generated.
Easing	The easing curve used between stops.
Banding	Smooth, Subtle Compression or Visible Step Risk.
White min	The lowest contrast ratio between white and any of 24 samples along the gradient.
Black min	The same against black.
Hue	The dominant hue in degrees.

CSS

The **CSS** card shows the gradient as a CSS value, for example:

```
linear-gradient(0deg, #723c2d 0%, #7b3600 100%)
```

Buttons: **Copy CSS**, **Download CSS** (a CSS class) and **Download SVG**.

Color Stops

Every stop, numbered from **01**, with a swatch, its hex code (select it to copy) and its position along the gradient as a percentage.

Generator Metrics

Figures recorded when the gradient was generated. They appear a moment after the tab opens.

Row	Meaning
Scheme	The scheme family.
Interpolation	The interpolation space.
Easing	The easing curve.
Sample Count	How many samples the gradient was measured with.
Complexity Score	A number behind the Complexity label; higher is more elaborate.
DeltaE Mean	The average colour difference between neighbouring samples.
Uniformity	A measure of how evenly the gradient changes.
Banding	The measured verdict.
Seed	The number the generator started from.

Quick Export

"Export this gradient or save it locally for this browser." Buttons: **Download JSON**, **Download Tailwind**, **Download PNG**, **Copy share link**, **Design tokens...** and **Save gradient** (or **Remove saved**). See [Copy, export and share](#) and [Save gradients](#).

Result

You know how the gradient is built, how it was measured, and how readable white and black are on it — and you have its CSS one click away.

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Save gradients

Save gradients, find them on the Saved tab, and reach them from your Library.

Save a gradient

- Select **Save** on a card (it changes to **Saved**), or
- open the gradient on **Inspect** and select **Save gradient** under **Quick Export** (it changes to **Remove saved**).

The page confirms **Gradient saved**, and the **Saved** tab's badge goes up by one.

See saved gradients

Select the **Saved** tab. Your gradients appear as cards, most recently saved first. They work like cards in the grid: select one to inspect it, **CSS** to copy its CSS, **Saved** to unsave it.

A note says they are **Also saved to your Library workspace with image previews**. With nothing saved, the tab says **No saved gradients**.

Remove a gradient

Select **Saved** on its card, or **Remove saved** on **Inspect**. The page confirms **Gradient removed**, and the gradient also leaves your Library.

In your Library

Each saved gradient is also added to your Library under its name (for example **Aurora Simple #00001**), described by its scheme, number of stops and interpolation space, with a preview image. Open your Library from any page with **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **L**. See the [Library Kit docs](#).

Limits

- The **Saved** tab keeps up to 240 gradients; saving more drops the oldest.
- Saves are kept in this browser, not in your account. Clearing this site's data removes them.

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Tags and statistics

Browse the collection by tag on the Tags tab, and read distributions for your filtered set on the Stats tab.

Tags tab

The **Tags** tab lists every value in six groups, each with the number of gradients in the whole collection, most common first:

Group	Values
Methods	Analogous, Aurora, Chaotic, Complementary, Duotone, Golden, Monochrome, Nebula, Prismatic, Spectral, Terrain, Thermal
Schemes	The same twelve scheme names
Complexity	Detailed, Simple, Extreme
Interpolation	Lch Short, Linear Rgb, Oklab, Oklch Long, Oklch Short

Group	Values
Easing	Cubic In Out, Linear, Quart In Out, Sine In Out, Smootherstep
Banding	Smooth, Visible Step Risk, Subtle Compression

Select a value in **Methods**, **Schemes**, **Complexity**, **Interpolation** or **Easing** to set that filter and return to the **Library** tab with the grid narrowed. The **Banding** values are shown for information; filter by banding with the **Banding** filter on the **Library** tab.

The counts on this tab always describe the whole collection, whatever filters are set.

Stats tab

The **Stats** tab describes the gradients that currently match your search and filters (or the whole collection when nothing matches). Seven cards, each a bar chart with counts:

Card	Groups
Banding	Smooth, Compresses, Steps
Methods	One bar per method
Complexity	Simple, Detailed, Extreme
Stop Counts	2–4, 5–8, 9–16, 17–32, 33+
Interpolation	One bar per space
Easing	One bar per easing
Score Bands	0.70+, 0.55–0.69, under 0.55

Select a card heading to fold or unfold it. The tab redraws after you change a filter; if it looks out of date, select the tab again.

Example

Set **Interpolation** to **Linear Rgb** and open **Stats**; then set it to **OkIch Short** and open **Stats** again. Compare the **Banding** cards to see how often each blending space produced a smooth ramp in this collection.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > GRADIENT LIBRARY

Test vision, contrast and text

Use the Vision, Accessibility and Pair tabs to see a gradient under colour vision deficiencies, measure its contrast along the ramp, and test a text colour on it.

These three tabs work on the gradient you have open. If none is open, each says **Select a gradient** and asks you to pick one first.

Vision tab

The **Color Vision Preview** card shows the gradient six times:

Preview	What it simulates
Normal	The original.
Deuteranopia	No working green-sensitive cones.
Protanopia	No working red-sensitive cones.
Tritanopia	No working blue-sensitive cones.
Achromatopsia	No colour vision: greys only.
Low Vision	Blurred, with reduced saturation.

Use it to check that a gradient carrying meaning — for example a heat-map scale from cool to hot — still reads in order for colour-blind viewers. The previews are approximate screen filters; see [Limits and accuracy](#).

Accessibility tab

A gradient can pass contrast in one region and fail in another, so this tab samples the whole ramp.

Contrast Summary

Row	Meaning
White text min	Lowest contrast of white text anywhere on the 17 samples.
Black text min	Lowest contrast of black text.
Auto text min	Lowest contrast if each region used whichever of near-white or near-black reads better there.
Best sampled max	The highest contrast of white or black text anywhere.
Adjacent stop min	The lowest contrast between two neighbouring stops.
AA-safe samples	How many of the 17 samples reach 4.5:1 with the better text colour.

Sampled Stops

17 evenly spaced samples, from 0% to 100%, each with its colour, hex code and the best contrast it can give white or black text.

Reading Guidance

A reminder of the thresholds — **AA normal text: 4.5:1**, **AAA normal text: 7:1**, **AA large text: 3:1** — and advice to use the **Pair** tab for real copy.

Pair tab

1. Open the **Pair** tab. The text colour starts as white.
2. Choose a text colour: use the colour picker, type a six-digit hex into the text field, or select **White**, **Black** or **Gold**.
3. Read the preview: the gradient's name and a sentence written in your colour on top of the gradient.
4. Read **Pair Result**:

Row	Meaning
Minimum contrast	The lowest contrast of your text colour across 33 samples.
Average contrast	The average across those samples.
Text color	Your colour in hex.
Status	One of three verdicts, below.

Status	When
Passes AA in every sampled region	Minimum contrast 4.5:1 or more.
Large text only in weakest regions	Minimum between 3:1 and 4.5:1.
Needs overlay, shadow, or different text color	Minimum below 3:1.

The card also shows a ready-to-copy CSS snippet with the `background` and `color` declarations.

Result: you know whether your text colour is readable across the entire gradient, not only in the middle.

Tip: When no single text colour passes everywhere, place text only over the part of the gradient that passes, add a semi-transparent overlay behind the text, or choose a gradient with a smaller lightness range.

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Gradient Library reference

Every control, filter, sort order, tab, output, file name and message in the Gradient Library.

Everything on <https://auricartisan.com/library/gradient/>.

Heading

Item	Content
Kicker	Auric Artisan · Gradient

Item	Content
Headline	Eight thousand ramps, and which of them band.
Facts	Collection 8,192, Smooth 77%, Measured in OKLab
Read the API guide →	Opens the Gradient Library API guide.
Automate this note	3 API credits per call to GET /v1/gradient/library; API docs; × dismisses.

Will your gradient band?

Control	What it does	Values	Default
Stop swatch	Opens a colour picker for the stop.	Any colour	—
Stop text field	Takes any CSS colour.	Hex, <code>rgb()</code> , <code>hsl()</code> , <code>hwb()</code> , <code>lab()</code> , <code>lch()</code> , <code>oklab()</code> , <code>oklch()</code> , <code>color()</code> , names	<code>#000000</code> , <code>#0B3D91</code> , <code>#FFFFFF</code>
×	Removes the stop. Hidden when two stops remain.	—	—
Add a stop	Adds a stop at the end, halfway between the last two.	Up to 12 stops	—
Measure it	Measures again.	—	—

Output	Meaning
Preview strip and marker	The ramp, evenly spaced, with the worst step marked.
Verdict	Smooth (ratio below 3.2), Some compression (3.2 to below 5.5), It will step (5.5 or more).
step ratio	Largest step divided by the mean step.
Mean step, Largest step	OKLab distances between neighbouring samples, five decimals.
Worst transition at	Percentage along the ramp.
Sampled	96 steps, sRGB.

Browse controls

Control	What it does
Search by name, hex or scheme...	Every word must match name, type, angle, a stop hex, scheme, method, complexity, interpolation, easing or banding.
Shuffle	Sort Random .
Open a random gradient	Opens any gradient on Inspect .

Control	What it does
Filter inside results (name, hex, scheme...)	Second search, combined.
Clear	Empties the second search.

Tabs

Library (badge: matches), **Inspect**, **Vision**, **Accessibility**, **Pair**, **Tags**, **Stats**, **Export**, **Saved** (badge: saved count).

Filters

Filter	Options
Method	All methods , Analogous, Aurora, Chaotic, Complementary, Duotone, Golden, Monochrome, Nebula, Prismatic, Spectral, Terrain, Thermal
Scheme	All schemes and the same twelve
Complexity	Any complexity , Simple, Detailed, Extreme
Stops	Any stops , 2 to 4 stops, 5 to 8 stops, 9 to 16 stops, 17 to 32 stops, 33+ stops
Interpolation	Any interpolation , Lch Short, Linear Rgb, Oklab, Oklch Long, Oklch Short
Easing	Any easing , Cubic In Out, Linear, Quart In Out, Sine In Out, Smootherstep
Score	Any score , Top quality (≥ 0.70), Balanced+ (≥ 0.55), Wild / experimental (< 0.55)
Banding	Any banding , Low banding risk (smooth), Medium banding risk (subtle compression), High banding risk (visible step risk)

Sort by

Sort: original (default), **Score high to low**, **Complexity high to low**, **Stops high to low**, **Stops low to high**, **Dominant hue**, **Random**.

Library tab buttons

Control	What it does
Reset	Clears searches and filters; Sort: original .
Export visible	Opens Export .
Back to top	Scrolls to the first card.

Control	What it does
Counter	<code>first-last of total</code> , or Nothing to show.

Card

Part	Action
Preview	Name, "scheme / space", score.
Stop strip	Up to 18 stops.
Chips	Banding (Smooth, Compresses, Steps), stop count.
CSS	Copy CSS.
Save / Saved	Save or unsave.
Card	Select, <code>Enter</code> or <code>Space</code> : open on Inspect .

Inspect tab

Block	Contents
Preview	Name; "scheme / space / easing"; Copy CSS .
Quick facts	Type, Angle, Stops, Method, Complexity, Score, Space, Easing, Banding, White min, Black min, Hue
CSS	The CSS value; Copy CSS, Download CSS, Download SVG .
Color Stops	Number, swatch, hex (select to copy), position.
Generator Metrics	Scheme, Interpolation, Easing, Sample Count, Complexity Score, DeltaE Mean, Uniformity, Banding, Seed
Quick Export	Download JSON, Download Tailwind, Download PNG, Copy share link, Design tokens..., Save gradient / Remove saved

Vision, Accessibility, Pair

Tab	Contents
Vision	Normal, Deuteranopia, Protanopia, Tritanopia, Achromatopsia, Low Vision previews.
Accessibility	Contrast Summary (White text min, Black text min, Auto text min, Best sampled max, Adjacent stop min, AA-safe samples); Sampled Stops (17) ; Reading Guidance .
Pair	Text color picker and hex field; White, Black, Gold ; preview; Pair Result (Minimum contrast, Average contrast, Text color, Status) and a CSS snippet.

Pair text colour default: white. **Gold** is `#D3AF37`; **Black** is `#111111`.

Tags and Stats

Tab	Cards
Tags	Methods, Schemes, Complexity, Interpolation, Easing, Banding (whole-collection counts).
Stats	Banding, Methods, Complexity, Stop Counts, Interpolation, Easing, Score Bands (matching set).

Export tab

Card	Buttons
Active Gradient	Copy CSS gradient, Download CSS class, Download JSON, Download SVG, Download Tailwind token, Download PNG preview, Copy share link, Design tokens...
Visible Set	JSON with metadata, Minified JSON, CSS classes, CSV index, Tailwind tokens
Current CSS	The open gradient's CSS.

Files

Output	Name	Detail
CSS class	<code><name>.css</code>	<code>.aa-gradient-<name> { background: ... }</code>
JSON	<code><name>.json</code>	Full gradient.
SVG	<code><name>.svg</code>	1440 × 900.
Tailwind token	<code><name>.tailwind.txt</code>	<code>"<name>": "<css>"</code>
PNG	<code><name>.png</code>	1600 × 1000.
Bulk	<code>gradient-library-<count>-<date>.<ext></code>	<code>json, css, csv, txt.</code>

Messages

Message	When
Loading gradient library...	While loading.
Could not load gradient library	Loading failed.
No gradients match	Nothing matches the filters.
No gradient selected	Inspect before opening a gradient.
Select a gradient	Vision , Accessibility or Pair before opening a gradient.
No saved gradients	Nothing saved.

Message	When
CSS copied, Copied	After copying.
Gradient saved, Gradient removed	After saving or unsaving.
Select a gradient first	An export with no gradient open.
Nothing to export	A bulk export with no matches.
PNG export failed	The browser could not make the PNG.
Shared gradient not in current library	A share link's gradient could not be found.
Two stops at least.	The checker has fewer than two stops.
Stop N is not a colour yet	A checker field holds text that is not a colour.

Keyboard

Key	Action
/	Focus the search box.
Enter / Space	Open the focused card.
Escape	Close the share or design tokens dialog.

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Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes for problems in the Gradient Library.

"Could not load gradient library"

Why: The collection could not be downloaded — usually a dropped connection or a content blocker.

What to do: Check your connection, allow auricartisan.com in any blocker, and reload.

"No gradients match"

Why: The search and filters together exclude everything. Some combinations are rare, for example **Extreme** complexity with **2 to 4 stops**.

What to do: Select **Reset**, then add filters back one at a time.

My gradient says "It will step" but looks fine to me

Why: The check measures the ratio between the largest and the average step. On a small preview, a step can be hard to see; on a large hero area, on a different screen, or after image compression, it often shows.

What to do: Look at the ramp full-width on the screens you care about. If the worst step is at the dark end, lift the black slightly; otherwise add a stop near **Worst transition at**.

The checker gives a different verdict from the same gradient in the collection

Why: The checker always paints evenly spaced stops blended in plain sRGB, the way a basic CSS gradient is drawn. The collection's gradients were generated with their own stop positions, interpolation space and easing, and their verdict describes that.

What to do: Treat the checker as "how will this look as a basic CSS gradient". To keep a collection gradient's smoothness, use its CSS exactly as exported.

"Stop N is not a colour yet"

Why: The text in that stop's field is not a colour the page can read, such as a half-typed hex.

What to do: Finish or correct the value. Until then the stop is measured with its last valid colour; leaving the field puts that colour back.

Selecting a Banding value on the Tags tab does nothing

Why: On the **Tags** tab, the **Banding** values are counts only.

What to do: Use the **Banding** filter on the **Library** tab.

Vision, Accessibility or Pair say "Select a gradient"

Why: These tabs work on the open gradient.

What to do: Select a card first, then open the tab.

The Stats tab has not changed after I filtered

Why: The tab is drawn when opened.

What to do: Select the **Stats** tab again.

A share link opens the page but not the gradient

Why: The link was cut short or edited, or the page says **Shared gradient not in current library**.

What to do: Ask for the link again, or search for the gradient's name.

Saved gradients have gone

Why: Saves live in this browser only, and the **Saved** tab keeps the latest 240.

What to do: Save them again, or export them as JSON or CSS to keep a permanent copy.

Downloads do not start

Why: Some browsers block several downloads in a row, or ask before downloading.

What to do: Allow downloads from auricartisan.com when your browser asks.

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Gradient Library FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Gradient Library.

How many gradients are there?

8,192, with between 2 and 46 stops each. All of them are linear gradients.

How smooth is the collection?

6,342 gradients (about 77%) are measured as smooth, 330 show subtle compression, and 1,520 carry a visible step risk.

Can I check a gradient I made elsewhere?

Yes. Type its stops into **Will your gradient band?** in any CSS colour format. See [Check your own gradient](#).

What does interpolation space mean?

The colour space in which the colours between two stops are worked out. Blending in sRGB (the CSS default) can produce muddy middles and uneven steps; blending in OKLab or OKLCH usually gives more even, brighter transitions.

What is easing?

A curve that controls how fast a blend moves between two stops — steadily (**Linear**), or slowly at the ends and faster in the middle (**Sine In Out**, **Cubic In Out**, **Quart In Out**, **Smoootherstep**).

What does the score mean?

A quality score from 0 to 1 recorded for each gradient. The **Score** filter groups it into **Top quality** (0.70 or more), **Balanced+** (0.55 or more) and **Wild / experimental** (below 0.55). It is a ranking aid, not a guarantee.

Can I put text on a gradient?

Yes, if it stays readable across the whole ramp. Use the **Pair** tab to test your text colour; see [Test vision, contrast and text](#).

Do I need an account?

No. Saved gradients stay in your browser and your Library.

Is there an API?

Yes. The heading links to the Gradient Library API guide, and the **Automate this** note names the call (**GET /v1/gradient/library**). See [Public API](#).

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Gradient Library: other material

Supporting material for the Gradient Library: glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages, privacy and release notes.

Background material for the Gradient Library.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Banding, step ratio, interpolation, easing and other terms.
Shortcuts	Keyboard and pointer actions.
Limits and accuracy	What the banding check and contrast figures measure, and their limits.
Related	Related libraries, tools and Learn articles.
Privacy	What stays in your browser and what uses the network.
Release notes	User-facing history.

[Back to the Gradient Library overview.](#)

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Gradient Library shortcuts

Keyboard and pointer actions in the Gradient Library.

Keyboard

Keys	Where	Result
/	Anywhere, when not typing	Focuses Search by name, hex or scheme...
Tab	Grid	Moves between cards and their buttons.
Enter or Space	A focused card	Opens it on Inspect .
Escape	Share link or design tokens dialog	Closes it.

Pointer

Action	Result
Select a card	Opens it on Inspect .
Select CSS on a card	Copies its CSS.
Select a stop's hex on Inspect	Copies the hex.

Action	Result
Select a value on Tags	Filters the Library by it (except Banding).
Select a card heading on Vision , Accessibility , Pair , Tags , Stats or Export	Folds or unfolds the card.

The site-wide shortcuts also work here. See [Site features](#).

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Gradient Library glossary

Definitions of the terms used in the Gradient Library.

Term	Meaning
Achromatopsia	Complete colour blindness: only shades of grey are seen.
Angle	The direction of a linear gradient, in degrees, as in CSS: 0deg runs bottom to top, 90deg left to right.
Banding	Visible steps or edges in a gradient that should look smooth.
Complexity	Simple , Detailed or Extreme : how elaborate a gradient is, backed by a complexity score.
Contrast ratio	The WCAG 2 measure of the lightness difference between two colours, from 1:1 to 21:1.
Design tokens	Named values in a format a design system or platform reads.
Easing	The curve controlling how fast a blend moves between two stops.
Interpolation space	The colour space in which in-between colours are calculated: for example sRGB, linear RGB, LCH, OKLab or OKLCH. "Short" and "long" say which way round the hue circle the blend travels.
OKLab, OKLCH	A modern perceptual colour space, and its lightness–chroma–hue form. Equal distances in it look roughly equally different, which is why the banding check measures in OKLab.
Scheme	The colour family a gradient belongs to, such as Aurora, Thermal or Terrain.
Score	A quality score from 0 to 1 recorded for each gradient.
sRGB	The standard colour space of the web. Plain CSS gradients blend in it.
Step ratio	The largest colour change between neighbouring samples divided by the average change. 1 is perfectly even; the check calls 3.2 and above compression and 5.5 and above a step.
Stop	One colour at one position along a gradient.
WCAG	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines. AA text needs 4.5:1 contrast (3:1 for large text); AAA needs 7:1.

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Limits and accuracy

What the Gradient Library's banding verdicts, contrast figures and previews measure, and what they do not.

The banding verdict

- The checker samples 96 points along the ramp and compares neighbouring samples in OKLab. The verdict depends on the ratio of the largest step to the average step, so it does not change with the number of samples.
- The thresholds (3.2 and 5.5) were set from the collection's own labelled gradients, as the page explains. They are a good guide, not a guarantee: whether a step is visible also depends on the screen, its bit depth, the size of the gradient, image compression and the viewer.
- The checker models a plain CSS gradient: evenly spaced stops blended in sRGB. It ignores stop positions, colour hints, easing and `in oklch`-style interpolation you may use in your own CSS.
- The collection's verdicts were recorded when each gradient was generated, using its own positions, space and easing.

Contrast

- Contrast uses the WCAG 2 formula on sampled colours: 24 samples for **White min** and **Black min**, 17 on the **Accessibility** tab, and 33 on the **Pair** tab. A very narrow dark or light band between samples could be missed.
- Passing contrast is one part of readable text; font size, weight and any texture behind the text also matter.

Vision previews

The **Vision** tab uses approximate screen filters for complete deuteranopia, protanopia, tritanopia and achromatopsia, and a blur for low vision. They show the idea, not an exact simulation of any individual's sight.

Scores and labels

The score, complexity, method and scheme are recorded with each gradient when it was generated. The score is a ranking aid, not a judgement of beauty or fitness for your purpose.

Exports

- The SVG export draws a linear gradient at the gradient's angle across the image; for very steep angles it can differ slightly from how CSS fits the same angle to a box.
- The PNG export is drawn by your browser, so it reflects your browser's sRGB blending.

What it is not

It is not a certified measurement of display performance, and it does not know how your gradient will be compressed or displayed.

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Privacy

What the Gradient Library keeps in your browser and what it fetches over the network.

What stays in your browser

What	Why	How to remove it
Saved gradients (up to 240)	To fill the Saved tab.	Unsave each one, or clear this site's data.
A copy of each saved gradient in your Library	So it appears with your other saved items.	Unsave it, or remove it in the Library.
Whether you dismissed the Automate this note	So it stays hidden.	Clear this site's data.

The stops you type into **Will your gradient band?** are measured in your browser and are never sent anywhere. Searches and filters are not remembered after you leave.

What uses the network

- On opening, the page downloads the collection's index from auricartisan.com.
- Opening a gradient downloads its detailed metrics from auricartisan.com.
- Downloads are created in your browser. **Download all** in the design tokens dialog may fetch a small helper from auricartisan.com to build the ZIP.
- Share links carry the gradient in the link itself; nothing is uploaded.

Advertising and analytics follow your consent choices. See [Company and legal](#).

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Release notes

User-facing history of the Gradient Library.

0.9.9 — 5 June 2026

The Gradient Library was added in release 0.9.9 as part of the library expansion. See the [Changelog](#).

The current page

The page now opens with **Will your gradient band?**, which measures any stops you give it, shows a banding chip on every card, and puts every tab on screen at once. These changes are not listed as a separate changelog release.

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Related

Libraries, tools and Learn articles that work alongside the Gradient Library.

Other colour libraries

- [Shade Library](#) — one colour taken from light to dark, measured for even steps.
 - [Palette Library](#), [Harmony Library](#), [Color Library](#) and [Accessibility Library](#).
-

Tools

- [Basic Tools](#) — includes a gradient maker.
 - [M-Gradient Palette](#) — multigradient palettes.
 - [Tonal Steps, Tints & Shades](#) — step charts.
 - [Vision Simulation](#) — full simulations of colour vision deficiencies.
 - [Your Library](#) — where saved gradients also appear.
-

Learn articles

- [Color Gradients and Interpolation](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-07-color-gradients-and-interpolation) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-07-color-gradients-and-interpolation>
 - [Oklab and Oklch: Modern Perceptual Color Spaces](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces>
 - [Color in CSS: Modern Color in the Browser](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-07-16-color-in-css-modern-color-in-the-browser) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-07-16-color-in-css-modern-color-in-the-browser>
 - [Accessible Color Design and WCAG Contrast](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color>
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Guides and API

- The Gradient Library user guide in the [Documentation library](#).
- [Public API](#).

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Harmony Library

What the Harmony Library is, who it is for, where to find it, and how to identify your own colours' harmony and export a scheme.

The Harmony Library is a collection of 8,192 colour harmonies built on 23 colour-theory schemes — complementary, split complementary, triadic, tetradic, square, analogous, monochromatic, hexadic, pentadic, golden ratio and more — grouped into five families. The headline says "Eight thousand schemes, *and none of them stored*": every harmony is worked out from a fixed seed when you need it, so an id such as `har_5k` always means the same colours, anywhere. It is, in the page's words, "a claim anyone can recompute".

A colour harmony is a set of colours whose hues sit in a deliberate pattern around the colour wheel — opposite each other, evenly spaced, or close neighbours. The library shows each harmony's colours with their roles in the scheme (base, complement, triad, accent and so on), how closely they keep to the scheme's ideal angles, and — the part a row of swatches cannot show — which of its colours can carry text on each other. Only about a quarter of the collection contains two colours you could set text with.

The library also works the other way round. In **What harmony is this?**, you type in colours you already use and it tells you which of the 23 schemes they form, how closely, and which other schemes look identical by hue alone.

Who it is for

- Designers who want palettes grounded in colour theory, and want to know which colours are safe for text.
- Anyone who wants to name the harmony behind an existing brand palette.
- Front-end developers who need a scheme as CSS, SCSS, Tailwind or design tokens.
- Students learning how the classic colour-wheel schemes relate.

Where to find it

Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/harmony/> in a current browser. It is also listed as **Harmony Library** ("Color relationships") under **Libraries** in the site header's **Learn** menu. No account is needed.

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/harmony/>.
2. In **What harmony is this?**, read the answer for the starting colours: three hues 120° apart, a triadic.
3. Replace them with your own colours and select **Identify it**.
4. Scroll to **Browse the collection** and set **Family** to **Analogous**.
5. Select **Inspect** on a card to see its roles, adherence and pair contrast.
6. Under **Quick export**, select **Copy CSS vars** and paste the variables into your stylesheet.

7. Select **Save to library** to keep the harmony.

What you can do

- Identify which of 23 schemes any 2 to 12 colours form, with a fit score and the runners-up.
 - Browse all 8,192 harmonies, jump to any by id, and search by id, hex, method or family.
 - Filter by hue, chroma, lightness and family; sort by lightness, chroma, hue or number of colours.
 - Inspect a harmony: colour roles, descriptive names, scheme description and canonical angles, adherence, pair contrast and every colour's values.
 - Read distributions of schemes, families, hues, adherence and contrast on the **Theory**, **Accessibility** and **Stats** tabs.
 - Copy as hex, CSS, SCSS or Tailwind; download JSON, ASE, SVG or PNG; open in Colors; export design tokens; share a link.
 - Save harmonies in your browser and your Library, and export whole filtered sets.
-

In this folder

- [docs/](#) — how to use the Harmony Library.
 - [Getting started](#), [Identify your colours' harmony](#), [Browse, search and filter](#), [Inspect a harmony](#), [Analyse the collection](#), [Copy, export and share](#), [Save harmonies](#), [Reference](#), [Troubleshooting](#), [FAQ](#).
- [others/](#) — background material.
 - [Glossary](#) (including all 23 schemes), [Shortcuts](#), [Limits and accuracy](#), [Related](#), [Privacy](#), [Release notes](#).

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Harmony Library documentation

The task guides, reference, troubleshooting and FAQ for the Harmony Library.

Task guides, the full reference, and troubleshooting and FAQ for the Harmony Library.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	Opening the page, a tour of the screen, and a first harmony from identification to export.
identify-your-colours.md	What harmony is this?: entering colours, reading the fit, ties and runners-up.
browse-search-and-filter.md	Ids, search, filters, sorting and the grid.
inspect-a-harmony.md	The Inspect tab: roles, summary, scheme, pair contrast and per-colour values.
analyse-the-collection.md	The Theory , Accessibility and Stats tabs.
copy-export-and-share.md	Copy formats, downloads, Colors, design tokens, share links and bulk export.
save-harmonies.md	Saving, the Saved tab and your Library.
reference.md	Every control, option, output and message.
troubleshooting.md	Symptoms, causes and fixes.
faq.md	Short answers.

[Back to the Harmony Library overview.](#)

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Getting started

Open the Harmony Library, learn the screen, and identify, inspect and export a first harmony.

Open the page

1. Go to <https://auricartisan.com/library/harmony/>, or open the **Learn** menu in the site header and select **Harmony Library** under **Libraries**.
2. While the page works out the collection, the grid shows **Loading harmony database....** This takes a moment: all 8,192 harmonies are calculated in your browser so the filters can look at every one.
3. The grid fills and the counter reads, for example, **1–48 of 8,192 harmonies**.

If loading fails you see **Could not load harmony database**. See [Troubleshooting](#).

A tour of the screen

The heading

Kicker **Auric Artisan · Harmony**; headline **Eight thousand schemes, and none of them stored.**; facts **Collection 8,192, 23 methods** and **Derived, not stored**; and **Read the API guide** → to the Harmony Library's API guide.

A note starting **Automate this** may appear: browsing the collection is also available through the site's REST API — **3 API credits per call to GET /v1/harmony/library** — with a link to **API docs**. Select × to dismiss it.

What harmony is this?

A row of colours, each with a swatch to click and pick, and a text field that takes any CSS colour. **Add a colour** and **Identify it** sit below, then the answer: the scheme your colours form, a fit score, and what else was considered. See [Identify your colours' harmony](#).

Browse the collection

A search box (**Search by id, hex or method...**), **Shuffle**, **Open a random harmony**, and a second row, **Filter inside results**, with **Clear**.

The tabs

Tab	What it shows
Library	Filters, sort, the grid. The badge shows how many harmonies match.
Inspect	The harmony you last opened.
Theory	Distributions of schemes, families, hues, colour counts, adherence, lightness and chroma.
Accessibility	How many harmonies contain text-safe pairs.
Stats	Six histograms.
Export	Exports for the open harmony and for every matching harmony.
Saved	Harmonies you have saved.

A card

Each card shows the harmony's colours as a strip of swatches with hex codes (select a swatch to copy it), its id (such as **har_0**), its scheme (such as **Split complementary**), and **Inspect**, **Copy** and **Save** buttons.

Your first task: name your brand palette's harmony, then find a text-safe alternative

1. In **What harmony is this?**, type your brand colours into the fields — use **Add a colour** or × until you have the right number.
2. Read the verdict, for example **a split complementary** with **fit 0.912**. A fit near 1 means your hues sit close to the scheme's ideal angles.
3. Read **Worst pair** and **Best pair**. If **Best pair** is below 4.5:1, no two of your colours can carry body text on each other.
4. In **Browse the collection**, type the scheme's name into the search box, for example `split_complementary`.
5. Open the **Accessibility** tab and look at **Has any AA pair (4.5+)**, then return to **Library**.
6. Select **Inspect** on a harmony and read **Pair-by-pair WCAG contrast** until you find one with a pair at 4.5:1 or more.
7. Under **Quick export**, select **Copy CSS vars**.

Result: you know which scheme your palette follows, and you have an alternative in the same scheme with at least one text-safe pair, ready in CSS.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > HARMONY LIBRARY

Analyse the collection

Use the Theory, Accessibility and Stats tabs to see how schemes, families, adherence and contrast are distributed across the harmonies you have filtered.

The **Theory**, **Accessibility** and **Stats** tabs describe every harmony that matches your current search and filters — the whole collection when nothing is set. Because all 8,192 harmonies are calculated when the page opens, these are complete counts, not samples.

Each tab is drawn when you open it and redrawn after the filters change. If a tab looks out of date, select it again. With nothing matching, each tab shows **No harmonies**.

Theory tab

Card	What it counts
Color-theory scheme	Harmonies per method.
Family	Harmonies per family.
Dominant hue bucket	Harmonies per overall hue: red, orange, yellow, green, cyan, blue, purple, pink.
Color count	Harmonies with 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 or 7 colours.
Adherence to canonical scheme	High (≥ 0.85) , Medium (0.60-0.85) and Low (< 0.60) .

Card	What it counts
Lightness & chroma profile	Dark ($L < 0.4$)**, **Mid (0.4-0.7)**, **Light (> 0.7); Muted (< 0.07)**, **Balanced**, **Vivid (> 0.15).

In the full collection there are 1,070 complementary-family, 2,138 polyadic, 1,424 analogous, 2,136 monochromatic and 1,424 compound harmonies, and adherence is high for 6,521, medium for 1,608 and low for 63.

Accessibility tab

Harmony-level WCAG summary

Row	Meaning
Has any AA pair (4.5+)	Harmonies with at least one pair at 4.5:1 or more.
Has any AAA pair (7+)	Harmonies with at least one pair at 7:1 or more.
All pairs AA	Harmonies in which every pair reaches 4.5:1 (up to 24 are counted and shown below).

Across the full collection, 2,078 harmonies (about a quarter) have an AA pair, 1,588 an AAA pair, and only 7 have every pair at AA.

Pair-level WCAG breakdown

Every pair in every matching harmony, counted as **AAA pairs ($\geq 7:1$)**, **AA pairs ($\geq 4.5:1$)** and **Below AA**.

Visible harmonies where every pair passes AA

Up to 24 cards whose colours all reach 4.5:1 against each other. They work like grid cards. If there are none, the card says **No full-AA harmonies here**.

Tip: Harmonies where every pair passes are rare because every colour then has to sit at a very different lightness. Most harmonies with a text-safe pair have one very light and one very dark member; filter by **Family** or search a scheme and look for **Has any AA pair**.

Stats tab

Six histograms:

Card	Range	Bands
Avg lightness (OKLCH L)	0 to 1	10
Avg chroma (OKLCH C)	0 to 0.30	10

Card	Range	Bands
Hue spread	0° to 360°	12
Min pair contrast	1:1 to 12:1	11
Adherence	0 to 1	10
Colors per harmony	2 to 8	6

Values beyond a range are counted in the last band.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > HARMONY LIBRARY

Browse, search and filter

Jump to a harmony by id, search, filter by hue, chroma, lightness and family, and sort the collection.

Ids

Every harmony has a number from 0 to 8,191 and an id: `har_` followed by that number in base 36. `har_0` is the first; `har_5k` is number 200. The id always gives the same colours.

The schemes take turns: harmony 0 is complementary, 1 is split complementary, 2 is triadic, and so on through all 23 before starting again. The collection therefore holds 356 or 357 harmonies of each scheme.

Jump to a harmony

Type an id (`har_5k`) or a number (`200`) into **Search by id, hex or method...**. The grid shows that harmony alone. Filters are ignored while an id is in the box.

Search

Type anything else. Every word must appear in the harmony's id, its method (for example `split_complementary`), its family, or the hex code of one of its colours. The **Filter inside results** box (**id**, **hex**, **method...**) adds more words; **Clear** empties it.

Tip: Method names use underscores, as in `analogous_5` or `golden_ratio`. Searching `analogous` finds all three analogous schemes and the accented analogous one.

Press `/` outside a text field to jump to the search box.

Filters

Filter	Options	Meaning
Base hue	All hues, Red, Orange, Yellow, Green, Cyan, Blue, Purple, Pink	The harmony's overall hue: the average of its colours' OKLCH hues, weighted towards the more colourful ones.
Chroma	Any chroma, Muted (< 0.07)**, **Balanced** (0.07 to 0.15), **Vivid (> 0.15)	Average OKLCH chroma.
Lightness	Any lightness, Dark (below 0.40), Mid (0.40 to 0.70), Light (above 0.70)	Average OKLCH lightness.
Method	All methods and the 23 method names	Intended to filter by scheme. See the note below.
Family	All families, Complementary, Polyadic, Analogous, Monochromatic, Compound	The scheme family.

Note: On the current page, choosing a **Method** does not narrow the grid. To see one scheme, type its method name into the search box instead, for example **triadic**.

Filters and searches all combine: a harmony must pass every one. Because the page holds all 8,192 harmonies at once, filters look at the whole collection, not a sample.

Sort by

Option	Order
Sort: original	By number (default).
Lightness ↑ / Lightness ↓	Average OKLCH lightness.
Chroma ↑ / Chroma ↓	Average OKLCH chroma.
Hue (rainbow)	Overall hue from 0°.
Color count ↑ / Color count ↓	Number of colours, 2 to 7.
Random	Shuffled.

Buttons

- **Shuffle** — sort **Random**.
- **Open a random harmony** — opens any harmony on **Inspect**.
- **Reset** — clears searches and filters, and sets **Sort: original**.
- **Export visible** — opens **Export**.
- **Back to top** — scrolls to the first card.

The grid

The grid scrolls continuously; the counter reads, for example, **1–48 of 1,424 harmonies**. With no matches it reads **Nothing to show** and the grid says **No harmonies match — Try clearing a filter, or searching a broader method or family**.

Each card: the swatch strip (select a swatch to copy its hex), the id, the scheme name, and **Inspect**, **Copy** (all hex codes, comma-separated: **Harmony hexes copied**) and **Save**. Select the card elsewhere, or press **Enter** or **Space** on a focused swatch, to open it on **Inspect**.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > HARMONY LIBRARY

Copy, export and share

Copy a harmony as hex, CSS, SCSS or Tailwind with role-named variables, download JSON, ASE, SVG or PNG, export design tokens, share a link, and export many harmonies.

Quick copies from the grid

- Select a swatch to copy its hex code.
- Select **Copy** on a card to copy all its hex codes, separated by commas.

One harmony

Open the harmony on **Inspect**. Use its **Quick export** row, or the **Selection** card on the **Export** tab (headed **Selection** · with the id and scheme). With nothing open, the **Export** tab says **No harmony selected. Click Inspect on any card in the Library tab to enable selection exports**.

Copy formats

Variables are named after the harmony's id and each colour's role, which makes them easy to read. The examples use **har_0**, a complementary harmony.

Quick export	Export tab	What is copied
Copy HEX	HEX list	Hex codes, one per line.
Copy CSS vars	CSS variables	A :root block.
Copy SCSS	SCSS variables	Sass variables.
Copy Tailwind	Tailwind config	A colour object keyed by role.

```
:root {
  --har_0-base: #D17671;
  --har_0-complement: #71CCD1;
}
```

```
$har_0-base: #D17671;  
$har_0-complement: #71CCD1;
```

```
{  
  "har_0": {  
    "base": "#D17671",  
    "complement": "#71CCD1"  
  }  
}
```

Downloads

Quick export	Export tab	File	Contents
Download JSON	JSON	har_0.json	Id, method, family, base (hue, saturation, lightness, hex), every colour (role, hex, RGB, HSL, OKLCH, Lab) and metadata including canonical angles, description, adherence and the contrast table.
Download ASE	Adobe ASE	har_0.ase	An Adobe Swatch Exchange file with one RGB swatch per colour.
Download SVG	SVG strip	har_0.svg	A strip of the colours with hex labels.
Download PNG	PNG strip	har_0.png	The same strip as an image.

Open in Colors (on **Inspect**, and under **External** on the **Export** tab) opens the harmony's colours on colors.co in a new tab.

Design tokens

Select **Design tokens...** The dialog is titled with the harmony's id, and **Token prefix** starts as the harmony's method name in lower case with dashes (for example `split-complementary`). Choose a format — **W3C Design Tokens, CSS Variables, SCSS, Tailwind Config, Style Dictionary, Material UI Theme, iOS (SwiftUI)** or **Android colors.xml** — then **Copy**, **Download**, or **Download all** for a ZIP named, for example, `harmony-har-0.zip`.

Share a link

Select **Copy share link**. The **Share link** dialog (titled **Harmony** and the id) offers **Copy**, **Share via...** where available, **Open in new tab** and **Close**. The link opens the Harmony Library with the harmony on **Inspect**. If it cannot be found, the page says **Shared harmony not found in current dataset**.

Many harmonies

The **Visible** page card on the **Export** tab exports every harmony that matches your search and filters — all 8,192 with no filter. Its badge shows the number.

Group	Button	Contents
Bulk download	Download JSON (visible page)	Every harmony in full.
	Download CSV (visible page)	<code>harmony_id,method,family,color_count,base_hex,colors</code> with colours separated by spaces.
	Download CSS variables	One <code>:root</code> block, role-named variables per harmony.
	Download SCSS variables	Role-named Sass variables.
	Download compact JSON	Id, method and hex codes per harmony.
Sample formats	Download .txt hex list	Every hex code, one per line.
	Download tailwind.config.js fragment	A Tailwind configuration with one colour group per harmony.

Files are named `harmony-page-<count>-<date>.<ext>`. With nothing matching, the page says **Nothing to export**.

Result

The harmony is on your clipboard, in a file, in design tokens for your platform, or in a link — with variable names that say what each colour does.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > HARMONY LIBRARY

Identify your colours' harmony

Use "What harmony is this?" to find which of the 23 schemes your colours form, how closely, and which schemes it cannot tell apart.

What harmony is this? compares the hue pattern of colours you give it against all 23 schemes in the collection.

How the match works

- A harmony is a shape on the colour wheel, and a shape has no first colour. So the page tries each of your colours as the base in turn and keeps the best fit. The order you enter colours in does not change the answer.

- Only schemes with the same number of colours as yours are compared. Three colours are compared with the 3-colour schemes, five with the 5-colour schemes, and so on.
- For each scheme it measures how far, on average, your hues are from the scheme's ideal angles, in degrees. The **fit** runs from 1 (exact) down to 0 (60° or more off on average — a whole scheme's worth of wrong).
- Only hue is compared. Lightness and saturation are ignored.

Steps

1. Scroll to **What harmony is this?**. It starts with three colours: `#E4572E`, `#2EE457` and `#572EE4`.
2. For each colour, click the swatch to pick one, or type into the field. Any CSS colour works: hex, `rgb()`, `hsl()`, `lab()`, `oklch()`, `color()` or a name.
3. Select **Add a colour** to add one (up to 12). The new colour is the opposite of the first colour. Select × to remove one; at least two always remain.
4. The answer updates as you type. **Identify it** runs the match again.

Result: the scheme your colours form, how closely, and which others were close.

Reading the answer

The verdict

Fit	Verdict	Note
0.85 or more	The scheme's name, for example a triadic	The hue offsets sit within N° of the canonical ...°.
0.65 to below 0.85	Close to and the scheme, for example Close to an analogous 3	The closest scheme is off by N° on average. Near enough to read as intentional, far enough that it was probably not.
Below 0.65	Not one of the 23	Nothing in the collection sits close to these hue offsets. That is not a fault — most palettes in the world are not one of 23 schemes.

Next to the verdict: **fit** and the score to three decimals.

Schemes it cannot tell apart

Five schemes share a hue shape with another and differ only in lightness or saturation: **shades**, **tints** and **neutral** are all five colours at one hue (like **monochromatic 5**); **warm cool** has the shape of **complementary**; **triad shifted** has the shape of **triadic**. When your colours match one of these, the note says: **By hue alone this is indistinguishable from ...** and lists the others, because a hue measurement cannot separate them.

The rows

Row	Meaning
Family	The best scheme's family: complementary, polyadic, analogous, monochromatic or compound.
Base colour	Which of your colours worked best as the scheme's base.
Worst pair	The lowest contrast ratio between any two of your colours.
Best pair	The highest, marked (AA) when it reaches 4.5:1 — at least one pair can then carry body text.

Also considered

Up to four runner-up schemes, each with its fit to two decimals.

Special cases

- **No scheme uses N colours.** With 8 to 12 colours no scheme has as many members, so the page says so and explains that the 23 methods run from two members to seven. Remove colours until you have seven or fewer.
- **Colour N is not a colour yet.** A field holds text that is not a colour. The match uses that colour's last valid value; leaving the field puts that value back.
- If the list of schemes cannot be loaded, the section says **The scheme manifest did not load, so there is nothing to match against.**

Example

Enter **#E4572E**, **#2EE457** and **#572EE4** (the defaults). The hues are 120° apart, so the verdict is **a triadic** with a fit close to 1, and the note names **triad shifted** as indistinguishable by hue alone.

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Inspect a harmony

Read the Inspect tab: colour roles and names, the harmony summary, the colour-theory scheme, pair contrast and each colour's values.

Open a harmony by selecting **Inspect** or the card, pressing **Enter** or **Space** on a focused swatch, selecting **Open a random harmony**, or opening a share link. Until then the tab shows **No harmony selected**.

The colour strip

One column per colour, each with:

- its **role** in the scheme — for example **Base, Complement, Split-Low, Split-High, Triad ②, Triad ③, Ally, Comp-Ally, Right 90°, Left 90°, Accent, Warm-Shift, Cool-Shift, Ally-Comp, Temperature Mate**, or a numbered role such as **Analogous 1, Shade 1, Tint 3, Neutral 2, Hex 2, Pent 4** or **Phi 2**;
- a three-word descriptive name, such as **soft saturated teal** (tone, colourfulness and hue from OKLCH);
- its hex code.

Select a column to copy its hex code.

Harmony summary

The card's badge shows the family.

Row	Meaning
Harmony ID	For example <code>har_5k</code> .
Global index	The harmony's number.
Scheme	The method, for example <code>triadic</code> .
Family	complementary, polyadic, analogous, monochromatic or compound.
Colors	2 to 7.
Base hue	The base colour's hue in degrees.
Avg L* (OKLCH)	Average OKLCH lightness, 0 to 1.
Avg chroma	Average OKLCH chroma.
Hue span	Widest angle between two of its hues, 0° to 180°.
DeltaE avg	Average colour difference between pairs (CIE76).
Adherence	How closely the colours keep to the scheme's ideal hue angles, as a percentage. 85% or more is shown as good, 60% to 85% as a warning, below 60% as poor.
Entropy	Hue bands covered, divided by the number of colours (up to 10).
Min pair contrast	Lowest contrast between two of its colours.
Max pair contrast	Highest. 4.5:1 or more means at least one pair can carry body text.

Color-theory scheme

- A one-sentence description of the scheme, for example "Three hues spaced 120° apart — vibrant and well-balanced."
- **Canonical angles** — the scheme's ideal hue offsets from the base, for example **120° / 240°**.
- **Color roles** — the roles of all its colours, in order.

- **Base HSL** — the base colour's hue, saturation and lightness.

Pair-by-pair WCAG contrast

Every pair of colours by role, for example **Base / Complement 1.72 : 1** for `har_0`. 4.5:1 or more is good for body text, 3:1 or more for large text.

Quick export

Copy HEX, Copy CSS vars, Copy SCSS, Copy Tailwind, Download JSON, Download ASE, Download SVG, Download PNG, Open in Coolers, Save to library / Unsave, Copy share link and Design tokens.... See [Copy, export and share](#).

One card per colour

Headed by role and hex, with a badge of its contrast on white and on black. Rows: **Role, HEX, RGB, HSL, OKLCH, CIE L*a*b*, WCAG vs white, WCAG vs black**, and buttons that copy the hex and `rgb()` values.

Select any card heading to fold or unfold it.

Why adherence is not always 100%

Colours are generated in HSL, where equal hue steps are not perfectly even to the eye, and some schemes deliberately shift saturation or lightness. **Adherence** measures the hue angles the colours actually have against the scheme's ideal ones, so you can see how strictly a harmony keeps to its theory. Across the collection, 6,521 harmonies score 85% or more.

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Save harmonies

Save harmonies, find them on the Saved tab, and reach them from your Library.

Save

Select **Save** on a card (it becomes **Saved**), or **Save to library** under **Quick export** on **Inspect** (the page confirms **Saved**). The **Saved** tab's badge goes up.

Find your saved harmonies

Open the **Saved** tab. Harmonies appear as cards, most recently saved first, with a note that they are **Also saved to your Library workspace with image previews**. With nothing saved, the tab says **No saved**

harmonies yet.

Unsave

Select **Saved** on the card, or **Unsave** on **Inspect (Removed)**. The harmony also leaves your Library.

In your Library

Each saved harmony is added to your Library as a palette named, for example, **Harmony har_5k**, described by its method, family and number of colours. Open your Library from any page with **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **L**. See the [Library Kit docs](#).

Limits

- Up to 500 harmonies are kept; saving more drops the oldest.
- Saves are kept in this browser only. Clearing site data removes them. Noting a harmony's id is a permanent way to find it again.

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [COLOUR LIBRARIES](#) > [HARMONY LIBRARY](#)

Harmony Library reference

Every control, filter, sort order, tab, output and message in the Harmony Library.

Everything on <https://auricartisan.com/library/harmony/>.

Heading

Item	Content
Kicker	Auric Artisan · Harmony
Headline	Eight thousand schemes, and none of them stored.
Facts	Collection 8,192, 23 methods, Derived, not stored
Read the API guide →	The Harmony Library API guide.
Automate this note	3 API credits per call to GET /v1/harmony/library; API docs; × dismisses.

What harmony is this?

Control	What it does	Default
Colour swatch	Opens a colour picker.	—

Control	What it does	Default
Colour field	Any CSS colour.	#E4572E , #2EE457 , #572EE4
×	Removes a colour; hidden at two.	—
Add a colour	Adds the opposite of the first colour; up to 12.	—
Identify it	Runs the match again.	—

Output	Meaning
Verdict	Scheme name (fit ≥ 0.85), Close to ... (0.65 to 0.85), Not one of the 23 (below 0.65).
fit	0 to 1, three decimals.
Note	Angle error, or schemes indistinguishable by hue.
Family, Base colour, Worst pair, Best pair	Family, best base, lowest and highest pair contrast ((AA) at 4.5:1).
Also considered	Up to four runners-up with fit.

Browse controls

Control	What it does
Search by id, hex or method...	An id (<code>har_...</code>) or number shows that harmony; other words must match id, method, family or a hex.
Shuffle	Sort Random .
Open a random harmony	Opens any harmony on Inspect .
Filter inside results (id, hex, method...)	Second search.
Clear	Empties the second search.

Tabs

Library (badge: matches), **Inspect**, **Theory**, **Accessibility**, **Stats**, **Export**, **Saved** (badge: saved).

Filters

Filter	Options
Base hue	All hues , Red (340° to under 20°), Orange (20–50°), Yellow (50–80°), Green (80–160°), Cyan (160–200°), Blue (200–260°), Purple (260–300°), Pink (300–340°)

Filter	Options
Chroma	Any chroma, Muted (< 0.07)**, **Balanced**, **Vivid (> 0.15)
Lightness	Any lightness, Dark (< 0.40), **Mid** (0.40–0.70), **Light** (> 0.70)
Method	All methods and 23 methods (does not currently narrow the grid; search the method name instead)
Family	All families, Complementary, Polyadic, Analogous, Monochromatic, Compound

Sort by

Sort: original (default), **Lightness** ↑, **Lightness** ↓, **Chroma** ↑, **Chroma** ↓, **Hue (rainbow)**, **Color count** ↑, **Color count** ↓, **Random**.

Library tab buttons

Reset (clears searches, filters and sort), **Export visible** (opens **Export**), **Back to top**.

Card

Swatches (select to copy), id, scheme, **Inspect**, **Copy** (all hexes), **Save** / **Saved**. Select the card to inspect.

Inspect tab

Block	Contents
Colour strip	Role, descriptive name, hex; select to copy.
Harmony summary	Harmony ID, Global index, Scheme, Family, Colors, Base hue, Avg L* (OKLCH), Avg chroma, Hue span, DeltaE avg, Adherence, Entropy, Min pair contrast, Max pair contrast
Color-theory scheme	Description, Canonical angles, Color roles, Base HSL
Pair-by-pair WCAG contrast	Every pair by role.
Quick export	Copy HEX, Copy CSS vars, Copy SCSS, Copy Tailwind, Download JSON, Download ASE, Download SVG, Download PNG, Open in Colors, Save to library / Unsave, Copy share link, Design tokens...
Colour cards	Role, HEX, RGB, HSL, OKLCH, CIE L*a*b*, WCAG vs white, WCAG vs black

Analysis tabs

Tab	Cards
Theory	Color-theory scheme, Family, Dominant hue bucket, Color count, Adherence to canonical scheme, Lightness & chroma profile
Accessibility	Harmony-level WCAG summary, Pair-level WCAG breakdown, Visible harmonies where every pair passes AA
Stats	Avg lightness (OKLCH L), Avg chroma (OKLCH C), Hue spread, Min pair contrast, Adherence, Colors per harmony

Export tab

Card	Buttons
Selection · id	HEX list, CSS variables, SCSS variables, Tailwind config; JSON, Adobe ASE, SVG strip, PNG strip; Open in Coolors
Visible page	Download JSON (visible page), Download CSV (visible page), Download CSS variables, Download SCSS variables, Download compact JSON; Download .txt hex list, Download tailwind.config.js fragment

Files

Output	Name
One harmony	<code><id>.json</code> , <code><id>.ase</code> , <code><id>.svg</code> , <code><id>.png</code>
Bulk	<code>harmony-page-<count>-<date>.<ext></code>
Design tokens ZIP	<code>harmony-<id>.zip</code>

Messages

Message	When
Loading harmony database...	While loading.
Could not load harmony database	Loading failed.
No harmonies match	Nothing matches.
No harmony selected	Inspect before opening one.
No harmonies	An analysis tab with nothing matching.
No saved harmonies yet	Nothing saved.

Message	When
No scheme uses N colours	The identifier has a colour count no scheme uses.
Colour N is not a colour yet	An identifier field is not a colour.
#HEX copied, Harmony hexes copied, HEX list copied, CSS variables copied, SCSS variables copied, Tailwind config copied, Copied	After copying.
Downloaded and a file name	After a download.
Saved, Removed	After saving or unsaving on Inspect .
Nothing to export	Bulk export with no matches.
Shared harmony not found in current dataset	A share link could not be matched.

Keyboard

/ focuses search; **Enter** or **Space** on a focused swatch opens its harmony; **Escape** closes the share and design tokens dialogs.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > HARMONY LIBRARY

Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes for problems in the Harmony Library.

"Could not load harmony database"

Why: The small description of the collection could not be downloaded.

What to do: Check your connection and any content blocker, and reload.

The page is slow to open

Why: All 8,192 harmonies are calculated in your browser when the page opens, so that every filter looks at the whole collection. On an older device this can take a moment.

What to do: Wait for the grid to appear. After that, filtering is immediate.

Choosing a Method does not change the grid

Why: On the current page, the **Method** filter does not narrow the results.

What to do: Type the method's name into the search box, for example `triadic` or `golden_ratio`. Use **Family** for broader groups.

"No scheme uses N colours"

Why: The schemes have between two and seven colours. With eight or more colours there is nothing to compare.

What to do: Remove colours until you have seven or fewer.

The identifier names several schemes

Why: Some schemes differ only in lightness or saturation, which hue matching cannot see: shades, tints and neutral share a shape with monochromatic 5; warm cool with complementary; triad shifted with triadic.

What to do: Choose between them by looking at your colours' lightness and saturation. See the scheme descriptions in the [Glossary](#).

My palette is "Not one of the 23"

Why: Its hues do not sit near any scheme's pattern. As the page says, most palettes in the world are not one of 23 schemes.

What to do: Nothing needs fixing. If you want a textbook scheme, the runners-up under **Also considered** show which is nearest.

Few harmonies have text-safe pairs

Why: Harmonies are defined by hue. Unless their colours also differ strongly in lightness, no pair reaches 4.5:1. About a quarter of the collection has at least one AA pair.

What to do: Use the **Accessibility** tab to see which harmonies do, or pair a harmony with a neutral text colour from the [Accessibility Library](#).

A share link does not open the harmony

Why: The link was cut short or edited.

What to do: Ask for the id and search for it.

Saved harmonies have gone

Why: Saves live in this browser only (up to 500).

What to do: Save them again, or keep their ids.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > HARMONY LIBRARY

Harmony Library FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Harmony Library.

What is a colour harmony?

A set of colours whose hues sit in a deliberate pattern on the colour wheel: opposite (complementary), evenly spaced (triadic, square, pentadic, hexadic), neighbouring (analogous) or one hue at different lightness (monochromatic).

How many schemes are there?

23, in five families. See the list in the [Glossary](#).

Why "none of them stored"?

Each harmony is calculated from a fixed seed when needed, so the same id always gives the same colours, and anyone can recalculate it.

Can it tell me my palette's harmony?

Yes: **What harmony is this?** matches 2 to 12 colours against every scheme with the same number of colours. See [Identify your colours' harmony](#).

Does the colour order matter?

No. Each colour is tried as the base.

Why does it ignore lightness?

Harmony schemes are defined by hue angles. Lightness and saturation are what make a scheme usable for text, which is why the page reports pair contrast separately.

What does adherence mean?

How closely a harmony's actual hues keep to its scheme's ideal angles, from 0% to 100%.

Do I need an account?

No.

Is there an API?

Yes. The heading links to the Harmony Library API guide, and the **Automate this** note names **GET /v1/harmony/library**. See [Public API](#).

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Harmony Library: other material

Supporting material for the Harmony Library: glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages, privacy and release notes.

Background material for the Harmony Library.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Terms, and all 23 schemes with family, colours, angles and description.
Shortcuts	Keyboard and pointer actions.
Limits and accuracy	What the identifier and the figures can and cannot tell you.
Related	Related libraries, tools and Learn articles.
Privacy	What stays in your browser.
Release notes	User-facing history.

[Back to the Harmony Library overview.](#)

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Harmony Library shortcuts

Keyboard and pointer actions in the Harmony Library.

Keys or action	Where	Result
/	Anywhere, when not typing	Focuses Search by id, hex or method...
Enter or Space	A focused swatch in the grid	Opens its harmony on Inspect .
Escape	Share link or design tokens dialog	Closes it.
Select a swatch	Grid	Copies its hex.
Select a column	Inspect strip	Copies its hex.
Select a card heading	Inspect	Folds or unfolds the card.

The site-wide shortcuts also work here. See [Site features](#).

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Harmony Library glossary

Definitions of the terms and all 23 colour-theory schemes used in the Harmony Library.

Terms

Term	Meaning
Adherence	How closely a harmony's actual hues keep to its scheme's canonical angles, from 0% to 100%.
Base	The colour a scheme is built around. Other colours are placed at angles from its hue.
Canonical angles	A scheme's ideal hue offsets from the base, such as 120° and 240° for triadic.
Colour wheel	Hues arranged in a circle from 0° to 360° (red, yellow, green, cyan, blue, magenta and back to red).
Contrast ratio	The WCAG 2 lightness-difference measure between two colours, from 1:1 to 21:1. 4.5:1 is AA for body text.
Family	A group of related schemes: complementary, polyadic, analogous, monochromatic or compound.
Fit	In What harmony is this? : 1 minus the average angle error divided by 60°, never below 0.
Harmony id	har_ followed by the harmony's number in base 36.
Hue span	The widest angle between two of a harmony's hues.
Role	What a colour does in its scheme: base, complement, ally, accent and so on.
Scheme (method)	One of the 23 rules for placing hues.

The 23 schemes

Scheme	Family	Colours	Canonical angles	Description (as the page gives it)
complementary	complementary	2	180°	Base hue and its 180° opposite — the strongest possible contrast pair.
split_complementary	complementary	3	150°, 210°	Base plus two hues flanking its complement — softer than complementary.
double_complementary	complementary	4	30°, 180°, 210°	Two pairs of complements offset by a small angle.
triadic	polyadic	3	120°, 240°	Three hues spaced 120° apart — vibrant and well-balanced.
triad_shifted	polyadic	3	120°, 240°	Triadic with chroma + lightness shifts for hierarchy.
tetradic	polyadic	4	60°, 180°, 240°	Two complementary pairs forming a rectangle on the wheel.
square	polyadic	4	90°, 180°, 270°	Four hues spaced 90° apart — bold and evenly weighted.
pentadic	polyadic	5	72°, 144°, 216°, 288°	Five hues equally spaced (72°).

Scheme	Family	Colours	Canonical angles	Description (as the page gives it)
hexadic	polyadic	6	60°, 120°, 180°, 240°, 300°	Six hues at 60° intervals — full color-wheel coverage.
analogous_3	analogous	3	−24°, 24°	Three neighbouring hues — harmonious, low-tension.
analogous_5	analogous	5	−44°, −22°, 22°, 44°	Five neighbouring hues for richer analogous palettes.
analogous_7	analogous	7	−54° to 54° in 18° steps	Seven analogous hues — long ramp suitable for illustration.
accented_analogous	analogous	4	−24°, 24°, 180°	Three analogous hues plus one complementary accent.
monochromatic_3	monochromatic	3	0°	Three lightness/saturation steps of one hue.
monochromatic_5	monochromatic	5	0°	Five-step single-hue ramp.
monochromatic_7	monochromatic	7	0°	Seven-step single-hue ramp — UI-friendly tonal scale.
shades	monochromatic	5	0°	Five-step ramp from base toward black.
tints	monochromatic	5	0°	Five-step ramp from base toward white.
neutral	monochromatic	5	0°	Desaturated greyscale tinted toward the base hue.
compound	compound	5	24°, 180°, 156°, 210°	Base + warm/cool shifts + complement + accent.
warm_cool	compound	2	180°	Base paired with its temperature-flipped counterpart.
golden_ratio	compound	5	137.5°, 275.01°, 52.51°, 190.01°	Hues rotated by the golden angle (137.5°).
fibonacci_hue	compound	5	34.4°, 68.8°, 103.1°, 171.9°	Fibonacci-indexed golden-angle distribution.

Analogous angles are measured from the middle colour. Monochromatic schemes keep one hue and vary lightness and saturation.

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Limits and accuracy

What the Harmony Library's identifier, adherence and contrast figures measure, and what they do not.

The identifier

- It compares hue only, measured as the HSL hue of each colour. Two palettes with the same hues but very different lightness get the same answer.
- Five schemes cannot be separated by hue (shades, tints and neutral from monochromatic 5; warm cool from complementary; triad shifted from triadic). The page names all of them rather than guessing.
- Very grey colours have an unstable hue: a tiny change in value can swing the hue angle a long way. Identifying a palette of near-greys gives an unreliable answer.
- It only compares schemes with the same number of colours as you entered.
- The fit bands (0.85 and 0.65) are guides for how deliberate a pattern looks, not rules of colour theory.

The collection

- Colours are generated in HSL from each scheme's rule and a base colour whose saturation is between 45% and 95% and lightness between 35% and 80%. HSL hue steps are not perfectly even to the eye, which is one reason adherence varies.
- The **Base hue** filter uses the harmony's overall hue (a weighted average of its colours' OKLCH hues), which can differ from the base colour's own hue.
- Scheme descriptions are the page's short summaries of common colour-theory practice, not formal definitions.

Contrast

Pair contrast uses the WCAG 2 formula. It is one requirement for readable text among several; size, weight and context matter too.

Your screen

Swatches look different on different displays; the values do not change.

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Privacy

What the Harmony Library keeps in your browser and what it fetches over the network.

What stays in your browser

What	How to remove it
Saved harmony ids (up to 500)	Unsave each one, or clear this site's data.
A copy of each saved harmony in your Library	Unsave it, or remove it in the Library.

What	How to remove it
Whether you dismissed the Automate this note	Clear this site's data.

The colours you type into **What harmony is this?** are matched in your browser and never sent anywhere.

What uses the network

- On opening, the page downloads a 5 KB description of the collection from auricartisan.com; the harmonies are calculated in your browser.
- **Open in Colors** sends the harmony's hex codes to colors.co in the address of a new tab.
- **Download all** in the design tokens dialog may fetch a small helper from auricartisan.com.
- Share links carry the harmony in the link; nothing is uploaded.

Advertising and analytics follow your consent choices. See [Company and legal](#).

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Release notes

User-facing history of the Harmony Library.

0.9.9 — 5 June 2026

The Harmony Library was added in release 0.9.9 as part of the library expansion. See the [Changelog](#).

The current page

The page now calculates all 8,192 harmonies when it opens, so filters and the analysis tabs cover the whole collection rather than one page of it, and **What harmony is this?** identifies the scheme behind your own colours. Every tab is shown at once (an earlier Simple/Advanced switch has gone). These changes are not listed as a separate changelog release.

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Related

Libraries, tools and Learn articles that work alongside the Harmony Library.

Other colour libraries

- [Palette Library](#) — five million five-colour palettes.
- [Accessibility Library](#) — text and background pairs scored for contrast.
- [Color Library](#), [Gradient Library](#) and [Shade Library](#).

Tools

- [Basic Tools](#) — build and remix palettes.
- [Personalisation Generator](#) — palettes conditioned on your preferences.
- [Contrast Checker](#).
- [Your Library](#).

Learn articles

- [Color Theory and Harmony](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-04-color-theory-and-harmony) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-04-color-theory-and-harmony>
- [Accessible Color Design and WCAG Contrast](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color>
- [Oklab and Oklch: Modern Perceptual Color Spaces](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces>

Guides and API

- The Harmony Library user guide in the [Documentation](#) library.
- [Public API](#).

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Palette Library

What the Palette Library is, who it is for, where to find it and how to find and export your first palette.

The Palette Library is a browsable collection of 5,000,000 five-colour palettes. The page headline is "Five million palettes, *and a 660-byte file*": the collection is not stored as a list, because written out in full it would take 3.9 GB. Instead, every palette is worked out from a fixed starting number (a seed) the moment you scroll to it. The same palette id always gives the same five colours, on any computer, so an id such as `pal_abc` is a stable reference you can write down or share.

That design has one consequence the page is open about. Nothing can look at five million palettes at once, so a filter does not narrow a list — it starts a scan through the collection, and the counter under the grid tells you how many palettes were worked out to find the ones you are looking at. The analysis tabs (Harmony, Accessibility, Stats) likewise measure a sample and say how big it was.

For each palette you can read every colour in HEX, RGB, OKLCH and CIE Lab, check the contrast between every pair of its colours and against white and black, copy it as CSS, SCSS or Tailwind, download it as JSON, Adobe ASE, SVG or PNG, export it as design tokens for eight platforms, share a link to it, or save it to your Library.

Who it is for

- Designers looking for palette ideas they can inspect and trust, not only look at.
- Front-end developers who want a palette as CSS variables, SCSS, Tailwind or design tokens.
- Accessibility specialists checking which colours in a palette can carry text on each other.
- Students exploring how colours are distributed across a very large generated collection.

Where to find it

Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/palette/> in a current browser. It is also listed as **Palette Library** ("Scientific color palettes") under **Libraries** in the site header's **Learn** menu. No account or installation is needed.

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/palette/>. The grid fills with palettes, starting with `pal_0`.
2. Select a single colour in any palette to copy its hex code.
3. Choose **Vivid (> 0.15)** in **Chroma** and **Blue** in **Dominant hue**. The page scans the collection and shows matching palettes; the counter under the grid says how many were derived.
4. Select **Inspect** on a palette you like. The **Inspect** tab opens.
5. Read **Pair-by-pair WCAG contrast** to see which of its colours can carry text on each other.
6. Select **Copy CSS vars** under **Quick export**, and paste the result into your stylesheet.

7. Select **Save to library** to keep it.

What you can do

- Scroll through all 5,000,000 palettes, or jump straight to any palette by its id.
- Search by id, hex code or generation method, and filter by dominant hue, average chroma, average lightness and method.
- Sort by lightness, chroma or hue, or shuffle.
- Inspect a palette: descriptive colour names, summary metrics, pair contrast and per-colour values.
- See how methods, hues, harmony types and contrast are distributed across a sample, on the **Harmony**, **Accessibility** and **Stats** tabs.
- Copy a palette as a hex list, CSS variables, SCSS variables or a Tailwind snippet.
- Download it as JSON, Adobe Swatch Exchange (ASE), SVG or PNG, or open it in Coolors.
- Export it as design tokens in eight formats, including W3C Design Tokens, Material UI, SwiftUI and Android.
- Share a link that opens the same palette for anyone.
- Save palettes in your browser and find them in your Library.
- Download a whole sample of palettes as JSON, CSV, CSS, SCSS, plain text or Tailwind.

In this folder

- [docs/](#) — how to use the Palette Library.
 - [Getting started](#) — open the page, the screen tour and a first palette.
 - [Browse, search and filter](#) — scanning, the counter, ids, filters and sorting.
 - [Inspect a palette](#) — everything on the **Inspect** tab.
 - [Analyse the collection](#) — the **Harmony**, **Accessibility** and **Stats** tabs.
 - [Copy, export and share](#) — every copy format, download, design tokens and share links.
 - [Save palettes](#) — the **Saved** tab and your Library.
 - [Reference](#) — every control, output and message.
 - [Troubleshooting](#) — symptoms, causes and fixes.
 - [FAQ](#) — short answers.
- [others/](#) — background material.
 - [Glossary](#), [Shortcuts](#), [Limits and accuracy](#), [Related](#), [Privacy](#), [Release notes](#).

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Palette Library documentation

The task guides, reference, troubleshooting and FAQ for the Palette Library.

This folder holds the task guides for the Palette Library, the full reference of its controls and outputs, and the troubleshooting and FAQ pages. Start with Getting started if you are new to the page.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	Opening the page, a tour of the screen and a first palette from search to export.
browse-search-and-filter.md	Scrolling five million palettes, jumping to an id, searching, filtering, sorting and reading the counter.
inspect-a-palette.md	The Inspect tab: colour names, summary metrics, pair contrast, per-colour values.
analyse-the-collection.md	The Harmony , Accessibility and Stats tabs and the samples they measure.
copy-export-and-share.md	Copy formats, downloads, Colors, design tokens, share links and bulk export.
save-palettes.md	Saving, the Saved tab and your Library.
reference.md	Every control, filter, sort, output, file name and message.
troubleshooting.md	What to do when something does not behave as expected.
faq.md	Short answers to common questions.

[Back to the Palette Library overview.](#)

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Getting started

Open the Palette Library, learn what each part of the screen does, and find, inspect and export a first palette.

Open the page

1. Go to <https://auricartisan.com/library/palette/>, or open the **Learn** menu in the site header and select **Palette Library** under **Libraries**.
2. While the page prepares, the grid area shows **Loading palette database....** This takes a moment only: the page downloads a tiny description of the collection, not the palettes themselves.
3. When it is ready, the grid fills with palettes and the counter under the grid reads, for example, **1–48 of 5,000,000 palettes**.

If loading fails you see **Could not load palette database** with the reason. See [Troubleshooting](#).

A tour of the screen

The heading

The kicker reads **Auric Artisan · Palette** and the headline **Five million palettes, and a 660-byte file**. A short paragraph explains that the collection is worked out as you scroll rather than stored. The line under it shows **Collection 5,000,000, Five colours each** and **Derived, not stored**, with a link, **Read the API guide** →, to the Palette Library's API guide.

A note starting **Automate this** may appear under the heading. It says the same job can be done through the site's REST API — **3 API credits per call to GET /v1/palette/library** — and links to **API docs**. It also points out that API credits are a separate balance from your tool tokens. Select × to dismiss it; it stays hidden in this browser.

Browse the collection

- A search box, **Search by id or hex...**
- **Shuffle** — puts the grid in a random order.
- **Open a random palette** — picks any palette from all five million and opens it on the **Inspect** tab.
- A second row, **Filter inside results**, with its own box (**id, hex, method...**) and a **Clear** button.

The tabs

Tab	What it shows
Library	Filters, sort and the palette grid. Its badge shows the size of the collection, 5M .
Inspect	Everything about the palette you last opened.
Harmony	How methods, hues and harmony types are distributed in a sample.
Accessibility	Which palettes contain colours that can carry text on each other.
Stats	Histograms of lightness, chroma, hue spread and best-pair contrast.
Export	Copy and download buttons for the open palette and for a sample of palettes.
Saved	The palettes you have saved. Its badge shows how many.

The Library tab

- Filters: **Dominant hue, Chroma, Lightness, Method** and **Sort by**, then **Reset** and **Export visible**.
- The grid. Each card is a strip of five colours with their hex codes, the palette id (such as **pal_0**), its generation method, and three buttons: **Inspect, Copy** and **Save**.
- Under the grid, the counter and a **Back to top** button.

Your first task: find a calm, dark palette and use it in CSS

1. Under **Lightness**, choose **Dark**.
2. Under **Chroma**, choose **Muted (< 0.07)**.
3. Watch the counter under the grid. It reads, for example, **96 matches from 1,500 derived**: the page has worked out 1,500 palettes and 96 of them are dark and muted. Scroll down and it keeps looking.
4. Select any colour in a card to copy its hex code, or select **Copy** to copy all five.
5. Select **Inspect** on the palette you like best.
6. On the **Inspect** tab, read the colour names across the top strip (for example "deep muted blue") and the **Palette summary**.
7. Under **Quick export**, select **Copy CSS vars**. The page confirms **CSS variables copied**.
8. Paste into your stylesheet. You get five custom properties named after the palette id, for example `--pal_2f-1` to `--pal_2f-5`.

Result: a dark, muted five-colour palette in your stylesheet, with its id noted so you can find it again.

Next steps

- [Browse, search and filter](#) explains why filtering scans and how to read the counter.
- [Inspect a palette](#) explains every number on the **Inspect** tab.
- [Copy, export and share](#) covers design tokens, ASE files and share links.

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Analyse the collection

Use the **Harmony**, **Accessibility** and **Stats** tabs to see how methods, hues, contrast and lightness are distributed across a sample of palettes.

The **Harmony**, **Accessibility** and **Stats** tabs describe many palettes at once. A browser cannot count five million palettes, so each tab measures a sample and says how big it was.

The sample

Every tab opens with a line such as:

Measured on 2,000 palettes from the start of the collection. Five million cannot be counted in a browser, so these are a sample — the API samples the same way.

- **No filter or search:** the sample is the first 2,000 palettes of the collection.
- **A filter or search is on:** the page looks through up to 40,000 palettes from the start of the collection and keeps up to 2,000 that match. The line then says, for example, **Measured on 812 palettes matching this**

filter, out of 40,000 derived.

- **An id is in the search box:** the sample is that one palette.

The sample is rebuilt every time you change a filter or search, so the tabs always describe the filter the grid is showing. If nothing in the looked-at stretch matches, the tabs show **No palettes** and suggest widening the filter.

Harmony tab

Four cards, each a bar chart with counts:

Card	What it counts
Generation method	How many sampled palettes carry each method label.
Dominant hue bucket	How many have each dominant hue: red, orange, yellow, green, cyan, blue, purple or pink.
Harmony classification	How many are classified Neutral , Triadic , Analogous or Monochrome from their measured hues (see Inspect a palette).
Lightness & chroma profile	How many are Dark ($L < 0.4$)**, **Mid ($0.4-0.7$ **) or **Light (> 0.7), and Muted (< 0.07 **), **Balanced** or **Vivid (> 0.15).

Accessibility tab

Palette-level WCAG summary

Row	Meaning
Has any AA pair (4.5+)	Palettes with at least one pair of colours at 4.5:1 or more, as a count and percentage.
Has any AAA pair (7+)	Palettes with at least one pair at 7:1 or more.
Largest mutually-legible set	The most colours from one palette that all reach 4.5:1 against each other, for example 2 of 5 (sRGB allows 3).

Pair-level WCAG breakdown

Every palette has ten pairs, so the sample has ten times as many pairs as palettes. The card counts **AAA pairs** ($\geq 7:1$), **AA pairs** ($\geq 4.5:1$) and **Below AA**.

How many of the five can be used together

This card answers a practical question: how many of a palette's five colours can all be used as text on each other? The page explains why the answer can never be five. Contrast depends only on how light each colour is, and between black and white there is room for at most three lightness levels that are each 4.5:1 apart — and only two at 7:1. So **no five-colour palette can have all ten pairs at AA**, here or anywhere. The card shows how many sampled palettes allow 1, 2 or 3 mutually legible colours, marking 3 as **(the ceiling)**.

The most usable in this sample

Up to 24 palettes that contain at least one legible pair, ordered by their strongest pair. The page notes that two is what this collection realistically offers: a legible trio needs a near-black, a mid-tone and a near-white to turn up together in one palette, which the page reports did not happen in any of the 60,000 palettes it measured. The cards work like cards in the grid: select one to inspect it, select a swatch to copy it.

Stats tab

A line first states how many sampled palettes contain a pair at 4.5:1 or better, "so they can carry body text on themselves". Then four histograms:

Card	Range	Bands
Avg lightness (OKLCH L)	0 to 1	10
Avg chroma (OKLCH C)	0 to 0.30	10
Hue spread	0 to 360 degrees	12
Best pair contrast	1:1 to 15:1	14

Values beyond a histogram's range are counted in its last band. The best pair is charted rather than the worst because, as the page explains, with five colours some pair is nearly always close to identical, so the worst pair says little about whether a palette can carry text.

Keeping the tabs current

Each tab is drawn when you open it and redrawn after any change of filter or search. If a tab looks out of date, select it again.

Result

You can see, for any filter, what share of palettes can carry text, which methods and hues dominate, and how light and colourful the palettes tend to be — with the size of the sample stated every time.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > PALETTE LIBRARY

Browse, search and filter

Scroll five million palettes, jump to a palette by id, search, filter and sort, and read the counter that says how far a scan went.

How the collection works

Each palette has a number from 0 to 4,999,999, and an id made from that number: `pal_` followed by the number written in base 36 (digits 0–9 then letters a–z). Palette 0 is `pal_0`, palette 10 is `pal_a`, palette 13,368 is `pal_abc`. The five colours of a palette are worked out from its number every time you need them, so they never change.

Because every palette can be reached by its number, the unfiltered grid can show any part of the collection instantly. A filtered grid cannot: the only way to find the hundredth blue palette is to look through every palette before it. So the page scans forward in chunks as you scroll, and the counter under the grid tells you how far it has looked.

Scroll the whole collection

With no search or filter:

- The grid starts at `pal_0` and scrolls continuously.
- The counter reads, for example, **1–48 of 5,000,000 palettes**.
- A browser cannot make a page tall enough to scroll through five million palettes, so the scrollbar stops before the end. When it does, the counter adds **scroll reaches N; search an id for the rest**. Every palette beyond that point can still be opened by searching for its id.
- **Back to top** returns to `pal_0`.

Jump to a palette by id

1. Type an id into **Search by id or hex...**, for example `pal_abc`, or type the palette's number, for example `13368`.
2. The grid shows only that palette, and the counter reads **1 palette, by id**.
3. If the id is outside the collection, the counter reads **No palette with that id**.

An id or number anywhere in either search box takes priority over everything else: filters are ignored while an id is shown.

Search by hex or method

Type anything that is not an id, for example `#3a` or `analogous`. A palette matches when every word you type is found in:

- its id; or
- its generation method; or
- the hex code of any of its five colours (with or without `#`).

The **Filter inside results** box works the same way; words in both boxes are combined. **Clear** empties only the second box.

Searching counts as a filter, so it starts a scan (see below).

Filters

Filter	Options	What it tests
Dominant hue	All hues, Red, Orange, Yellow, Green, Cyan, Blue, Purple, Pink	The palette's overall hue: the average of its five OKLCH hues, weighted so that more colourful colours count more.
Chroma	Any chroma, Muted (< 0.07)**, **Balanced**, **Vivid (> 0.15)	The average OKLCH chroma of the five colours. Balanced is 0.07 to 0.15.
Lightness	Any lightness, Dark, Mid, Light	The average OKLCH lightness: Dark below 0.40, Mid 0.40 to 0.70, Light above 0.70.
Method	All methods, complementary, triadic, analogous, tetradic, golden_ratio, random, monochromatic	The generation method the palette is labelled with.

All filters and searches combine: a palette must pass every one.

Read the counter while filtering

With any filter or search active, the counter reads, for example:

- **96 matches from 1,500 derived** — the page has worked out 1,500 palettes so far and 96 of them match.
- **4,210 matches from 5,000,000 derived · all five million looked at** — the scan has reached the end of the collection.

Scroll down to make the scan continue; each step works out another stretch of palettes. A rare filter combination may need to look through many palettes before the first match. Until then the grid shows **Nothing matched yet** with the advice **Scroll to keep looking, or widen the filter — a rare one can go a long way into five million before the first hit.**

Sort

Sort by has these options:

Option	Order
Sort: original	By palette number (default).
Lightness ↑	Darkest palettes first (average OKLCH lightness).

Option	Order
Lightness ↓	Lightest first.
Chroma ↑	Least colourful first (average chroma).
Chroma ↓	Most colourful first.
Hue (rainbow)	By dominant hue, from 0°.
Random	Shuffled.

Five million palettes cannot be put in order in a browser. Any sort other than **Sort: original** therefore works on a bounded first stretch of the collection — the first 1,500 palettes the page works out, or the matches among them when a filter is on — and orders those. With a filter on, the counter says so, for example **96 matches, ordered within the first 1,500 derived**. The sorted grid does not grow as you scroll.

Tip: To see, say, the most colourful palettes of one method, choose the method first and then **Chroma ↓**. You are ordering the matches the page has found, not the whole collection.

Shuffle, random, reset

- **Shuffle** sets **Sort by** to **Random**. Like any sort, it shuffles the first stretch of the collection.
- **Open a random palette** picks a palette from anywhere in the five million and opens it on **Inspect**.
- **Reset** empties both search boxes, sets every filter back to "All" or "Any", and sets the sort back to **Sort: original**.
- **Export visible** opens the **Export** tab.

Cards

Each card shows:

- five swatches, each labelled with its hex code — select a swatch to copy that hex code (the page confirms, for example, **#3A5F8C copied**);
- the palette id and its method;
- **Inspect** — opens the palette on the **Inspect** tab (selecting the card anywhere outside the buttons and swatches does the same);
- **Copy** — copies all five hex codes, separated by commas (**Palette hexes copied**);
- **Save** or **Saved** — saves or unsaves the palette.

With the keyboard, **Tab** moves between swatches; **Enter** or **Space** on a swatch opens its palette on **Inspect**.

Result

You can reach any of the five million palettes directly by id, or scan for palettes with the hue, chroma, lightness or method you need, and the counter always tells you how much of the collection the answer is based on.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > PALETTE LIBRARY

Copy, export and share

Copy a palette as hex, CSS, SCSS or Tailwind, download it as JSON, ASE, SVG or PNG, export design tokens, share a link, and download many palettes at once.

Quick copies from the grid

- Select one swatch to copy that colour's hex code.
- Select **Copy** on a card to copy all five hex codes separated by commas, for example `#28ACE4, #715ED2, #F84461, #6F30E7, #BBC8BA`.

Export one palette

Open the palette on the **Inspect** tab (see [Inspect a palette](#)). You can then use either the **Quick export** row on **Inspect**, or the **Selection** card on the **Export** tab. They produce the same results.

If no palette is open, the **Export** tab says **No palette selected. Click Inspect on any card in the Library tab to enable selection exports.**

Copy formats

The examples use palette `pal_0`. Variable names are built from the palette id and the colour's position, 1 to 5.

Quick export	Export tab	What is copied
Copy HEX	HEX list	The five hex codes, one per line.
Copy CSS vars	CSS variables	A <code>:root</code> block with one custom property per colour.
Copy SCSS	SCSS variables	Five Sass variables.
Copy Tailwind	Tailwind config	A colour object you can paste into <code>theme.extend.colors</code> .

```
:root {
  --pal_0-1: #28ACE4;
  --pal_0-2: #715ED2;
  --pal_0-3: #F84461;
  --pal_0-4: #6F30E7;
  --pal_0-5: #BBC8BA;
}
```

```
$pal_0-1: #28ACE4;
$pal_0-2: #715ED2;
$pal_0-3: #F84461;
$pal_0-4: #6F30E7;
$pal_0-5: #BBC8BA;
```

```
{
  "pal_0": {
    "c1": "#28ACE4",
    "c2": "#715ED2",
    "c3": "#F84461",
    "c4": "#6F30E7",
    "c5": "#BBC8BA"
  }
}
```

These are the real colours of `pal_0`, which is labelled **complementary**.

Downloads

Quick export	Export tab	File	Contents
Download JSON	JSON	<code>pal_0.json</code>	The id, each colour's hex, RGB, OKLCH and Lab, and the metadata: method, colour count, average ΔE , entropy and the full 5×5 contrast table.
Download ASE	Adobe ASE	<code>pal_0.ase</code>	An Adobe Swatch Exchange file with five RGB swatches named <code>pal_0_1</code> to <code>pal_0_5</code> . Opens in Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign and other apps that read ASE.
Download SVG	SVG strip	<code>pal_0.svg</code>	A 600×220 strip of the five colours, each labelled with its hex code.
Download PNG	PNG strip	<code>pal_0.png</code>	An 800×320 image of the same strip.

The page confirms each download with **Downloaded** and the file name.

Open in Coolors

Open in Coolors (on **Inspect**, and under **External** on the **Export** tab) opens the palette on coolors.co in a new tab, with the five colours already loaded. Coolors is a separate website; what you do there is governed

by its own terms.

Export design tokens

Design tokens are named colour values in a format a design system or app platform understands.

1. On **Inspect**, select **Design tokens....** A dialog opens, titled with the palette id.
2. In **Token prefix**, type the name your tokens should start with. The default is **brand**.
3. Select a format tab. The preview shows the file, with a line above it giving the number of tokens, the file name and the file's length, for example **5 tokens · tokens.css** and a character count.
4. Select **Copy** to copy the preview, **Download** to save that format, or **Download all** to save every format in one ZIP file.

Format tab	File name
W3C Design Tokens	tokens.json
CSS Variables	tokens.css
SCSS	tokens.scss
Tailwind Config	tailwind.config.js
Style Dictionary	style-dictionary.tokens.json
Material UI Theme	theme.ts
iOS (SwiftUI)	Colors.swift
Android colors.xml	colors.xml

Download all names the ZIP after the palette, for example **palette-pal-0.zip**. Close the dialog with **×** or by selecting outside it.

Share a link

1. On **Inspect**, select **Copy share link**. The **Share link** dialog opens, titled with the palette id.
2. The dialog explains: "Anyone with this link can open a copy. State is encoded in the URL — no account needed."
3. Select **Copy** (it changes to **Copied!**), **Share via...** (on devices that offer a system share sheet), or **Open in new tab**.
4. Select **Close** when you are done.

Anyone who opens the link lands on the Palette Library with the palette open on **Inspect**. The link carries the palette's id and colours; nothing is stored on a server. If the palette cannot be found, the page says **Shared palette not found in current dataset**.

Export many palettes

The **Export** tab's second card is headed **Visible page** and carries a badge with a number of palettes. It exports the same sample the analysis tabs measure (see [Analyse the collection](#)): with no filter, the first 2,000 palettes of the collection; with a filter, up to 2,000 matching palettes from the first 40,000 looked at.

Group	Button	Contents
Bulk download	Download JSON (visible page)	Every palette in full, with export time, source and count.
	Download CSV (visible page)	One row per palette: <code>palette_id,method,c1,c2,c3,c4,c5</code> .
	Download CSS variables	One <code>:root</code> block with five variables per palette.
	Download SCSS variables	Five Sass variables per palette.
	Download compact JSON	The count and each palette's id and five hex codes.
Sample formats	Download .txt hex list	Every hex code, one per line.
	Download tailwind.config.js fragment	A Tailwind configuration with one colour group per palette.

Files are named `palette-page-` plus the number of palettes and the date, for example `palette-page-2000-2026-09-24.csv`. If the sample is empty, the page says **Nothing to export**.

Note: "Visible page" means the measured sample, not only the cards on your screen. To export exactly one palette, use the **Selection** card instead.

Result

The palette is on your clipboard, in a file your design tool or code can read, in a design-token format for your platform, or in a link someone else can open.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > PALETTE LIBRARY

Inspect a palette

Read everything on the Inspect tab: the colour strip, the palette summary, pair-by-pair contrast and each colour's values.

The **Inspect** tab turns one palette into a full report.

Open a palette

- Select **Inspect** on a card, or select the card outside its swatches and buttons.
- Focus a swatch and press `Enter` or `Space`.

- Select **Open a random palette**.
- Open a share link someone sent you (see [Copy, export and share](#)).

Before any palette is open, the tab shows **No palette selected** and explains what you will see.

The colour strip

Five tall columns, one per colour. Each shows:

- a descriptive name made of three words — a tone, a colourfulness and a hue — for example **soft muted blue**;
- the hex code.

Select a column to copy its hex code.

Word	Meaning (from OKLCH)
Tone: deep, rich, soft, pale	Lightness below 0.35, below 0.55, below 0.75, and 0.75 or more.
Colourfulness: neutral, muted, saturated, vivid	Chroma below 0.04, below 0.10, below 0.18, and 0.18 or more.
Hue: red, orange, yellow, green, teal, blue, purple, pink	The colour's OKLCH hue angle.

Palette summary

The **Palette summary** card carries a badge that classifies the palette from its real colours:

Badge	When
Neutral	Average chroma below 0.05.
Triadic	The widest gap between any two hues is more than 90°.
Analogous	The widest gap is more than 30°.
Monochrome	The widest gap is 30° or less.

The card's rows:

Row	Meaning
Palette ID	The id, such as <code>pal_abc</code> .
Global index	The palette's number in the collection.
Method	The generation method the palette is labelled with.
Colors	5.
Avg L* (OKLCH)	The average OKLCH lightness of the five colours, 0 to 1.

Row	Meaning
Avg chroma	The average OKLCH chroma.
Hue span	The widest angle between any two of the five hues, in degrees (0 to 180).
DeltaE avg	The average colour difference between each pair of colours (CIE76, in Lab). Larger means more varied.
Entropy	How many different hue families the palette covers, as a fraction: the number of 36° hue bands its colours fall in, divided by 5.
Min pair contrast	The lowest WCAG contrast ratio between any two of its colours.
Max pair contrast	The highest. If it is 4.5:1 or more, at least one pair can carry body text.

Note: The **Method** row and the badge can disagree. The method is the label the palette carries in the collection; the badge is measured from the colours themselves. When you need a particular relationship between hues, trust the badge and the **Hue span**.

Pair-by-pair WCAG contrast

All ten pairs of the five colours, each with its contrast ratio, for example **#1B2A4A / #F0E6D2 11.48 : 1**. Ratios of 4.5:1 or more are shown as good, 3:1 to 4.5:1 as a warning, and below 3:1 as failing.

Use this list to choose foreground and background pairs from the palette:

- 4.5:1 or more — normal body text (WCAG AA).
- 7:1 or more — normal text at AAA.
- 3:1 or more — large text (at least 18 point, or 14 point bold) and graphical objects such as icons.

Quick export

A row of actions for this palette: **Copy HEX**, **Copy CSS vars**, **Copy SCSS**, **Copy Tailwind**, **Download JSON**, **Download ASE**, **Download SVG**, **Download PNG**, **Open in Colors**, **Save to library** (or **Unsave**), **Copy share link** and **Design tokens...**. Each is described in [Copy, export and share](#).

One card per colour

Five cards, headed **Color 1** to **Color 5** with the hex code. The badge on each heading shows its contrast on white and on black, for example **6.6:1 / 3.2:1**. Each card lists:

Row	Format
HEX	#3A5F8C
RGB	rgb(58, 95, 140)
OKLCH	Lightness as a percentage, chroma and hue, for example 47.87% 0.085 254.14
CIE L*a*b*	L, a and b, for example 39.54, 1.04, -28.90
WCAG vs white	The contrast ratio against #FFFFFF.
WCAG vs black	The contrast ratio against #000000.

Two small buttons under the rows copy the hex code and the `rgb()` value.

Select any card's heading to fold it away, and again to unfold it.

Result

You know what each colour is called and measures, how varied the palette is, and exactly which of its colours can be used as text on which.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > PALETTE LIBRARY

Save palettes

Save palettes, find them on the Saved tab, and reach them from your Library.

Save a palette

Either:

- select **Save** on the palette's card in the grid (it changes to **Saved**); or
- open the palette on **Inspect** and select **Save to library** under **Quick export** (the page confirms **Saved**).

The **Saved** tab's badge goes up by one.

See your saved palettes

Select the **Saved** tab. Your palettes appear as cards, the most recently saved first. The cards work like cards in the grid: select a swatch to copy it, **Copy** to copy all five, **Inspect** to open the palette, or **Saved** to unsave it.

A note above the cards says your palettes are **Also saved to your Library workspace with image previews**, with a link.

With nothing saved, the tab shows **No saved palettes yet** and explains how to save one.

Remove a palette

Select **Saved** on its card, or **Unsave** under **Quick export** on **Inspect** (the page confirms **Removed**). The palette leaves the **Saved** tab and your Library.

In your Library

Each saved palette is also added to your Library as a palette named, for example, **Palette pal_abc**, described by its method and colour count, with a picture of its five colours. Open your Library from any page with

Ctrl + **Shift** + **L**. See the [Library Kit docs](#).

Limits

- The **Saved** tab keeps up to 500 palettes. Saving more drops the oldest from the list.
- Saved palettes are kept in this browser, not in your account. They do not follow you to another browser or device, and clearing this site's data removes them.

Because every palette is fixed by its id, writing down an id such as **pal_abc** is a permanent way to keep a palette: search for the id at any time to get the same five colours.

Result

Your chosen palettes are one tab away on the Palette Library and also in your Library next to everything else you have saved.

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [COLOUR LIBRARIES](#) > [PALETTE LIBRARY](#)

Palette Library reference

Every control, filter, sort order, tab, output, file name and message in the Palette Library.

Everything on <https://auricartisan.com/library/palette/>.

Heading

Item	Content
Kicker	Auric Artisan · Palette
Headline	Five million palettes, and a 660-byte file.
Collection	5,000,000
Facts	Five colours each, Derived, not stored

Item	Content
Read the API guide →	Opens the Palette Library API guide in the documentation library.
Automate this note	3 API credits per call to GET /v1/palette/library ; links to API docs ; × dismisses it.

Browse controls

Control	What it does	Default
Search by id or hex...	An id (pa1_...) or a number shows that one palette. Other words must each match the id, the method or a colour's hex.	Empty
Shuffle	Sets Sort by to Random .	—
Open a random palette	Opens any of the 5,000,000 palettes on Inspect .	—
Filter inside results box (id, hex, method...)	A second search, combined with the first.	Empty
Clear	Empties the second box.	—

Tabs

Tab	Badge	Contents
Library	5M	Filters, sort, grid, counter.
Inspect	—	The open palette.
Harmony	—	Method, hue, harmony and lightness/chroma distributions of the sample.
Accessibility	—	Pair-contrast summaries of the sample.
Stats	—	Four histograms of the sample.
Export	—	Selection and sample exports.
Saved	Number saved	Saved palettes.

Filters

Filter	Options	Test
Dominant hue	All hues , Red (340° to under 20°), Orange (20–50°), Yellow (50–80°), Green (80–160°), Cyan (160–200°), Blue (200–260°), Purple (260–300°), Pink (300–340°)	Chroma-weighted average of the five OKLCH hues.
Chroma	Any chroma , Muted (< 0.07)**, **Balanced** (0.07 to 0.15), **Vivid (> 0.15)	Average OKLCH chroma.
Lightness	Any lightness , Dark (below 0.40), Mid (0.40 to 0.70), Light (above 0.70)	Average OKLCH lightness.

Filter	Options	Test
Method	All methods, complementary, triadic, analogous, tetradic, golden_ratio, random, monochromatic	The palette's method label.

Sort by

Option	Order
Sort: original	Palette number (default). Streams through the whole collection.
Lightness ↑ / Lightness ↓	Average OKLCH lightness.
Chroma ↑ / Chroma ↓	Average OKLCH chroma.
Hue (rainbow)	Dominant hue.
Random	Shuffled.

Any sort other than **Sort: original** orders a first stretch of 1,500 derived palettes (or the matches among them).

Library tab buttons

Control	What it does
Reset	Clears both searches and every filter; sets Sort: original .
Export visible	Opens the Export tab.
Back to top	Scrolls to the start of the grid.

Card

Part	Action
Swatch	Select to copy its hex. Enter or Space on a focused swatch opens the palette.
Id and method	Palette id and method label.
Inspect	Opens the palette on Inspect .
Copy	Copies the five hexes, comma-separated.
Save / Saved	Saves or unsaves.
Rest of the card	Opens the palette on Inspect .

Counter under the grid

Text	Meaning
1–48 of 5,000,000 palettes	Unfiltered; the range currently shown.
... · scroll reaches N; search an id for the rest	The scrollbar cannot go beyond palette N.
N matches from M derived	Filtered; M palettes worked out so far, N match.
· all five million looked at	The scan reached the end.
N matches, ordered within the first M derived	Filtered and sorted.
1 palette, by id	An id is in the search box.
No palette with that id	The id is outside the collection.

Inspect tab

Block	Contents
Colour strip	Five columns with a three-word name and hex; select to copy.
Palette summary	Badge (Neutral , Triadic , Analogous , Monochrome); Palette ID , Global index , Method , Colors , Avg L* (OKLCH), Avg chroma , Hue span , DeltaE avg , Entropy , Min pair contrast , Max pair contrast .
Pair-by-pair WCAG contrast	Ten pairs with ratios.
Quick export	Copy HEX , Copy CSS vars , Copy SCSS , Copy Tailwind , Download JSON , Download ASE , Download SVG , Download PNG , Open in Colors , Save to library / Unsave , Copy share link , Design tokens...
Color 1 to Color 5	HEX , RGB , OKLCH , CIE L*a*b* , WCAG vs white , WCAG vs black , copy buttons.

Select a card heading to fold or unfold it.

Analysis tabs

Tab	Cards
Harmony	Generation method , Dominant hue bucket , Harmony classification , Lightness & chroma profile
Accessibility	Palette-level WCAG summary , Pair-level WCAG breakdown , How many of the five can be used together , The most usable in this sample
Stats	Avg lightness (OKLCH L) (0–1, 10 bands), Avg chroma (OKLCH C) (0–0.30, 10 bands), Hue spread (0–360°, 12 bands), Best pair contrast (1–15:1, 14 bands)

Sample: the first 2,000 palettes, or up to 2,000 matches from the first 40,000 when filtered.

Export tab

Card	Group	Buttons
Selection · id	Copy formats	HEX list, CSS variables, SCSS variables, Tailwind config
	Download	JSON, Adobe ASE, SVG strip, PNG strip
	External	Open in Coolors
Visible page	Bulk download	Download JSON (visible page), Download CSV (visible page), Download CSS variables, Download SCSS variables, Download compact JSON
	Sample formats	Download .txt hex list, Download tailwind.config.js fragment

Files

Output	File name	Size or shape
JSON (one palette)	<id>.json	Full record with contrast table.
ASE	<id>.ase	Five RGB swatches <id>_1 to <id>_5.
SVG	<id>.svg	600 × 220.
PNG	<id>.png	800 × 320.
Bulk	palette-page-<count>-<date>.<ext>	json, csv, css, scss, txt, js.
Design tokens	See Copy, export and share	Eight formats; Download all makes palette-<id>.zip.

Design tokens dialog

Control	What it does	Default
Token prefix	The start of every token name.	brand
Format tabs	W3C Design Tokens, CSS Variables, SCSS, Tailwind Config, Style Dictionary, Material UI Theme, iOS (SwiftUI), Android colors.xml	W3C Design Tokens
Copy	Copies the preview.	—
Download	Saves the current format.	—
Download all	Saves every format in one ZIP.	—

Share link dialog

Control	What it does
Link field	The share address, selected and ready to copy.
Copy	Copies the link (Copied!).
Share via...	Opens your device's share sheet, where available.
Open in new tab	Opens the link.
Close / ✕	Closes the dialog.

Messages

Message	When
Loading palette database...	While the page prepares.
Could not load palette database	The collection description failed to load.
Nothing matched yet	No match found so far in a scan.
No palette selected	Inspect or Export before a palette is opened.
No palettes	An analysis tab found no matches in its sample.
No saved palettes yet	The Saved tab is empty.
#HEX copied, Palette hexes copied, HEX list copied, CSS variables copied, SCSS variables copied, Tailwind config copied, Copied	After copying.
Downloaded and a file name	After a download.
Saved, Removed	After saving or unsaving from Inspect .
Nothing to export	Bulk export of an empty sample.
Could not encode PNG	The browser could not make the PNG.
Shared palette not found in current dataset	A share link's palette could not be found.

Keyboard

Key	Action
/	Focus Search by id or hex... (when not typing in a field).
Enter / Space	On a focused swatch: open its palette.
Escape	Close the share or design-tokens dialog.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > PALETTE LIBRARY

Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes for problems in the Palette Library.

"Could not load palette database"

Why: The page could not download the short description of the collection it needs to work out palettes, usually because of a dropped connection or a content blocker.

What to do: Check your connection, allow auricartisan.com in any content blocker, and reload.

A filter shows "Nothing matched yet"

Why: A filter starts a scan from the beginning of the collection. A rare combination, such as **Dark** lightness with **Vivid** chroma and one method, may need to look through many palettes before the first match.

What to do: Scroll down to let the scan continue, or widen the filter. Watch the counter: **N matches from M derived** shows how far it has looked.

Filtering feels slow

Why: Every palette the scan looks at is worked out on the spot. The page does this in small steps so it stays responsive, but a rare filter can mean a lot of work.

What to do: Remove a filter you do not need, or use the search box to jump straight to a known id.

The scrollbar stops before the end of the collection

Why: No browser can make a page tall enough for five million palettes. The counter says **scroll reaches N; search an id for the rest**.

What to do: Type the id or number of the palette you want into **Search by id or hex....** Every palette can be reached this way.

A sort does not seem to cover the whole collection

Why: Sorting needs the whole set in hand, and five million palettes cannot be ordered in a browser. Any sort other than **Sort: original** orders only a first stretch of the collection, and the sorted grid does not grow as you scroll.

What to do: Combine the sort with filters so the stretch it orders is the one you care about. For a full, streaming browse, use **Sort: original**.

Filters seem to be ignored

Why: The search box contains an id or a plain number. An id always wins, and the grid shows only that palette (**1 palette, by id**).

What to do: Remove the id or number from both search boxes.

The palette's method does not match its colours

Why: The **Method** is a label each palette carries in the collection. The badge on **Palette summary** (**Neutral, Triadic, Analogous, Monochrome**) is measured from the actual colours, and the two can disagree.

What to do: When the relationship between hues matters, judge by the badge and the **Hue span**, not the method label. See [Limits and accuracy](#).

"Export visible" exported more palettes than I can see

Why: The **Visible page** export uses the same sample as the analysis tabs: up to 2,000 palettes, not only the cards on screen.

What to do: To export one palette, open it on **Inspect** and use the **Selection** card or **Quick export**.

A share link opens the page but not the palette

Why: The link may have been cut short when it was pasted, or edited.

What to do: Ask for the link again, or ask for the palette id and search for it. If the page says **Shared palette not found in current dataset**, the id in the link is not valid.

The ASE file will not open

Why: ASE files are read by Adobe apps and some other design tools; not every app supports them.

What to do: Import it through your app's swatches or palette panel rather than opening it as a document. If your app does not read ASE, use the JSON, CSS or design-token exports instead.

Saved palettes have gone

Why: Saved palettes live in this browser only; clearing site data, a private window, or another browser or device will not show them. The **Saved** tab also keeps only the latest 500.

What to do: Save them again, or keep their ids — an id always gives the same palette.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > COLOUR LIBRARIES > PALETTE LIBRARY

Palette Library FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Palette Library.

Are there really five million palettes?

Yes. Each of the 5,000,000 palettes is defined by its number and worked out when you view it. The same id always gives the same five colours.

Why not store them?

Written out in full, the collection was 3.9 GB. Working palettes out as you scroll keeps the page fast and the download tiny.

How do I get back to a palette I found?

Note its id (for example `pal_abc`) and type it into the search box, save it, or copy a share link.

Why does a filter say "derived"?

Because the page has to work out palettes to test them. **96 matches from 1,500 derived** means it has looked at 1,500 palettes and 96 passed.

Can every colour in a palette be used as text on every other?

No — not in this library or any other. There is only room for three lightness levels that are all 4.5:1 apart, so at most three colours can all be legible on each other, and in practice palettes here offer two. Use **Pair-by-pair WCAG contrast** on **Inspect** to find the pairs that work. See [Analyse the collection](#).

What do the method names mean?

They are the palette's generation-method labels: **complementary**, **triadic**, **analogous**, **tetradic**, **golden_ratio**, **random** and **monochromatic**. The badge on **Inspect** measures the hue relationship the colours actually have.

Which export should I use?

- Pasting into CSS: **Copy CSS vars**.
 - A Tailwind project: **Copy Tailwind**, or **Design tokens...** › **Tailwind Config**.
 - Adobe apps: **Download ASE**.
 - A design system or native app: **Design tokens....**
 - A presentation or mood board: **Download PNG** or **Download SVG**.
-

Do I need an account?

No. Saving keeps palettes in this browser and in your Library without signing in.

Is there an API?

Yes. The heading links to the Palette Library API guide, and the **Automate this** note names the call (**GET /v1/palette/library**, 3 API credits per call). See **Public API**.

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Palette Library: other material

Supporting material for the Palette Library: glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages, privacy and release notes.

Background material for the Palette Library: its terms, keyboard actions, what its figures mean and do not mean, related pages, what it stores, and its history.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Terms such as seed, derived, dominant hue, hue span and mutually legible.
Shortcuts	Keyboard and pointer actions.
Limits and accuracy	Samples, scans, method labels and contrast.
Related	Related libraries, tools and Learn articles.
Privacy	What stays in your browser and what uses the network.
Release notes	User-facing history.

Back to the [Palette Library overview](#).

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Palette Library shortcuts

Keyboard and pointer actions in the Palette Library.

Keyboard

Keys	Where	Result
/	Anywhere, when not typing in a field	Focuses Search by id or hex...
Tab	Grid	Moves between swatches and buttons.
Enter or Space	A focused swatch	Opens its palette on Inspect .
Escape	Share link or design tokens dialog	Closes the dialog.

Pointer

Action	Result
Select a swatch in the grid	Copies its hex code.
Select a column on Inspect	Copies its hex code.
Select a card outside its buttons	Opens the palette on Inspect .

Action	Result
Select a card heading on Inspect	Folds or unfolds the card.
Select outside a dialog	Closes it.

The site-wide shortcuts also work here. See [Site features](#).

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Palette Library glossary

Definitions of the terms used in the Palette Library.

Term	Meaning
ASE	Adobe Swatch Exchange, a swatch file format read by Adobe apps and other design tools.
Base 36	Writing numbers with the digits 0–9 and the letters a–z. Palette ids use it: <code>pal_a</code> is palette 10.
Chroma	How colourful a colour is compared with a grey of the same lightness. The page uses OKLCH chroma.
Contrast ratio	The WCAG 2 measure of the lightness difference between two colours, from 1:1 to 21:1. 4.5:1 is the AA level for body text; 7:1 is AAA.
Derived	Worked out on the spot from the palette's number rather than read from storage.
Design tokens	Named colour values in a format a design system or platform reads, such as CSS variables, a Tailwind config or an Android <code>colors.xml</code> .
Dominant hue	A palette's overall hue: the average of its five hues, weighted towards the more colourful colours.
Entropy	On Inspect : how many 36° hue bands the five colours fall in, divided by 5. 1.00 means five different hue families.
Hue span	The widest angle between any two of a palette's five hues, from 0° to 180°.
Method	The generation-method label a palette carries, such as <code>triadic</code> .
Mutually legible	A set of colours that all reach a contrast threshold against each other, so any one can be text on any other.
OKLCH	A modern perceptual colour space: lightness (0 to 1), chroma and hue angle.
Palette id	<code>pal_</code> followed by the palette's number in base 36, for example <code>pal_abc</code> .
Sample	The set of palettes the analysis tabs and the bulk export use: up to 2,000 palettes.
Scan	Looking through the collection from the start, in chunks, to find palettes that match a filter.
Seed	The fixed starting number from which every palette is worked out. It is why palettes never change.
WCAG	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines, the international standard for accessible web content.

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Limits and accuracy

What the Palette Library's scans, samples and figures can tell you, and what they cannot.

Scans and samples

- A filtered browse is a scan from the start of the collection. It shows the matches found so far, not all matches in five million. The counter always states how many palettes were looked at.
 - Sorting orders a first stretch of 1,500 palettes (or the matches among them), not the whole collection.
 - The **Harmony**, **Accessibility** and **Stats** tabs, and the **Visible page** export, use a sample of up to 2,000 palettes: the first 2,000, or the first matches found in up to 40,000. Percentages describe that sample. Because the sample always starts at the beginning of the collection, it is consistent from visit to visit but is not a random draw from all five million.
-

Method labels and measured harmony

Each palette carries a method label (such as **triadic**). The colours are worked out from the palette's number, and the label does not guarantee a particular hue relationship. The **Palette summary** badge and **Hue span** on **Inspect** are measured from the actual colours; rely on those when the relationship matters.

Contrast

- Contrast ratios use the WCAG 2 formula. They are exact for the colours as sRGB values.
 - WCAG 2 contrast is one requirement for readable text. Font size, weight, and the surrounding design also matter. Newer measures such as APCA can rate some pairs differently.
 - The ceiling of three mutually legible colours at 4.5:1 is a property of the contrast formula, not of this collection.
-

Colour values

- OKLCH and CIE Lab values are standard conversions from sRGB with a D65 white point, rounded for display.
 - **DeltaE avg** uses CIE76, which over-states differences between very saturated colours compared with newer formulas.
 - The three-word colour names on **Inspect** come from fixed lightness, chroma and hue bands. They are handy descriptions, not standard colour names.
-

Your screen

Swatches look different on different displays. The numbers are the same everywhere.

What it is not

- It is not a palette generator that responds to your input. For that, see the palette tools in [Related](#).
- It is not an accessibility audit of a design.

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Privacy

What the Palette Library keeps in your browser and what it fetches over the network.

What stays in your browser

What	Why	How to remove it
Saved palette ids (up to 500)	To fill the Saved tab.	Unsave each palette, or clear this site's data.
A copy of each saved palette in your Library	So it appears with your other saved items.	Unsave it, or remove it in the Library.
Whether you dismissed the Automate this note	So it stays hidden.	Clear this site's data.

Your searches, filters and sort choices are handled in your browser and are not remembered after you leave.

What uses the network

- When the page opens, it downloads a short description of the collection from auricartisan.com. Palettes themselves are worked out in your browser.
- **Open in Colors** opens colors.co in a new tab and passes it the palette's five hex codes in the address. Colors is a separate service with its own privacy policy.
- **Download all** in the design tokens dialog may download a small helper from auricartisan.com to build the ZIP file.
- Share links contain the palette's id and colours in the link itself; nothing is uploaded when you create one.

Advertising and analytics on the site follow your consent choices. See [Company and legal](#).

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Release notes

User-facing history of the Palette Library.

0.9.9 — 5 June 2026

The Palette Library was added in release 0.9.9 as part of the library expansion, together with the Color, Gradient, Harmony, Shade and Accessibility libraries. See the [Changelog](#).

The current page

The current page streams the whole five-million collection as you scroll, reports how far every filtered scan has looked, measures the analysis tabs on a stated sample, and shows every tab at once (earlier versions hid the analysis tabs behind a Simple/Advanced switch, and paged the grid in fixed page sizes). These changes are not listed as a separate changelog release.

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Related

Libraries, tools and Learn articles that work alongside the Palette Library.

Other colour libraries

- [Harmony Library](#) — palettes built on named colour-theory schemes.
 - [Accessibility Library](#) — text and background pairs scored for contrast.
 - [Color Library](#), [Gradient Library](#) and [Shade Library](#).
-

Tools

- [Basic Tools](#) — generate and remix your own palettes.
 - [Image Picker](#) — extract a palette from a picture.
 - [Contrast Checker](#) — test any two colours.
 - [Design System Generator](#) — build a full design system from colours.
 - [Your Library](#) — where saved palettes also appear.
-

Learn articles

- Color Theory and Harmony — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-04-color-theory-and-harmony>
- Oklab and Oklch: Modern Perceptual Color Spaces — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces>
- Accessible Color Design and WCAG Contrast — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color>

Guides and API

- The Palette Library user guide in the [Documentation library](#).
- [Public API](#) — browse the collection from your own code.

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Shade Library

What the Shade Library is, who it is for, where to find it, and how to find and export a first shade scale.

The Shade Library is a collection of 8,192 shade scales (also called shade systems or colour ramps). A shade scale is one colour taken from very light to very dark in named steps — the familiar **50**, **100**, **200** ... **900**, **950** of design systems such as Tailwind CSS or Material Design. The page puts the difference from a palette clearly: "A shade scale is not a palette. It is one colour taken through lightness so that some steps are surfaces and others are text on them."

The headline, "Eight thousand ramps, *and 8% of them even*", sums up what the page measures. All 8,192 scales run in one direction and all can carry text, but only 8.2% have genuinely even steps. The scales come from ten generation methods — from Material-like and Tailwind-like ramps to accessible-UI, neutral, ink-and-paper, duotone and temperature-shift systems — with 5 to 21 tokens each.

For each scale you can read every token's value in HEX, RGB, OKLCH and CIE Lab, see which tokens can carry body text with black or white text on them, and export the whole scale as CSS custom properties, SCSS, a Tailwind colour group, JSON, SVG, PNG or design tokens for eight platforms.

Who it is for

- Designers and developers building a design system who need a full tint-and-shade scale for a brand colour.
- Front-end developers who want token-named CSS variables or a Tailwind colour group ready to paste.
- Accessibility specialists checking which steps of a scale can carry text.

Where to find it

Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/shades/> in a current browser. It is also listed as **Shade Library** ("OKLCH shade systems") under **Libraries** in the site header's **Learn** menu. No account is needed.

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/shades/>.
2. Set **Base hue** to the hue of your brand colour, for example **Blue**.
3. Set **Method** to **Tailwind Like**.
4. Select **Inspect** on a scale.
5. Read the **Token contrast ladder** to see which steps carry text.
6. Under **Quick export**, select **Copy CSS vars**.
7. Paste the variables into your stylesheet.

What you can do

- Browse, search and filter 8,192 scales by base hue, chroma, lightness and method.
- Sort by lightness, chroma, hue, score or number of tokens.
- Inspect a scale: token names, descriptive colour names, summary metrics, a contrast ladder and every token's values.
- Read distributions of methods, hues, profiles and accessibility across your filtered set.
- Copy a scale as hex, CSS, SCSS or Tailwind; download JSON, SVG or PNG; export design tokens; share a link.
- Save scales in your browser and your Library, and export whole filtered sets.

In this folder

- [docs/](#) — how to use the Shade Library.
 - [Getting started](#), [Browse, search and filter](#), [Inspect a scale](#), [Analyse the collection](#), [Copy, export and share](#), [Save scales](#), [Reference](#), [Troubleshooting](#), [FAQ](#).
- [others/](#) — background material.
 - [Glossary](#), [Shortcuts](#), [Limits and accuracy](#), [Related](#), [Privacy](#), [Release notes](#).

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Shade Library documentation

The task guides, reference, troubleshooting and FAQ for the Shade Library.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	Opening the page, a tour of the screen, and a first scale from filter to CSS.
browse-search-and-filter.md	Search, filters, sorting and cards.
inspect-a-scale.md	The Inspect tab: tokens, summary, contrast ladder and per-token values.
analyse-the-collection.md	The Harmony , Accessibility and Stats tabs.
copy-export-and-share.md	Copy formats, downloads, design tokens, share links and bulk export.
save-scales.md	Saving, the Saved tab and your Library.
reference.md	Every control, output and message.
troubleshooting.md	Symptoms, causes and fixes.
faq.md	Short answers.

[Back to the Shade Library overview.](#)

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Getting started

Open the Shade Library, learn the screen, and find, check and export a first shade scale.

Open the page

1. Go to <https://auricartisan.com/library/shades/>, or open the **Learn** menu in the site header and select **Shade Library** under **Libraries**.
2. While the collection loads, the grid shows **Loading shade library...**
3. The grid fills and the counter reads, for example, **1–24 of 8,192 scales**.

If loading fails you see **Could not load shade library**. See [Troubleshooting](#).

A tour of the screen

The heading

Kicker **Auric Artisan · Shades**; headline **Eight thousand ramps, and 8% of them even.**; facts **Collection 8,192, 10 methods** and **Measured in OKLab**; and **Read the API guide** → to the Shade Library's API guide.

A note starting **Automate this** may appear: browsing is also available through the site's REST API — **3 API credits per call to GET /v1/shade/library** — with **API docs**. Select × to dismiss it.

Browse the collection

A search box (**Search by id, hex, token or method...**), **Shuffle**, **Open a random scale**, and **Filter inside results** with its own box and **Clear**.

The tabs

Tab	What it shows
Library	Filters, sort and the grid. The badge shows how many scales match.
Inspect	The scale you last opened.
Harmony	Distributions of methods, hues, profiles and token counts.
Accessibility	Which scales' tokens can carry text.
Stats	Five histograms.
Export	Exports for the open scale and for every matching scale.
Saved	Scales you have saved.

A card

Each card shows the scale as a strip of swatches, each labelled with its token and hex (for example **500 #FF724C**), then the scale's id (such as **shade_000000**), its method (such as **Material Like**) and **Inspect**, **Copy** and **Save**.

Your first task: a blue scale for a design system

1. Set **Base hue** to **Blue**.
2. Set **Method** to **Tailwind Like** to get the familiar 50–950 token names.
3. Select **Inspect** on a scale you like.
4. Read the **Shade summary: Tokens, Auto AA tokens** and **Min adjacent contrast**.
5. Read the **Token contrast ladder**: each step's contrast with the better of black or white text.
6. Under **Quick export**, select **Copy CSS vars**. The page confirms **CSS variables copied**.
7. Paste the block into your stylesheet and use the variables for surfaces, borders and text.

Result: a full blue scale as CSS custom properties, with the steps that can carry text identified.

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Analyse the collection

Use the Harmony, Accessibility and Stats tabs to see how methods, profiles, text safety and token counts are distributed across your filtered scales.

These tabs describe every scale that matches your current search and filters — all 8,192 when nothing is set. Each is drawn when opened and redrawn after a filter change; select the tab again if it looks out of date. With nothing matching, each shows **No shade systems**.

Harmony tab

Card	What it counts
Generation method	Scales per method.
Dominant hue bucket	Scales per base hue.
Shade profile	Neutral, Hue Shift, Light, Deep and Balanced (see Inspect a scale).
Token count	Scales with 5, 7, 9, 10, 11, 13, 16 or 21 tokens.
Lightness & chroma profile	Dark, Mid and Light; Muted, Balanced and Vivid.

Accessibility tab

Shade-level WCAG summary

Row	Meaning
All tokens auto-AA	Scales in which every token reaches 4.5:1 with automatic text.
75%+ tokens auto-AA	Scales in which at least three quarters of tokens do.
White text coverage	Scales in which at least 35% of tokens reach 4.5:1 with white text.
Black text coverage	The same with black text.

In the full collection, 403 scales have every token at AA with automatic text.

Active shade checks

The token contrast ladder for the open scale, or **Select a shade system to see per-token contrast**.

Visible shade systems where every token gets AA auto text

Up to 24 matching scales where every token passes. Cards work as in the grid. If there are none: **No full auto-AA shade systems here**.

Stats tab

Card	Range	Bands
Avg lightness (OKLCH L)	0 to 1	10
Avg chroma (OKLCH C)	0 to 0.30	10
Hue spread	0° to 120°	12
Token count	2 to 66	8
Score	0 to 1	10

Values beyond a range are counted in the last band.

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Browse, search and filter

Search and filter 8,192 shade scales by base hue, chroma, lightness and method, and sort the results.

Search

Search by id, hex, token or method... filters as you type. Every word must appear in the scale's id, its name, its base colour, its method, its base hue name (red, orange, yellow, green, cyan, blue, purple, pink), its token names, or any of its hex codes. The **Filter inside results** box adds more words; **Clear** empties it. Press **/** outside a text field to jump to the search box.

Examples:

- ff724c** — scales based on, or containing, that colour.
- tailwind blue** — Tailwind-like scales with a blue base.
- 950** — scales that have a **950** token.

Filters

Filter	Options	Meaning
Base hue	All hues, Red, Orange, Yellow, Green, Cyan, Blue, Purple, Pink	The OKLCH hue of the scale's base colour.
Chroma	Any chroma, Muted (< 0.07)**, **Balanced** (0.07 to 0.15), **Vivid (> 0.15)	Average OKLCH chroma of the tokens.
Lightness	Any lightness, Dark (below 0.40), Mid (0.40 to 0.70), Light (above 0.70)	Average OKLCH lightness of the tokens.

Filter	Options	Meaning
Method	All methods, Accessible Ui, Brand System, Duotone Shift, Ink Paper, Material Like, Neutral System, Oklch Ramp, Tailwind Like, Temperature Shift, Vivid Product	How the scale was generated.

All filters and searches combine.

Method	Scales
Brand System	1,418
Accessible Ui	1,287
Tailwind Like	1,148
Oklch Ramp	1,020
Material Like	847
Vivid Product	700
Neutral System	571
Temperature Shift	515
Duotone Shift	414
Ink Paper	272

Sort by

Option	Order
Sort: original	Collection order (default).
Lightness up / Lightness down	Average OKLCH lightness.
Chroma up / Chroma down	Average OKLCH chroma.
Hue (rainbow)	Base colour's hue from 0°.
Score high to low	Highest recorded quality score first.
Tokens high to low	Most tokens first.
Random	Shuffled.

Buttons

- **Shuffle** — sort **Random**.
- **Open a random scale** — opens any scale on **Inspect**.
- **Reset** — clears searches, filters and sort.

- **Export visible** — opens **Export**.
- **Back to top** — scrolls to the first card.

The grid

The counter reads, for example, **1–24 of 1,148 scales**, or **Nothing to show**; the grid then says **No shade systems match** — **Try clearing a filter, or searching a broader method, hex or token**.

Cards: select a swatch to copy its hex; **Copy** copies all hex codes, comma-separated (**Shade hexes copied**); **Save** saves or unsaves (**Shade saved** / **Shade removed**); **Inspect**, or anywhere else on the card, opens it. With the keyboard, **Enter** or **Space** on a focused swatch opens the scale.

A note on evenness

The page's introduction points to evenness — whether a scale's steps are equally spaced — as the property that matters most, and reports that 8.2% of scales are genuinely even. The current filter row does not include an evenness filter. To judge evenness for one scale, open it on **Inspect** and read **Min adjacent contrast** and the **Token contrast ladder**: large jumps between neighbouring steps show up there.

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Copy, export and share

Copy a shade scale as hex, token-named CSS, SCSS or Tailwind, download JSON, SVG or PNG, export design tokens, share a link, and export many scales.

One scale

Open the scale on **Inspect**. Use **Quick export**, or the **Selection** card on the **Export** tab (headed **Selection** - and the id). With nothing open, the **Export** tab says **No shade system selected. Click Inspect on any card in the Library tab to enable selection exports**.

Names in the output come from the scale's name with the hex codes removed, in lower case with dashes: **Material Like #FF724C #00001** becomes **material-like-00001**. Each variable ends in the token name.

Copy formats

Quick export	Export tab	What is copied	Message
Copy HEX	HEX list	All hex codes, comma-separated.	HEX list copied
Copy CSS vars	CSS variables	A CSS class holding one custom property per token.	CSS variables copied
Copy SCSS	SCSS variables	One Sass variable per token.	SCSS copied
Copy Tailwind	Tailwind config	A colour group keyed by token.	Tailwind copied

For the first scale in the collection:

```
.aa-shade-material-like-00001 {  
  --material-like-00001-50: #fff0ec;  
  --material-like-00001-100: #ffdfd7;  
  --material-like-00001-300: #ff886b;  
  --material-like-00001-500: #ff724c;  
  --material-like-00001-700: #cd5531;  
  --material-like-00001-900: #4b1200;  
  --material-like-00001-950: #1e0400;  
}
```

```
$material-like-00001-50: #fff0ec;  
$material-like-00001-100: #ffdfd7;  
...  
$material-like-00001-950: #1e0400;
```

```
"material-like-00001": {  
  "50": "#fff0ec",  
  "100": "#ffdfd7",  
  ...  
  "950": "#1e0400"  
}
```

Tip: The CSS variables are declared on a class, not on `:root`. Either add that class to an element, or change the selector to `:root` after pasting. Rename the prefix to something meaningful in your project, such as `--brand-500`.

Downloads

Quick export	Export tab	File	Contents
Download JSON	JSON	shade-000000.json	Id, name, base, method, token names, each token's hex and contrast on white and black, and score, average lightness, average chroma and auto-AA count.
Download SVG	SVG strip	shade-000000.svg	A 1200 × 260 strip of the tokens; hovering a band shows its token and hex.
Download PNG	PNG strip	shade-000000.png	A 1600 × 420 strip.

Design tokens

Select **Design tokens....** The dialog is titled with the scale's name. **Token prefix** starts as `color`, and every token keeps its step name: `color-50`, `color-100` ... `color-950`. Choose **W3C Design Tokens, CSS**

Variables, SCSS, Tailwind Config, Style Dictionary, Material UI Theme, iOS (SwiftUI) or Android colors.xml, then **Copy**, **Download**, or **Download all** for a ZIP such as `shade-shade-000000.zip`.

Share a link

Select **Copy share link**. The **Share link** dialog offers **Copy**, **Share via...** where available, **Open in new tab** and **Close**. The link opens the scale on **Inspect**; if it cannot be found, the page says **Shared shade not in current library**.

Many scales

The **Visible page** card on the **Export** tab exports every scale matching your search and filters (all 8,192 with none set). Its badge shows the number.

Button	File	Contents
Download JSON (visible page)	<code>shade-library-<count>-<date>.json</code>	Every scale in full.
Download CSV (visible page)	<code>...csv</code>	<code>id,name,base,method,tokens,score,avg_lightness,avg_chroma,auto_aa,colors</code> , with colours separated by vertical bars.
Download CSS variables	<code>...css</code>	One class per scale.
Download SCSS variables	<code>...scss</code>	Sass variables per scale.
Download compact JSON	<code>...json</code>	Id and hex codes per scale.
Download .txt hex list	<code>...txt</code>	One line per scale: its id, a colon and its hex codes.
Download tailwind.config.js fragment	<code>...txt</code>	One Tailwind colour group per scale, inside braces.

If nothing matches, the bulk buttons do nothing.

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Inspect a scale

Read the Inspect tab: token strip, shade summary, token contrast ladder and each token's values.

Open a scale with **Inspect**, by selecting the card, with **Enter** or **Space** on a focused swatch, with **Open a random scale**, or from a share link. Until then the tab shows **No shade system selected**.

The token strip

One column per token, labelled with the token name and a descriptive colour name — for example **500 - soft vivid orange** — and the hex code. Select a column to copy its hex.

Shade summary

The badge gives the scale's profile:

Badge	When
Neutral	Average chroma below 0.035.
Hue Shift	Its hues span more than 35°.
Light	Average lightness above 0.72.
Deep	Average lightness below 0.38.
Balanced	Anything else.

The badges are checked in that order, so a scale is **Neutral** before it can be **Hue Shift**, and so on.

Row	Meaning
Shade ID	For example <code>shade_000000</code> .
Global index	The scale's number.
Method	For example Material Like .
Base	The base colour the scale is built around.
Tokens	Number of steps.
Avg L (OKLCH)	Average lightness, 0 to 1.
Avg chroma	Average OKLCH chroma.
Hue span	Widest hue difference between two tokens.
Score	The quality score recorded for the scale.
Auto AA tokens	How many tokens reach 4.5:1 with automatic text (near-black on light tokens, white on dark ones), for example 4 / 7 . All tokens is good; 70% or more is a warning; less is poor.
Min adjacent contrast	The lowest contrast between two neighbouring tokens — how close the two most similar steps are.

Token contrast ladder

Each token with its hex and its contrast with automatic text, for example **500 #FF724C 2.71 : 1 auto text**. Automatic text is near-black (**#111111**) on tokens whose luminance is above 0.5, and white otherwise. Use the ladder to decide which steps can hold body text (4.5:1 or more), large text (3:1 or more), or should be used only as fills.

Quick export

Copy HEX, Copy CSS vars, Copy SCSS, Copy Tailwind, Download JSON, Download SVG, Download PNG, Save to library / Unsave, Copy share link and Design tokens.... See [Copy, export and share](#).

One card per token

Headed **Token** and the name and hex, for example **Token 500 - #FF724C**, with a badge of its contrast on white and on black. Rows: **HEX, RGB, OKLCH, CIE L*a*b*, WCAG vs white, WCAG vs black**, and buttons to copy the hex and **rgb()** value.

Example

The first scale, **Material Like #FF724C #00001**, has seven tokens: **50, 100, 300, 500, 700, 900** and **950**. Its ladder shows **50, 100, 900** and **950** well above 4.5:1 with automatic text, while **300, 500** and **700** fall below it — those middle steps are for fills, borders and large accents, not body text.

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Save scales

Save shade scales, find them on the Saved tab, and reach them from your Library.

Save

Select **Save** on a card, or **Save to library** under **Quick export** on **Inspect**. The page confirms **Shade saved**, and the **Saved** tab's badge goes up.

Find saved scales

Open the **Saved** tab. Scales appear as cards, most recently saved first, with a note that they are **Also saved to your Library workspace with image previews**. With nothing saved: **No saved shade systems yet**.

Unsave

Select **Saved** on the card, or **Unsave** on **Inspect**. The page confirms **Shade removed**, and the scale leaves your Library too.

In your Library

Each saved scale is added to your Library under its name (for example **Material Like #FF724C #00001**), described by method, base colour and token count. Open your Library with **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **L**. See the [Library Kit docs](#).

Limits

Up to 500 scales are kept; saving more drops the oldest. Saves are kept in this browser only.

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Shade Library reference

Every control, filter, sort order, tab, output and message in the Shade Library.

Everything on <https://auricartisan.com/library/shades/>.

Heading

Item	Content
Kicker	Auric Artisan · Shades
Headline	Eight thousand ramps, and 8% of them even.
Facts	Collection 8,192, 10 methods, Measured in OKLab
Read the API guide →	The Shade Library API guide.
Automate this note	3 API credits per call to GET /v1/shade/library; API docs; × dismisses.

Browse controls

Control	What it does
Search by id, hex, token or method...	Every word must match id, name, base, method, base hue name, a token name or a hex.
Shuffle	Sort Random .
Open a random scale	Opens any scale on Inspect .

Control	What it does
Filter inside results (id, hex, method...)	Second search, combined.
Clear	Empties the second search.

Tabs

Library (badge: matches), **Inspect**, **Harmony**, **Accessibility**, **Stats**, **Export**, **Saved** (badge: saved).

Filters

Filter	Options
Base hue	All hues, Red (340° to under 20°), Orange (20–50°), Yellow (50–80°), Green (80–160°), Cyan (160–200°), Blue (200–260°), Purple (260–300°), Pink (300–340°)
Chroma	Any chroma, Muted (< 0.07)**, **Balanced** (0.07–0.15), **Vivid (> 0.15)
Lightness	Any lightness, Dark (< 0.40), **Mid** (0.40–0.70), **Light** (> 0.70)
Method	All methods, Accessible Ui, Brand System, Duotone Shift, Ink Paper, Material Like, Neutral System, Oklch Ramp, Tailwind Like, Temperature Shift, Vivid Product

Sort by

Sort: original (default), **Lightness up**, **Lightness down**, **Chroma up**, **Chroma down**, **Hue (rainbow)**, **Score high to low**, **Tokens high to low**, **Random**.

Library tab buttons

Reset, **Export visible**, **Back to top**. Counter: first-last of total scales, or **Nothing to show**.

Card

Part	Action
Swatch (token and hex)	Copies the hex. Enter / Space when focused opens the scale.
Id and method	For example shade_000000, Material Like.
Inspect	Opens the scale.
Copy	Copies all hexes (Shade hexes copied).
Save / Saved	Saves or unsaves (Shade saved / Shade removed).

Inspect tab

Block	Contents
Token strip	Token, descriptive name, hex; select to copy.
Shade summary	Badge (Neutral , Hue Shift , Light , Deep , Balanced); Shade ID , Global index , Method , Base , Tokens , Avg L (OKLCH) , Avg chroma , Hue span , Score , Auto AA tokens , Min adjacent contrast
Token contrast ladder	Each token's contrast with automatic text.
Quick export	Copy HEX , Copy CSS vars , Copy SCSS , Copy Tailwind , Download JSON , Download SVG , Download PNG , Save to library / Unsave , Copy share link , Design tokens...
Token cards	HEX , RGB , OKLCH , CIE L*a*b* , WCAG vs white , WCAG vs black

Analysis tabs

Tab	Cards
Harmony	Generation method , Dominant hue bucket , Shade profile , Token count , Lightness & chroma profile
Accessibility	Shade-level WCAG summary (All tokens auto-AA , 75%+ tokens auto-AA , White text coverage , Black text coverage), Active shade checks , Visible shade systems where every token gets AA auto text
Stats	Avg lightness (OKLCH L) , Avg chroma (OKLCH C) , Hue spread , Token count , Score

Export tab

Card	Buttons
Selection - id	HEX list , CSS variables , SCSS variables , Tailwind config ; JSON , SVG strip , PNG strip
Visible page	Download JSON (visible page) , Download CSV (visible page) , Download CSS variables , Download SCSS variables , Download compact JSON ; Download .txt hex list , Download tailwind.config.js fragment

Files

Output	Name	Detail
JSON	<code><id>.json</code> (for example <code>shade-000000.json</code>)	Scale with token contrast and metrics.
SVG	<code><id>.svg</code>	1200 × 260.
PNG	<code><id>.png</code>	1600 × 420.
Bulk	<code>shade-library-<count>-<date>.<ext></code>	<code>json</code> , <code>csv</code> , <code>css</code> , <code>scss</code> , <code>txt</code> .

Output	Name	Detail
Design tokens ZIP	shade-<id>.zip	Eight formats.

Messages

Message	When
Loading shade library...	While loading.
Could not load shade library	Loading failed.
No shade systems match	Nothing matches.
No shade system selected	Inspect or Export before opening a scale.
No shade systems	An analysis tab with nothing matching.
No saved shade systems yet	Nothing saved.
#HEX copied, Shade hexes copied, HEX list copied, CSS variables copied, SCSS copied, Tailwind copied, Copied	After copying.
Shade saved, Shade removed	After saving or unsaving.
PNG export failed	The browser could not make the PNG.
Shared shade not in current library	A share link could not be matched.

Keyboard

/ focuses search; **Enter** or **Space** on a focused swatch opens its scale; **Escape** closes the share and design tokens dialogs.

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Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes for problems in the Shade Library.

"Could not load shade library"

Why: The collection (about 2 MB) could not be downloaded.

What to do: Check your connection and any content blocker, and reload.

I cannot find an evenness filter

Why: The page's introduction recommends filtering by evenness, but the current filter row has only **Base hue**, **Chroma**, **Lightness** and **Method**.

What to do: Narrow the list with the other filters, then compare **Min adjacent contrast** and the **Token contrast ladder** on **Inspect**: uneven scales show one or two big jumps between neighbouring steps.

"No shade systems match"

Why: The filters together exclude everything, for example **Light** lightness with **Ink Paper**.

What to do: Select **Reset** and add filters back one at a time.

Pasted CSS variables do nothing

Why: **Copy CSS vars** declares the variables on a class such as `.aa-shade-material-like-00001`, not on `:root`.

What to do: Change the selector to `:root`, or add the class to the element where you use the variables.

The middle steps fail contrast

Why: In almost every scale, the middle steps (around `300–700`) are too close in lightness to both black and white to carry body text. That is expected: they are fills, borders and accents.

What to do: Use light steps for surfaces with dark text, dark steps for text or dark surfaces with light text, and check the **Token contrast ladder**.

Bulk export buttons do nothing

Why: No scales match the current filters.

What to do: Widen the filters, then export again.

A share link does not open the scale

Why: The link was cut short or edited; the page may say **Shared shade not in current library**.

What to do: Ask for the scale's id (for example `shade_000000`) and search for it.

Saved scales have gone

Why: Saves live in this browser only (up to 500).

What to do: Save them again, or export them.

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Shade Library FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Shade Library.

What is a shade scale?

One colour taken through lightness in named steps, from a near-white tint to a near-black shade. Light steps become surfaces, dark steps become text, and middle steps become fills and accents.

What are tokens?

The named steps of a scale, such as **50**, **100** ... **900**, **950**. The collection uses several naming patterns and has between 5 and 21 tokens per scale.

What do the methods mean?

They are the ten generation styles: **Material Like**, **Tailwind Like**, **Brand System**, **Accessible Ui**, **Oklch Ramp**, **Neutral System**, **Ink Paper**, **Vivid Product**, **Duotone Shift** and **Temperature Shift**. **Tailwind Like** and **Material Like** follow the step naming of those design systems.

What does "8% even" mean?

The page reports that only 8.2% of the scales have genuinely even steps — no step much larger than the average. Even steps make a scale predictable to use.

Can every step carry text?

In 403 of the 8,192 scales, every token reaches 4.5:1 with automatic black or white text. In most scales the middle steps do not. See [Analyse the collection](#).

Can I use a scale in Tailwind?

Yes: **Copy Tailwind** gives a colour group keyed by token, and **Design tokens...** > **Tailwind Config** gives a full configuration file.

Do I need an account?

No.

Is there an API?

Yes. The heading links to the Shade Library API guide, and the **Automate this** note names **GET /v1/shade/library**. See [Public API](#).

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Shade Library: other material

Supporting material for the Shade Library: glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages, privacy and release notes.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Scale, token, tint, shade, auto text and other terms.
Shortcuts	Keyboard and pointer actions.
Limits and accuracy	What the figures measure, and what they do not.
Related	Related libraries, tools and Learn articles.
Privacy	What stays in your browser.
Release notes	User-facing history.

Back to the [Shade Library overview](#).

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Shade Library shortcuts

Keyboard and pointer actions in the Shade Library.

Keys or action	Where	Result
/	Anywhere, when not typing	Focuses the search box.
Enter or Space	A focused swatch	Opens its scale on Inspect .
Escape	Share link or design tokens dialog	Closes it.
Select a swatch	Grid	Copies its hex.
Select a column	Inspect strip	Copies its hex.

The site-wide shortcuts also work here. See [Site features](#).

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Shade Library glossary

Definitions of the terms used in the Shade Library.

Term	Meaning
Auto text	The better of near-black (#111111) or white text for a token: near-black on tokens with luminance above 0.5, white otherwise.
Base	The colour a scale is built around, usually near its middle.

Term	Meaning
Contrast ratio	The WCAG 2 lightness-difference measure, 1:1 to 21:1. 4.5:1 is AA for body text; 3:1 for large text.
Even steps	A scale in which no step between neighbouring tokens is much larger than the average step.
Min adjacent contrast	The contrast between the two most similar neighbouring tokens.
OKLCH	A perceptual colour space: lightness (0 to 1), chroma (colourfulness) and hue angle.
Profile	The Shade summary badge: Neutral, Hue Shift, Light, Deep or Balanced.
Scale (shade system, ramp)	One colour taken through lightness in named steps.
Shade	A darker version of a colour, towards black.
Tint	A lighter version of a colour, towards white.
Token	A named step in a scale, such as 500 .

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Limits and accuracy

What the Shade Library's figures measure, and what they do not.

- **Contrast** uses the WCAG 2 formula. "Auto AA" tests each token against near-black or white, whichever the page picks from the token's luminance (the split is at 0.5). The other text colour can sometimes do slightly better; check **WCAG vs white** and **WCAG vs black** on the token cards.
- **Averages** (lightness and chroma) are across all tokens, so a scale with a very light start and a very dark end can average **Mid**.
- **Base hue** is the hue of the base colour only. Scales from the **Temperature Shift** and **Duotone Shift** methods deliberately change hue along the ramp; their **Hue span** shows how much.
- **Score** is recorded with each scale when it was generated. It is a ranking aid, not a judgement of fitness for your project.
- **Evenness**: the 8.2% figure is reported by the page; there is no per-scale evenness figure or filter in the current page.
- The three-word colour names on **Inspect** come from fixed OKLCH bands and are descriptions, not standard names.
- Swatches look different on different screens; the values do not.
- The library is not an accessibility audit of your design. Where a token sits (text, border, background) and at what size still decides whether it passes.

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Privacy

What the Shade Library keeps in your browser and what it fetches over the network.

What stays in your browser

What	How to remove it
Saved scale ids (up to 500)	Unsave each one, or clear this site's data.
A copy of each saved scale in your Library	Unsave it, or remove it in the Library.
Whether you dismissed the Automate this note	Clear this site's data.

Searches and filters are handled in your browser and are not remembered after you leave.

What uses the network

- On opening, the page downloads the collection from auricartisan.com.
- Downloads are created in your browser. **Download all** in the design tokens dialog may fetch a small helper from auricartisan.com.
- Share links carry the scale in the link; nothing is uploaded.

Advertising and analytics follow your consent choices. See [Company and legal](#).

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Release notes

User-facing history of the Shade Library.

0.9.9 — 5 June 2026

The Shade Library was added in release 0.9.9 as part of the library expansion. See the [Changelog](#).

The current page

The page now filters and scrolls all 8,192 scales at once and shows every tab (an earlier Simple/Advanced switch has gone). These changes are not listed as a separate changelog release.

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Related

Libraries, tools and Learn articles that work alongside the Shade Library.

Other colour libraries

- [Accessibility Library](#) — see what text colours a background allows.

- [Gradient Library](#) — measured ramps for smooth blends.
 - [Color Library](#), [Palette Library](#) and [Harmony Library](#).
-

Tools

- [Design System Generator](#) — builds accessible OKLCH ramps and a whole design system.
 - [Tonal Steps, Tints & Shades](#) — tonal step charts.
 - [Contrast Checker](#).
 - [Your Library](#).
-

Learn articles

- [Oklab and Oklch: Modern Perceptual Color Spaces](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-06-02-oklab-oklch-perceptual-color-spaces>
 - [Accessible Color Design and WCAG Contrast](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-05-25-wcag-contrast-accessible-color>
 - [Color in CSS: Modern Color in the Browser](https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-07-16-color-in-css-modern-color-in-the-browser) — <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/2026-07-16-color-in-css-modern-color-in-the-browser>
-

Guides and API

- The Shade Library user guide in the [Documentation library](#).
- [Public API](#).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > DOCUMENTATION

Documentation

What the documentation library contains, who it is for, and how to find a tool's guide.

The documentation library is where Auric Artisan publishes the written guide for each tool. Its heading, "Every tool, twice", describes the idea: most subjects have two documents — a **user guide**, which explains how to use the tool, and a **developer reference**, which explains how it works and what it computes. You pick the subject, then pick which of the two you want.

The index lists 54 subjects and 89 documents. 35 subjects have both a guide and a reference; the others have one. Subjects cover the site's tools (such as the URL Analyzer, Vision Simulation and the Font Library), the colour libraries, the browser extension and design-tool plugins, the generators behind the libraries, and the public REST API, including guides to using the Palette, Gradient, Harmony, Shade and accessibility collections from your own code.

Who it is for

- Anyone who wants step-by-step help with a tool: read its user guide.
- Developers and technical users who want to know exactly what a tool measures and how: read its developer reference.
- Developers automating the site's tools: read the API guides and the endpoint reference.

Where to find it

- The index: <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/>
- From the site header: **Learn** menu > **Documentation** ("Technical guides & references").
- The API endpoint reference: <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/api/>
- An RSS feed: <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/rss.xml>

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/>.
2. Type a tool's name into **Search 54 subjects...**, for example **contrast**.
3. Choose **Guides** if you only want user guides, or **References** for developer references; **Both** shows everything.
4. Select **Guide** or **Reference** on the subject's row.
5. On the article, use **On this page** to jump to a section, and the **User guide / Developer reference** switch to move to the other half of the pair.
6. Use **Next subject** at the end, or the list of all subjects at the side, to move on.

What you can do

- Search 54 subjects by name and description.
 - Show only user guides or only developer references, with a shareable address for each.
 - Move between a subject's guide and reference with one click.
 - Browse every subject from a side list on each article, with a breadcrumb back to the index.
 - Copy code examples with one click.
-

In this folder

- [docs/](#) — how to use the documentation library.
 - [Getting started](#) — the index, search and the audience filter.
 - [Read a guide](#) — the layout of a documentation article.
 - [All subjects](#) — every subject with links to its documents.
 - [Reference, Troubleshooting, FAQ](#).
- [others/](#) — [Glossary](#), [Related](#), [Privacy](#).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > DOCUMENTATION

Documentation: docs

Guides for using the documentation library, the list of all subjects, and the reference.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	The index page: search, the Both / Guides / References filter and the subject rows.
read-a-guide.md	A documentation article: the side list, breadcrumb, pair switch, contents, code blocks and pager.
all-subjects.md	All 54 subjects with links to their user guides and developer references.
reference.md	Every control and label on the index and article pages.
troubleshooting.md	Symptoms, causes and fixes.
faq.md	Short answers.

Back to the [Documentation overview](#).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > DOCUMENTATION

Getting started

Use the documentation index to find a tool's user guide or developer reference.

Open the index

Go to <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/>, or open the site header's **Learn** menu and choose **Documentation**.

The page

- The kicker **Documentation** and the heading **Every tool, twice**, with the line "35 of 54 subjects carry both a user guide and a developer reference. Pick the subject, then pick which of the two you are."
- A search box, **Search 54 subjects....**
- An audience switch: **Both, Guides, References**.
- A count, for example **54 subjects · 89 documents**.
- The list of subjects, alphabetical. Each row has the subject's name (a link to its first document), a one-line description, and one or two buttons: **Guide** and **Reference**.

Find a guide

1. Type part of the tool's name or a word from its description into the search box, for example **gamut**.
2. The list narrows as you type, and the count updates, for example **3 subjects · 6 documents**.
3. Select **Guide** for the user guide, or **Reference** for the developer reference.

If nothing matches, the page says **No subject matches that. Try a tool name.**

Show only guides or only references

Select **Guides** to hide every **Reference** button, or **References** to hide every **Guide** button. Subjects that have only the other kind disappear, and the count changes to match. Select **Both** to show everything again.

You can link straight to a filtered view: add `?audience=guide` or `?audience=reference` to the address, for example <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/?audience=reference>.

Which should I read?

- **User guide** — how to use a tool: what each control does, workflows, exports and good practice.
- **Developer reference** — how the tool works: the formulas, data and methods behind it. Useful when you need to know exactly what a number means.
- **API guides** (the subjects whose names end in "API") — how to get the same results from your own code.

Result

You are on the right document for the tool and for the kind of help you need. See [Read a guide](#) for finding your way around it.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > DOCUMENTATION

All documentation subjects

Every subject in the documentation library, with links to its user guide and developer reference.

The documentation library at <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/> lists 54 subjects and 89 documents. 35 subjects have both a user guide and a developer reference; the rest have one of the two. This page lists them all, in the order the index shows them, with the index's own one-line description.

Note: Some guides describe an earlier version of their tool. Where a guide and the tool disagree, the tool is right. The guides for the Accessibility Library and the Palette Library, for example, describe earlier layouts.

- **Accessibility Gen** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Check foreground and background color pairs against WCAG 2.1, WCAG 2.2, WCAG 3.0 APCA, Auric SD Flexible and Strict.
- **Accessibility Library** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Browse 5,000,000 deterministic foreground/background color pairs, search by id and HEX, filter by WCAG 2.1, WCAG 2.2.
- **Analyzer API** — [Guide](#). The URL Analyzer as three REST endpoints: ask what it can check, audit one page from its source with the scope you want.

- **ASCII Art Generator** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Image, text, webcam input, character sets, dithering, Sobel edge detection, render modes, charts, and exports.
- **Auric Artisan Browser Extension** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Install in Chrome, Edge, Brave, Firefox and Safari conversion workflows, use the command palette, pick colors, read HEX, RGB.
- **Auric Artisan Plugins** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Plugins suite across Figma, Penpot, Sketch, VS Code, Alfred, Raycast, Slack.
- **Basic Color Tools** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Floating panels, Palette Studio, Palette Remix, Gradient Maker, Color Picker, Color Battle, Collage Maker.
- **Chromatic Adaptation Dynamic** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Eight CAT methods, 12 illuminants, exponential adaptation timeline, image previews, state maps, LMS and SPD charts.
- **Collage Maker** — [User guide](#). Multi-image upload, drag, resize, rotate, layer ordering, lock and visibility controls, smart grid auto-layout.
- **Collage Measurement** — [Developer reference](#). A developer reference for how the Collage Maker measures coverage and overlap.
- **Color Atlas Gen** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Generate colour atlas datasets from a command line or a configuration file, and choose colour spaces and metadata.
- **Color Contrast Checker** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Enter a text and background colour as hex or with the native swatch, read the exact WCAG 2.1 ratio to two decimals.
- **Color Science Lab** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). 45 floating-panel tools, eight color science domains, linked controls, Compare, Analytics, exports, and library saves.
- **Design System Generator** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). How to use the Auric Artisan Design System Generator at /tool/design-engine/: pick an industry.
- **Dye in Solution** — [Developer reference](#). A developer reference for the dye-in-solution simulation and the colour science behind it.
- **Font Library** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). How to use the Auric Artisan Font Library at /tool/font/: preview 2,213 families with your own text, filter by weight.
- **Gamut Lab** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Standard and custom RGB color spaces, CIE xy and u-prime v-prime diagrams, RGB to XYZ matrices, transfer curves.
- **Gamut Map** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Five RGB color spaces, CIELAB L* slices, ICC rendering intents, sampling, overlays, probe analysis, Delta E playground.
- **Gradient Gen** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Create handmade multi-stop gradients, procedural aurora, nebula, spectral, terrain, thermal, golden, analogous.
- **Gradient Library** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Browse 8,192 generated gradients across 12 methods, 2 to 46 stops, OKLCH metadata, interpolation spaces, easing curves.
- **Gradient Ramp** — [Developer reference](#). A developer reference for the gradient ramp tool and its interpolation methods.
- **Harmony Gen** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Generate complementary, split complementary, triadic, tetradic, square, analogous, monochromatic, hexadic, neutral.
- **Harmony Library** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Browse 8,192 deterministic color harmonies across 23 canonical color-theory schemes, search by harmony id, HEX and scheme.
- **HDR Gamut Plot** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Rec.709, Display-P3, and Rec.2020 overlays, CIE xy and u-prime v-prime axes, PQ and HLG tone curves, peak-nit controls.

- **ICC Profile Parser** — [User guide](#). Load ICC and ICM files, inspect ICC v2/v4 headers, tag tables, profile IDs, TRC curves, RGB primaries, white points.
- **ICC Profile Reading** — [Developer reference](#). A developer reference for how ICC profiles are read, following ISO 15076-1:2010.
- **Illuminants** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). CIE standard illuminants, blackbody CCT, SPD charts, CRI Ra and R1-R14, TM-30 interpretation, metamerism index.
- **Image Picker** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Upload images, load image URLs, extract palettes with K-means++, use the canvas eyedropper, pin colors.
- **Industrial Dye Chemistry** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Spectral dye recipes, Beer-Lambert absorbance, Kubelka-Munk K/S mode, pH titration, temperature broadening, turbidity.
- **Ishihara Plate Generation** — [User guide](#). Comprehensive guide to generating Ishihara-style color plates: theory, algorithm, parameters.
- **LUT Lab** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Upload 1D and 3D .cube LUTs, use built-in cinematic looks, preview before, after and split views.
- **M-Gradient Palette** — [User guide](#). Build color ramps in sRGB, linear RGB, HSL and OKLCH, tune easing and step count, inspect luminance, CIEDE2000 uniformity.
- **Material & Lighting Lab** — [User guide](#). Comprehensive user guide for the Material & Lighting Lab: spectral BRDF, pigment reflectance, illuminant configuration.
- **Material Under Light** — [Developer reference](#). A developer reference for the material-under-light simulation and the colour science behind it.
- **Neuroscience** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). LMS cone responses, DKL opponent channels, retinal ganglion DoG, LGN pathways, V1 Gabor filters, V2 texture boundaries.
- **Palette Gen** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Generate harmony, mathematical, scientific, evolutionary and random color palettes, inspect RGB, HEX, Lab, OKLCH, Delta E.
- **Palette Library** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Browse 5,000,000 deterministic scientific color palettes, search by palette id and HEX, filter by hue, chroma.
- **Perception and Vision** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). WebGL2 color vision deficiency simulation, scotopic and mesopic vision, age lens yellowing, macular degeneration.
- **Personalization Generator** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Preference color pools, tune controls, chunked generation, palettes, gradients, typography, UI pairs, posters.
- **Psychophysical Experiment Engine** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). 2AFC and yes/no paradigms, Gabor, grating, patch, blob, noise and flicker stimuli, adaptive staircases, QUEST, PEST.
- **REST API** — [Developer reference](#). The reference for the site's public REST API: API keys from the account dashboard, authentication and the /v1 endpoints.
- **Shade Gen** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Generate OKLCH shade scales from base colors, create brand-system, accessible-ui, neutral-system, material-like.
- **Shade Library** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Browse 8,192 generated OKLCH shade systems, search by method, token, HEX and name, filter by hue, chroma.
- **SVG Recolour** — [Developer reference](#). A developer reference for how SVG Recolour rewrites colours in a file.
- **The Accessibility Corpus API** — [User guide](#). How to use the accessibility corpus and contrast map from your own code: browse and page five million pairs under a filter.

- **The Gradient Library API** — [User guide](#). How to use the gradient collection from your own code: filter 8,192 generated ramps by whether they band.
- **The Harmony Library API** — [User guide](#). How to use the harmony collection from your own code.
- **The Palette Library API** — [User guide](#). How to use the palette collection from your own code: five million palettes computed from a 660-byte manifest rather than stored.
- **The Shade Library API** — [User guide](#). How to use the shade collection from your own code: 8,192 token ramps each measured for whether it runs one way.
- **Tonal Steps Tints Shades** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). HSL, luminance-equal and contrast-driven ramp engines, OKLab, CIELab, sRGB-linear and HSL mixing, tints, shades, tones.
- **Tone Mapping** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Reinhard, Hable, ACES, BT.2446, Uchimura, Log and custom tone mapping, source encoding, color spaces, white points, exposure.
- **Understanding Your Accessibility Report** — [User guide](#). A plain guide to reading an accessibility report: what the score means and why it is deliberately hard to raise.
- **URL Analyzer** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). Simple and advanced modes, audit workflow, SEO review, accessibility fixes, site scans, reports, and exports.
- **Vision Simulation** — [User guide](#) · [Developer reference](#). 78 simulations, 11 categories, Basic and Advanced modes, floating panels, linked controls, metrics, Verify, Analytics, exports.

For how to search and filter this list on the site, see [Getting started](#).

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [DOCUMENTATION](#)

Read a guide

Find your way around a documentation article: the subject list, breadcrumb, pair switch, contents, code blocks and pager.

Documentation articles share a three-column layout on wide screens: every subject on the left, the article in the middle, and its contents on the right. On narrow screens the columns stack.

The parts of the page

Part	What it does
Subject list (left)	Headed Documentation . Every subject, alphabetically; the current one is highlighted and scrolled into view. Select a subject to open its first document.
Breadcrumb	Documentation > the subject's name. Select Documentation to return to the index.
Pair switch	User guide and Developer reference . The current document is highlighted; select the other to switch. If a subject has only one document, the missing half is shown greyed out, with the tooltip "No user guide for this subject yet" or "No developer reference for this subject yet".
Title and introduction	The subject's name and a short introduction.
Author and dates	Who wrote the document and when it was published or updated, where the article states them.

Part	What it does
On this page (right)	The article's numbered sections. Select one to jump to it. On narrow screens it is a collapsible list.
Sections	The article itself.
Code blocks	Each has a Copy button. After copying it reads Copied ; if your browser blocks the clipboard it reads Press Ctrl C so you can copy by hand.
Tables	Wide tables scroll sideways rather than stretching the page.
Pager (end)	The pair — a link to the other document for this subject — and Next subject , the next subject alphabetically.

Tips

- Read the user guide first, then the developer reference when you need to know exactly what a figure means.
- Guides were written for the tool as it was on their stated date. If a guide and the tool disagree, trust the tool, and check this documentation set for the current behaviour.
- The API guides include ready-made requests; the full endpoint list is at <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/api/>.

Result

You can move from any guide to its reference, to the next subject, or back to the index without losing your place.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > DOCUMENTATION

Documentation reference

Every control and label on the documentation index and on documentation articles.

Index page (<https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/>)

Control	What it does	Values	Default
Search 54 subjects...	Shows subjects whose name or description contains the text.	Any text	Empty
Audience switch	Shows both kinds of document, or only one.	Both, Guides, References	Both
Count	Subjects and documents currently shown.	For example 54 subjects · 89 documents	—
Subject row	Name (link), description, Guide and/or Reference buttons.	—	—

Control	What it does	Values	Default
No subject matches that. Try a tool name.	Shown when nothing matches.	—	—

Address	Effect
<code>?audience=guide</code>	Opens the index showing guides only.
<code>?audience=reference</code>	Opens the index showing references only.

Article pages

Element	What it does
Documentation (side list)	All subjects; current one highlighted.
Breadcrumb	Documentation › subject.
User guide / Developer reference	Switch between the pair; a missing half is greyed out.
On this page	Section links.
Copy on code blocks	Copies the code; shows Copied or Press Ctrl C .
The pair	Link to the other document for the subject.
Next subject	Link to the next subject alphabetically.

Other addresses

Page	Address
API endpoint reference	https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/api/
URL Analyzer API guide	https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/api/analyzer/
RSS feed	https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/rss.xml

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Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes when using the documentation library.

A subject disappeared when I chose Guides or References

Why: The subject has only the other kind of document. Hiding it avoids showing a row with nothing to open.

What to do: Select **Both**.

"No subject matches that. Try a tool name."

Why: No subject name or description contains your text.

What to do: Use a shorter word, or the tool's name as it appears in the site's menus. Descriptions use US spelling ("color").

The guide does not match what I see in the tool

Why: Guides are dated. Some tools have been redesigned since their guide was written — for example the Accessibility Library and the Palette Library.

What to do: Trust the tool. Check the date on the guide, and see this documentation set for current behaviour.

The side list or the pair switch is missing

Why: The article could not load the list of subjects, for example because the connection dropped. The article itself is still complete.

What to do: Reload the page. Use the breadcrumb or your browser's back button to reach the index.

"Press Ctrl C" appears instead of "Copied"

Why: Your browser blocked clipboard access.

What to do: The code is selected for you; press **Ctrl** + **C** (on a Mac, the equivalent copy command).

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > DOCUMENTATION

Documentation FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the documentation library.

What is the difference between a user guide and a developer reference?

A user guide shows how to use a tool. A developer reference explains how it works — the methods, formulas and data behind the results.

Why do some subjects have only one document?

Some tools have only a guide so far, and some subjects (such as a measurement method behind a tool) have only a reference. The pair switch on each article shows which half exists.

Where is the API documentation?

The API guides are listed as subjects ending in "API", and the full endpoint reference is at <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/api/>. See also [Public API](#).

Can I follow new documents?

Yes, with the RSS feed at <https://auricartisan.com/library/documentation/rss.xml>.

Does the documentation library work without JavaScript?

Yes. The index is a plain list of links; search, the audience filter and the article side list are added on top.

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Documentation: other material

Supporting material for the documentation library.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Subject, user guide, developer reference and other terms.
Related	Where else to find help.
Privacy	What the documentation pages store and send.

Back to the [Documentation overview](#).

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Documentation glossary

Terms used in the documentation library.

Term	Meaning
Subject	A tool or topic in the documentation index, such as "Gamut Map".
User guide	A document that explains how to use a tool.
Developer reference	A document that explains how a tool works and what it computes.
Pair	A subject's user guide and developer reference together.
Audience	Which kind of document the index shows: Both , Guides or References .
API guide	A guide to getting a tool's results from your own code through the site's REST API.
Endpoint reference	The list of the REST API's endpoints and their parameters.
RSS	A feed format for following new documents in a news reader.

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Privacy

What the documentation pages store and send.

The documentation index and articles do not ask for any information and do not keep a history of what you read. Search and the audience filter run in your browser. The audience you choose can be part of the page address (`?audience=...`), so it appears in your browser history like any other address.

Articles download a list of subjects from auricartisan.com to build the side list and the pair switch.

Analytics on the site follow your consent choices. See [Company and legal](#).

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [DOCUMENTATION](#)

Related

Other places to find help with Auric Artisan.

- [Collections](#) — every tool, to open alongside its guide.
- [Learn](#) — the colour science behind the tools.
- [Changelog](#) — what changed in each release.
- [Public API](#) — the REST API.
- [Help](#) — the FAQ, glossary and contact options for the whole site.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > LEARN

Learn

What the Learn library is, who it is for, where to find it, and how to start reading.

Learn is Auric Artisan's library of long-form articles about colour: 113 articles that run, in the page's words, "from what light is to how a press holds a colour". The Learn page presents them as a course, in the order they were written to be read, numbered 1 to 113, with about 64 hours of reading in total. You can start at article 1 and work through, or filter by one of seven categories — Foundations, Physics, Vision, Colorimetry, Digital, Design and Print — and take the part you need.

Most articles are interactive. They include live demos (the site calls them labs) that you can open in a panel, adjust and explore — spectra you can reshape, contrast you can test, gamuts you can rotate — and end with a short quiz and a "Continue your journey" section that suggests what to read next based on the article, the course order and what you have already read.

The Learn page remembers how far you have got, in your browser. It shows a tick next to articles you have read, a progress bar, and a link to pick up where you left off.

Who it is for

- Students and self-learners who want a structured course in colour science.
- Designers and developers who want the reasoning behind contrast, colour spaces, gradients and colour management.
- Accessibility specialists who need the background to colour vision deficiency and contrast standards.
- Anyone curious about why the sky is blue or why hot things glow.

Where to find it

- The Learn page: <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/>
- From any page: the site header's **Learn** menu, **Learning Hub** ("Practical color science lessons").
- Articles live at <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/> followed by the article's name.
- An RSS feed is available at <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/rss.xml>.

No account is needed.

Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/>.
2. Read the line under the heading: how many articles there are and how long the course takes.
3. Select a category chip, such as **Vision**, or type a topic into **Search titles and topics**.
4. Select an article title to open it.
5. Use the table of contents to move around, and open a **Live demo** to try the idea for yourself.

6. Answer the quiz at the end, then choose a suggestion under **Continue your journey**.
 7. Come back to the Learn page later: it shows **Pick up where you left off** or **Next in the course**.
-

What you can do

- Read 113 articles in course order or by category, with reading times.
 - Search titles, summaries and categories.
 - Track your progress in this browser, with ticks, a progress bar and a resume link.
 - Open interactive demos in a panel that can be docked or made full screen.
 - Test yourself with a quiz at the end of each article.
 - Get personalised "Continue your journey" suggestions, pin articles to the top of them, and rotate for more.
 - Print an article, or download it as Markdown or plain text.
-

In this folder

- [docs/](#) — how to use Learn.
 - [Getting started](#) — the Learn page and finding an article.
 - [Read an article](#) — the article page, demos, quiz, print and download.
 - [Continue your journey](#) — the recommendations at the end of each article.
 - [Article catalogue](#) — all 113 articles by category, with summaries.
 - [Reference, Troubleshooting, FAQ](#).
- [others/](#) — background material.
 - [Glossary, Shortcuts, Limits and accuracy, Related, Privacy, Release notes](#).

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Learn documentation

The guides, catalogue, reference, troubleshooting and FAQ for the Learn library.

File	What it covers
getting-started.md	The Learn page: the course list, categories, search, progress and resuming.
read-an-article.md	An article page: header actions, contents, badges, live demos, the quiz, print and download.
continue-your-journey.md	How the end-of-article recommendations are chosen, pinning and More like this .
article-catalog.md	Every article, grouped by category, with number, reading time and summary.
reference.md	Every control and label on the Learn page and article pages.
troubleshooting.md	Symptoms, causes and fixes.
faq.md	Short answers.

[Back to the Learn overview.](#)

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Getting started

Use the Learn page to browse the course, filter by category, search, and pick up where you left off.

Open the Learn page

Go to <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/>, or choose **Learning Hub** from the **Learn** menu in the site header.

The page, top to bottom

The heading

Learn, with a line such as: "Every article on this site about colour, in the order it was written to be read — **113** of them, **about 64 hours** end to end, from what light is to how a press holds a colour. Start at one, or take the part you need."

Where you are

Once you have opened at least one article, a panel appears under the heading:

- **Pick up where you left off** — the article you opened most recently and did not finish; or
- **Next in the course** — the first article, in course order, that you have not read.

It shows the article's number, title, category and reading time, and a progress bar with a line such as **12 of 113 read · about 58 hours to go**.

Search and categories

- **Search titles and topics** — type one or more words. An article is shown when every word appears in its number, title, summary or category. The list updates as you type.
- Category chips — **All** and the seven categories, in the order the course introduces them: **Foundations, Physics, Vision, Colorimetry, Digital, Design, Print**. Each chip shows how many articles it holds. Select a chip to show only that category; select it again (or **All**) to show everything.

When you have narrowed the list, a line shows how much is left, for example **17 of 113 · about 11 hours**.

The course list

One row per article, in course order:

- the article's number;
- its title (select it to open the article);
- its category and reading time, for example **Vision** and **55 min**;
- a tick if you have read it;
- a one-sentence summary.

The article marked as next for you is highlighted.

If nothing matches your search, the page says **Nothing in the course matches that**, with a **Show all articles** button that clears the search and the category.

The foot of the page

A note points to the [blog](#) for shorter notes on what is being built, and the [changelog](#) for release detail.

How "read" is decided

An article counts as read once you have scrolled at least 55% of the way through it. The page remembers the furthest point you reached in each article, in this browser. See [Privacy](#).

Your first task: start the course

1. Open the Learn page.
2. Select article **1, What Color Is and How Humans See It**.
3. Read it, trying the live demos as you go.
4. Scroll to the end and answer the quiz.
5. Return to the Learn page. Article 1 now shows a tick, and **Next in the course** points to article 2.

Result: you have started the course, and the Learn page will keep your place in this browser.

For the full list of articles, see the [Article catalogue](#).

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Learn article catalogue

Every published Learn article, grouped by topic, with its number in the course, reading time, link and a one-line summary.

This catalogue lists all 113 articles in the Learn library, grouped by the seven categories the Learn page uses as filters. Within each group, articles are in course order: the number before each title is its place in the course, which is meant to be read from 1 to 113. Together they take about 64 hours to read.

Each entry gives the article number, the title (linked to the article), the reading time stated on the article, and a one-line summary taken from the article's own description. Titles keep the site's published spelling.

Categories

Category	Articles	Reading time
Foundations	15	about 8 hours
Physics	17	about 9 hours
Vision	16	about 8 hours
Colorimetry	17	about 11 hours
Digital	18	about 11 hours
Design	15	about 8 hours
Print	15	about 8 hours

Foundations

What colour is, how it has been understood, and the ideas everything else builds on.

- **1. [What Color Is and How Humans See It](#)** — 45 min. An interactive, comprehensive guide to color: the physics of light, the biology of vision, photoreceptor science, trichromatic and opponent theories.
- **2. [The History of Color Science from Newton to Hering](#)** — 40 min. A deep, interactive history of color science: Aristotle and Alhazen, Newton's prism, Goethe's protest, Young's trichromatic theory.
- **29. [Color Order Systems: Munsell, NCS, Pantone, and RAL](#)** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to color order and notation systems: Munsell hue/value/chroma, the Natural Color System (NCS), Pantone spot colors, and RAL.
- **38. [Color Naming and Categorical Perception](#)** — 30 min. Where does green become blue? Languages carve the spectrum differently, and the words we have subtly shape what we see — explained

interactively.

- **45. Additive and Subtractive Color Mixing** — 32 min. Why lights add to white and inks subtract to black: the two great models of color mixing, plus partitive optical mixing — explained interactively.
- **49. The Vocabulary of Color: Hue, Saturation, Value, Tint, Tone, and Shade** — 30 min. Hue, saturation, chroma, lightness, value, tint, tone, shade — the precise meaning of every color word, explained interactively.
- **53. Warm and Cool Colors: The Temperature of Color** — 29 min. Why oranges feel warm and blues feel cool, why warm colors come forward, and how warmth is always relative — the temperature of color, explained interactively.
- **56. The Color Solid: Visualizing All Colors in Three Dimensions** — 31 min. Color needs three numbers, so all colors form a solid. Spin the RGB cube, the HSL cylinder, the Lab solid, and see why real gamuts taper — interactively.
- **65. Black, White, and Gray: The Achromatic Colors** — 29 min. Perceptual lightness versus linear, the myth of middle gray, why black and white are relative, tinted neutrals, and using neutrals as the backbone of design.
- **74. Primary Colors and Color Wheels: Why the Models Disagree** — 30 min. Why there's no single 'true' set of primaries, how RYB, RGB, and perceptual wheels differ, and why complements and mixing disagree — interactively.
- **84. Simultaneous Contrast: Why a Color Depends on Its Neighbors** — 29 min. An interactive guide to simultaneous contrast: why an identical color looks different against different surrounds.
- **86. Optical Mixing and Pointillism: The Third Kind of Color Mixing** — 29 min. An interactive guide to optical (partitive) color mixing: how the eye blends tiny adjacent colors at a distance.
- **89. Grayscale: The Many Ways to Remove Color** — 28 min. There is no single 'grayscale' — there are many, and they disagree. Luminosity, average, lightness, channels, and gamma, explored interactively.
- **97. Color and Sound: Synesthesia, Color Organs, and the One Octave of Light** — 28 min. Color organs, disagreeing pitch-to-color schemes, and the surprising fact that all of color is a single octave of light — explored interactively.
- **108. The Stories of Famous Pigments: Color's Most Precious, Poisonous, and Peculiar** — 29 min. An interactive history of famous pigments: ochre and the first cave paintings, ultramarine pricier than gold, Tyrian purple from sea snails.

Physics

Light itself: wavelength, spectra, emission, scattering and how surfaces and materials produce colour.

- **3. The Physics of Light, Wavelength, and Spectrum** — 50 min. A deep, interactive guide to the physics of light: the electromagnetic spectrum, wavelength and frequency, photon energy, blackbody radiation.
- **4. Spectral Power Distributions and Why RGB Is Not Enough** — 50 min. A deep, interactive guide to spectral power distributions: how light is actually shaped at each wavelength, the standard illuminants (D65, D50, A, F2).
- **28. Color Temperature and White Balance** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to color temperature and white balance: the Kelvin scale and blackbody radiation.

- **33. How Colorants Work** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to how colorants work: selective absorption, pigments vs dyes, why blue and yellow paint make green.
- **40. Color in Nature** — 30 min. The physics behind the blue sky, red sunsets, rainbows, and white clouds — scattering, refraction, and atmospheric color, explained interactively.
- **48. Fluorescence, Phosphorescence, and Optical Brighteners** — 33 min. Why a highlighter glows, why your white shirt is secretly blue, and why glow-in-the-dark stars fade slowly — luminescence in color, explained interactively.
- **50. Polarization and Color** — 34 min. A deep, interactive guide to how polarization makes and reveals color: linear polarization and Malus's law, photoelastic stress colors and birefringence.
- **54. Thin-Film Interference and Iridescence** — 32 min. Why a soap bubble blooms with color and shifts as you tilt it — the wave interference behind iridescence and structural color, explained interactively.
- **62. Diffraction and Diffraction Gratings: The CD Rainbow** — 31 min. Why a CD throws a rainbow, how a grating splits white light by wavelength, the grating equation, orders, and grating vs prism — explained interactively.
- **70. Emission: Neon, LEDs, and Gas-Discharge Light** — 33 min. Emission line spectra, neon and sodium tubes, the blue-pump-plus-phosphor white LED, and why a source's spectrum decides how colors render — interactively.
- **75. Chromatic Aberration and Color Fringing** — 30 min. Why lenses split color: dispersion, longitudinal vs lateral CA, purple and green fringing, and how it's corrected — interactively.
- **80. Color at Depth: Why the Underwater World Is Blue** — 30 min. An interactive guide to color underwater: how water absorbs sunlight wavelength by wavelength, why red vanishes first and the deep sea turns blue.
- **93. The Color of Metals: Why Gold Is Gold and Silver Is a Mirror** — 28 min. Why gold is yellow and copper red while silver is neutral — an interband absorption edge in the reflectance spectrum. Explored interactively.
- **99. The Color of Gemstones: Why Ruby Is Red and Sapphire Is Blue** — 29 min. Trace impurities that absorb light, and why the same chromium ion makes ruby red but emerald green — the color of gemstones, explored interactively.
- **103. Patina, Rust, and Tarnish: How Color Changes as Metal Ages** — 28 min. An interactive guide to how metal changes color as it ages: why copper turns green, iron turns orange, and silver turns black.
- **110. The Colors of Animals: Camouflage, Warning, and Display** — 30 min. Why animals are colored the way they are — camouflage, warning colors, mimicry, and angle-shifting structural color, explored with interactive demos.
- **112. The Color of Heat: Why Hot Things Glow - Incandescence, Blackbody Radiation, and the Color of Stars** — 30 min. How Planck's law and Wien's displacement law explain why heated things glow red then white then blue — and why the Sun is white. Explored interactively.

Vision

How eyes and brains turn light into colour, including colour vision deficiency, adaptation and perception.

- **5. Human Color Vision: Cones, Opponent Signals, and the Brain** — 55 min. A deep, interactive guide to human color vision: retinal layers, phototransduction, the cone mosaic, receptive fields, ganglion cell

types, LGN pathways.

- **6. Color Blindness and Color Vision Deficiency** — 45 min. An interactive guide to the biology, testing, simulation, and design implications of color vision deficiency.
- **7. Color Constancy, Adaptation, and Why Colors Change with Context** — 45 min. An interactive deep-dive into how the brain holds object color stable across illuminants — and how it fails.
- **30. Color Illusions and the Limits of Perception** — Color is inferred, not read. Explore afterimages, contrast, assimilation, constancy, and a combined perception model interactively.
- **34. Animal and Non-Human Color Vision** — 30 min. A deep, interactive guide to animal color vision: how many photoreceptor types different species have, dichromatic mammals, tetrachromatic birds.
- **47. Vision in Dim Light: Rods, Scotopic Vision, and the Purkinje Shift** — 33 min. A deep, interactive guide to low-light color vision: rods vs cones, photopic, mesopic, and scotopic vision.
- **52. Afterimages and the Opponent Process: Why Colors Leave Ghosts** — 30 min. A deep, interactive guide to color afterimages: negative and positive afterimages, the opponent-process theory behind them.
- **57. Color Vision Across the Lifespan: Development, Aging, and the Yellowing Lens** — 30 min. Why a newborn sees little color, why the lens yellows with age, and why older eyes lose blues and need more light — color vision over a lifetime, interactively.
- **64. Tetrachromacy, Anomalous Trichromacy, and the Range of Human Color Vision** — 31 min. A deep, interactive guide to variation in human color vision: anomalous trichromacy, potential tetrachromacy.
- **71. Memory Color and Preferred Reproduction** — 30 min. An interactive guide to memory color and preferred reproduction: why we remember grass greener and skies bluer than they measure.
- **78. The Evolution of Color Vision** — 31 min. The dichromat bottleneck, the primate regain of a third cone, the fruit-finding advantage, and why color blindness is X-linked — interactively.
- **85. The Perception of Transparency: How the Eye Sees Through Things** — 30 min. An interactive guide to perceptual transparency: how the visual system decides a region is see-through, Metelli's transparency rules and scission.
- **91. Chromatic Acuity: Why You See Detail in Brightness, Not Color** — 29 min. The eye resolves fine detail in brightness but blurs color — which is why video and JPEG throw away most color data invisibly. Explored interactively.
- **96. Color in Motion: Flicker Fusion, Spinning Disks, and Benham's Colors** — 28 min. Spinning disks that fuse colors, Newton's disk to gray, and Benham's illusory colors — the color science of time, explored interactively.
- **105. Contrast Sensitivity: The Spatial Frequencies You Can and Can't See** — 29 min. An interactive guide to the contrast sensitivity function.
- **111. Light and the Body Clock: Blue Light, Melanopsin, and Circadian Color** — 30 min. How the color of light sets your body clock — melanopsin, melatonin, color temperature, and night modes, explored with interactive demos.

Colorimetry

Measuring and specifying colour: colour spaces, colour difference, illuminants and computational colour.

- **8. CIE XYZ Explained** — 50 min. The central reference of modern color science: how XYZ was built, what the matching functions mean, and why every other color space depends on it.
- **9. CIELAB and LCH Explained** — 50 min. The perceptually scaled color space at the heart of modern tolerancing, palette design, and ΔE — explained with live demos.
- **10. Chromaticity Diagrams Without the Intimidation** — 45 min. The horseshoe, the line of purples, gamut triangles, white points, CCT, and dominant wavelength — explained with live demos.
- **11. Metamerism Explained** — 45 min. How two very different spectra can produce the same color — and break apart under a different light or observer.
- **20. ΔE Metrics from CIE76 to CIEDE2000 and ΔE_{ITP}** — 55 min. Every color difference formula in active use, what they correct, where they fail, and which one to use for which job.
- **22. Oklab and Oklch: Modern Perceptual Color Spaces** — 45 min. The perceptual color space behind modern CSS — why equal steps finally look equal, how the math works, and when to reach for oklch() over HSL or CIELAB.
- **37. Gamut Mapping** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to gamut mapping: what a gamut is, in-gamut vs out-of-gamut color, clipping vs perceptual compression.
- **41. Color Appearance Models** — 35 min. The same color looks different in dim vs bright light, on a dark vs light surround. Appearance models like CIECAM predict that — here is how, interactively.
- **61. White Points and Chromatic Adaptation: von Kries, Bradford, and CAT02** — 33 min. A deep, interactive guide to white points and chromatic adaptation transforms: reference white points (D50, D65, A), the von Kries cone-scaling model.
- **72. Color Difference in Practice: Tolerances and Pass/Fail QC** — 31 min. An interactive guide to color difference in production: ΔE explained and compared, setting pass/fail tolerances, perceptibility versus acceptability.
- **76. The Standard Observer: 2° vs 10° and the Average Eye** — 31 min. The color-matching experiment, negative primaries, the 2° vs 10° observers, macular pigment, and observer metamerism — interactively.
- **81. Measuring White: Whiteness and Yellowness Indices** — 30 min. The CIE Whiteness index, ASTM Yellowness Index, why bluing makes things measure whiter, and how optical brighteners beat 100 — interactively.
- **88. Color Rendering: Why Two "White" Lights Reveal Colors Differently** — 30 min. Two lights can both look white yet render the same object completely differently. The science of color rendering and CRI, interactively.
- **92. Dominant Wavelength and Purity: Naming a Color by Its Spectrum** — 28 min. An interactive guide to dominant wavelength and excitation purity: how to describe any color as a spectral hue plus a purity.
- **100. MacAdam Ellipses: Why the Color Diagram Lies About Distance** — 29 min. Equal distances on the chromaticity diagram do not mean equal color difference. MacAdam ellipses, perceptual uniformity, and the fix — explored interactively.
- **107. Gamut Volume: How Much Color a Wide Gamut Actually Adds** — 28 min. How sRGB, P3, Adobe RGB, and Rec.2020 nest on the chromaticity diagram, how much each covers, and where the extra colors live — explored interactively.
- **113. Spectral Rendering: Why Three Numbers Aren't Enough - Computing Color the Way Light Really Works** — 31 min. The finale of the color-science library: why realistic color needs full spectra, not three RGB numbers.

Digital

Colour on screens and in files: web colour, colour management, HDR, images and measurement workflows.

- **12. RGB, sRGB, Adobe RGB, ProPhoto, Display P3, and Rec.2020** — 55 min. The seven RGB spaces that dominate digital imaging, with primaries, white points, transfer functions, and conversion matrices interactively laid bare.
- **14. Gamma, Linear Light, and Transfer Functions** — 50 min. The curves that connect file values to display luminance, why they exist, and how to use them correctly in compositing, blending, and HDR.
- **15. ICC Profiles and How Color Management Actually Works** — 50 min. What ICC profiles are, how they're structured, the four rendering intents, and why color management is the bridge between every device and every other device.
- **16. End-to-End Color Management Workflow** — 50 min. The full pipeline from sensor to destination, with the discipline that keeps color predictable at every handoff.
- **17. How to Calibrate and Profile a Display** — 45 min. From sensor on the screen to a usable ICC profile — the full procedure, the tradeoffs, and the discipline that keeps the result honest.
- **18. Spectrophotometers, Colorimeters, and Spectroradiometers** — 50 min. The three families of color measurement instruments, their geometries, their accuracy classes, and how to choose between them.
- **19. HDR, Wide Gamut, PQ, HLG, and Modern Displays** — 55 min. What HDR actually is, the curves that encode it, the formats that deliver it, and the displays that finally show it.
- **21. HSL, HSV, and HSB: The Cylindrical Color Models** — 40 min. Why designers reach for HSL and HSV instead of RGB, what separates lightness from value, the conversion math, and where the cylinder models break down.
- **27. Color Gradients and Interpolation** — An advanced, interactive guide to gradient interpolation spaces, hue paths, gamma correction, banding, dithering, and production CSS.
- **35. Bit Depth, Channels, and Alpha** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to how color is stored: bit depth and levels, why low bit depth bands, RGB channels and luminance.
- **39. Color in Film and Video** — 35 min. Why raw footage looks flat, what a LUT really is, how lift/gamma/gain grades an image, and how color flows from camera to delivery — explained interactively.
- **42. Camera Color** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to how a camera makes color: the Bayer color filter array, demosaicing, white balance gains.
- **66. Color in CSS: Modern Color in the Browser** — 30 min. `color-mix()`, relative color syntax, the `color()` function, `oklch()`, wide-gamut Display-P3, and browser gamut mapping — modern CSS color, interactively.
- **67. Color Quantization and Dithering** — 31 min. An interactive guide to color quantization and dithering: posterization and banding, choosing a palette, ordered (Bayer) dithering.
- **69. Color Grading and LUTs** — 32 min. Lift/gamma/gain, the teal-and-orange look, 3D lookup tables and trilinear interpolation, and why colorists grade in log — color grading, interactively.
- **83. Color in Real-Time 3D: Albedo, PBR, and Tone Mapping** — 32 min. Albedo vs the lit pixel, linear-light shading, energy conservation, and tone mapping HDR to a display — color in real-time 3D, interactively.

- **98. How Displays Make Color: LCD, OLED, and the Subpixel** — 28 min. Every pixel is three tiny lights. How subpixels, backlights, and self-emission make color — and why OLED blacks are truly black, explored interactively.
- **104. E-Ink and Reflective Displays: The Screen That Acts Like Paper** — 28 min. An interactive guide to e-ink and reflective displays: why they read by ambient light like paper instead of glowing.

Design

Using colour well: harmony, accessibility, data visualisation, branding and colour in context.

- **13. Accessible Color Design and WCAG Contrast** — 50 min. The contrast standards, the math behind them, the cases they get wrong, and the modern alternatives — with interactive testers.
- **24. Color Theory and Harmony** — 40 min. A deep, interactive guide to color theory and harmony: the color wheel, hue/saturation/lightness, tints, shades and tones, warm and cool color.
- **25. Color in Data Visualization** — 40 min. A deep, interactive guide to color in data visualization: sequential, diverging, and categorical scales, perceptual uniformity.
- **26. Color Psychology and the Meaning of Color** — 35 min. What colors mean, where those meanings come from, how they change across cultures, and how brands use them — explained interactively, with the myths debunked.
- **31. Dark Mode and Adaptive Color** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to dark mode and adaptive color: why dark mode is not an inversion, semantic color tokens, surface elevation.
- **36. Building a Color System** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to building a color system: tonal scales (50-950), perceptual lightness ramps.
- **43. Color in Branding and Identity** — 35 min. How brands choose a distinctive, ownable color, keep it consistent across screen and print, and survive the one-color test — explained interactively.
- **55. Semantic Color: Status, States, and Feedback in UI** — 31 min. Success, warning, error, info; hover, active, disabled, focus; and why color must never be the only signal — semantic UI color, explained interactively.
- **63. Color in Typography and Text: Readable, Accessible, Beautiful** — 30 min. Readable body-text contrast, why pure black is harsh, the risk of colored text, link cues, and legible code themes — text color, explained interactively.
- **68. Skin Tones and Inclusive Color** — 32 min. An interactive guide to skin color and inclusive design: what gives skin its tone, melanin and hemoglobin, the Fitzpatrick and Monk scales.
- **79. Color in Wayfinding and Environmental Design** — 30 min. Distinct transit palettes, color-blind confusability, sign legibility at a distance, and redundant coding — color for finding your way, interactively.
- **87. Color Trends and Forecasting: How a Color of the Year Is Chosen** — 29 min. A quarter-century of Colors of the Year, how a trend rises and fades, seasonal palette building, and runway-to-retail toning — color forecasting, interactively.
- **94. Color and Food: Why We Eat with Our Eyes** — 27 min. Why warm foods look appetizing and blue looks wrong, why blue food is rare, and how color sets flavor expectations — explored interactively.

- **102. Color in Games: Rarity, HUDs, and Playing Without Color** — 28 min. The loot-rarity ladder, HUD status colors, and how games lead colorblind accessibility — color in games, explored interactively.
 - **106. Color in Maps: Elevation Tints, Choropleths, and Shaded Relief** — 28 min. Hypsometric elevation tints, sequential vs diverging choropleths, and shaded relief — how maps use color, explored interactively.
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Print

Colour on paper and other physical media: inks, halftones, presses and proofing.

- **23. CMYK and the Four-Color Printing Process** — 45 min. Why ink mixes the opposite way to light, where the black plate comes from, how halftones fake continuous tone, and why your screen colors shrink on paper.
- **32. Substrates and Finishing** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to how the substrate and finishing shape print color: paper white, brightness and optical brighteners.
- **44. Halftones and Screening: How Print Turns Color into Dots** — 35 min. A deep, interactive guide to halftoning and screening: how continuous tone becomes dots, line screen (LPI), screen angles.
- **46. Spot Colors, Duotones, and Specialty Inks** — 33 min. When CMYK is not enough: spot inks for exact color, duotones, metallics, fluorescents, varnish, and white ink on colored stock — explained interactively.
- **51. Color Proofing: Soft Proofing and Hard Proofs** — 33 min. A deep, interactive guide to color proofing: soft proofing on a calibrated display, paper-white and black-point simulation, gamut warnings.
- **58. Lightfastness and Fade: Why Colors Fade and How to Make Them Last** — 31 min. A deep, interactive guide to lightfastness and fading: why pigments fade, the Blue Wool and ASTM lightfastness scales, what accelerates fade (UV).
- **59. Digital Printing: Inkjet, Toner, and How They Differ from Offset** — 32 min. How inkjet droplets, fused toner, offset rosettes, and dye-sub continuous tone each make color — and when digital beats offset. Explained interactively.
- **60. Color on Textiles: Dyeing, Printing, and Why Fabric Color Is Hard** — 31 min. A deep, interactive guide to color on textiles: dyeing versus pigment printing, how fiber type changes color uptake, wash, light.
- **73. Dot Gain and Tone Reproduction on Press** — 30 min. Why printed midtones darken, mechanical vs optical dot gain, the TVI curve, how paper and screen change it, and how compensation fixes it — interactively.
- **77. GCR, UCR, and Ink Limits: Managing the Black Channel** — 30 min. Gray component replacement, under color removal, black generation curves, TAC ink limits, and registration-safe black — CMYK's black channel, interactively.
- **82. Overprint, Trapping, and Registration** — 30 min. How the four plates register, what misregistration does, how trapping hides gaps, overprint vs knockout, and what inks make when they stack — interactively.
- **90. Security Printing: The Color Tricks That Stop Counterfeits** — 29 min. Color-shifting inks, UV-fluorescent features, and microprinting — the color science that separates real banknotes from fakes, explored interactively.
- **95. Screen Printing: How Posters and T-Shirts Get Their Color** — 28 min. One screen per ink, registration, underbase, and halftones — how screen printing builds color, explored interactively.

- **101. Densitometry and Press Control: How Printers Measure and Hold Color** — 28 min. Optical density, the color bar, Murray-Davies dot gain, and ink keys — how printers measure and hold color on press, explored interactively.
- **109. The Families of Printing: Relief, Intaglio, Planographic, and Screen - How Each Lays Down Color** — 29 min. The four families of printing and how each physically lays ink — explored with interactive plate cross-sections, ink-film models, and a process chooser.

Notes

- The Learn page folds three smaller categories into their neighbours: articles tagged Computational are listed under Colorimetry, and articles tagged Measurement or Workflows under Digital. This catalogue follows the Learn page.
- For how to find, read and track articles, see [Getting started](#) and [Read an article](#).

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [LEARN](#)

Continue your journey

How the recommendations at the end of each Learn article are chosen, and how to pin articles and see more suggestions.

Every Learn article ends with **Continue your journey**. Instead of a fixed list, the page suggests seven articles chosen for the one you are reading and for what you have already read in this browser.

What you see

- A line above the cards: **Tailored to** the article's category, followed by **You've read N of 113 in the library**.
- A **More like this** button, when there are more suggestions to show.
- One featured card, full width — usually the natural next article.
- Six more cards.

Each card has an illustration coloured by category, a small badge giving the reason it was chosen, the title, the category, a tick if you have read it, and a pin button.

The reason badges

Badge	Meaning
Pinned	You pinned this article.
Up next in a category	The next unread article in the same category, in course order.
Shares a topic	It shares one or more topic tags with the current article.
More in a category	It is in the same category.

Badge	Meaning
Related idea	Its title or summary shares key words with the current article.
Recommended	A good general match.

How suggestions are chosen

The page scores every other article against the one you are reading:

- same category: a strong boost;
- each shared topic tag: a boost;
- shared key words in title and summary: a small boost;
- close to it in course order within the same category: a small boost;
- not yet read: a boost; already read: a penalty (read articles can still appear);
- the next unread article in the same category: an extra boost, so it usually takes the featured slot;
- pinned by you: always first.

To keep the list varied, no more than three suggestions from one category come first; the rest follow.

Pin an article

1. Select the pin button on a card. Its label reads "Pin" and the title; its tooltip says **Pin to top**.
2. The suggestions are re-ranked, and the pinned article moves to the front with the **Pinned** badge.
3. To unpin, select the pin again (tooltip **Pinned — click to unpin**).

Pins are kept in this browser and apply on every article, so a pinned article stays at the front of the suggestions until you unpin it. These pins are separate from pins elsewhere on the site.

See more

Select **More like this** to show the next seven suggestions. Select it again to keep rotating; it wraps back to the start.

If the suggestions do not change

If the page cannot load the Learn catalogue (for example when offline), or the article is not in it, the author's original suggestions stay in place. They are still good links; they just are not personalised.

Result

You always have a sensible next step: the next article in the course, the closest related ideas, and the articles you chose to keep.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > LEARN

Read an article

Find your way around a Learn article: header actions, facts, table of contents, live demos, the quiz, printing and downloading.

Every Learn article follows the same layout. This page walks through it from top to bottom.

The header

- A small line reading **Auric Artisan · Learn** above the title.
- The title and an introductory paragraph.
- A row of facts, each with a bold label: the article's category and its number in the course (for example "Physics · 112"), how many live demos it has, the reading time (for example "~30 min"), and its subject.
- Three actions:

Action	What it does
Download	Opens a small menu: Markdown (".md — Formatted, portable text") or Plain text (".txt — Just the words"). The file is made in your browser from the article's text; interactive demos, figures and the quiz are left out.
Print	Opens your browser's print dialog.
← All Articles	Returns to the Learn page.

Downloaded files are named after the article, without the date, for example **the-color-of-heat.md**. Each starts with the title, the introduction and a "Source:" line with the article's address. Press **Escape** to close the **Download** menu.

The table of contents

A **Table of Contents** lists the article's numbered sections. Select an entry to jump to it. A reading-progress bar at the top of the window fills as you scroll.

Sections

Articles are divided into numbered sections, typically: an introduction, several teaching sections each with a live demo, **The terms, defined** (a glossary), **What it means for color** (practical takeaways), **Test your**

understanding, and **Continue your journey**. Sections fade in as you reach them.

Live demos

Each interactive lab appears in the article as a wide button labelled **Live demo**, with the demo's name and **Expand**.

1. Select the button. The demo opens in a panel over the page, marked **Live**, **Article** and **Dockable**.
2. Use the demo's own controls — sliders, buttons, colour pickers — and read the explanation beside it.
3. Use the panel buttons:

Button	What it does
Dock panel	Docks the panel to the side so you can read the article beside the demo. Select again to undock.
Full screen	Enlarges the panel to fill the window. Select again to restore.
Close	Closes the panel. Escape does the same.

Docked and full screen are exclusive: turning one on turns the other off.

Demos run entirely in your browser and do not need an account.

Test your understanding

Near the end, **Quick check** asks multiple-choice questions one at a time — six in recent articles. Choose an answer to see feedback, then select **Next** →. A counter shows your place, for example **Question 1 of 6**.

Continue your journey

The last section suggests what to read next. On articles in the catalogue, the page replaces the author's fixed suggestions with personalised ones, and a line above them says, for example, **Tailored to Physics · You've read 12 of 113 in the library**. See [Continue your journey](#).

The foot of the article

A line gives the article's place in the course, for example **Article 112 of 113**.

Keeping your place

As you scroll, the article records how far you got, in this browser. Once you pass 55% of the page, the article counts as read on the Learn page and in **Continue your journey**. Reaching the bottom is not required.

Result

You can read, explore and test yourself on any article, print it or keep a copy, and move on to a suggestion that fits what you have read.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > LEARN

Learn reference

Every control and label on the Learn page and on Learn article pages.

The Learn page (<https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/>)

Element	What it does or shows
Heading line	Number of articles and total reading time.
Pick up where you left off / Next in the course	Your most recent unfinished article, or the first unread one; with number, title, category, minutes. Shown only after you have opened an article.
Progress bar	N of 113 read · time left.
Search titles and topics	Filters as you type; every word must match the number, title, summary or category.
Category chips	All, Foundations, Physics, Vision, Colorimetry, Digital, Design, Print , each with a count. Select again to clear.
Count line	N of 113 · time, shown only when filtered.
Course row	Number, title (link), category, minutes, tick when read, summary.
Nothing in the course matches that.	No results; Show all articles clears the search and category.
Foot	Links to the blog and changelog.

If the course list cannot be built (for example, offline), the page shows a plain list of **All articles** instead.

Categories

Category	Articles	Includes
Foundations	15	—
Physics	17	—
Vision	16	—
Colorimetry	17	Articles tagged Computational
Digital	18	Articles tagged Measurement and Workflows
Design	15	—

Category	Articles	Includes
Print	15	—

Reading times

Shown in minutes per article; totals under 90 minutes are given in minutes, longer totals as "about N hours".

An article page

Element	What it does
Auric Artisan · Learn	Label above the title.
Facts row	Category and number, demos, reading time, subject.
Download › Markdown / Plain text	Saves the article text as <code>.md</code> or <code>.txt</code> .
Print	Prints the article.
← All Articles	Back to the Learn page.
Table of Contents	Jump to a section.
Reading-progress bar	Fills as you scroll.
Live demo button (Expand)	Opens the demo panel.
Demo panel	Chips Live , Article , Dockable ; Dock panel , Full screen , Close .
Quick check	Multiple-choice quiz; Question N of 6 ; Next →.
Continue your journey	Seven personalised suggestions; pin buttons; More like this .
Article N of 113	Place in the course.

Keys

Key	Where	Effect
<code>Escape</code>	Demo panel	Closes it.
<code>Escape</code>	Download menu	Closes it.
<code>Tab</code>	Anywhere	Moves between links and controls.

Addresses

Page	Address
Learn page	https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/

Page	Address
An article	https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/articles/ plus the article name
RSS feed	https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/rss.xml

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > LEARN

Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes for problems on the Learn page and in Learn articles.

The Learn page shows a plain list, with no search or categories

Why: The page could not load the Learn catalogue, so it shows the built-in list of all articles instead.

What to do: Check your connection and reload. Every link in the plain list still works.

My progress and ticks have gone

Why: Progress is kept in this browser only. It does not follow you to another browser or device, and clearing this site's data, or using a private window, removes it.

What to do: Nothing can restore it. Reading past 55% of an article marks it as read again.

An article I finished is not ticked

Why: An article counts as read when you have scrolled at least 55% of the way through it. Jumping straight to the end with the table of contents still counts; reading only the top half does not.

What to do: Scroll through the article.

"Continue your journey" is the same on every visit

Why: If the Learn catalogue cannot load, or the article is not in it, the author's original suggestions stay.

What to do: Reload with a working connection. Also note that pinned articles always come first.

A live demo will not open, or looks empty

Why: Demos need JavaScript and a modern browser. Some content blockers or very old browsers stop them.

What to do: Allow scripts for auricartisan.com and use a current browser. Try **Full screen** if the demo is cramped.

The downloaded file has no demos or pictures

Why: Download saves the article's text only. Demos, figures and the quiz are left out by design.

What to do: Use **Print** (or print to PDF) to keep the page as it looks.

Search finds nothing

Why: Every word you type must appear in an article's number, title, summary or category. Articles use US spelling in titles ("color").

What to do: Use fewer words, or try the other spelling. Select **Show all articles** to reset.

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Learn FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Learn library.

How many articles are there?

113, numbered in course order, taking about 64 hours in total. See the [Article catalogue](#).

Do I have to read them in order?

No. The order is a suggested path from basics to specialist topics. Filter by category or search for what you need.

Do I need an account?

No. Everything is free and open, and your progress is kept in your browser.

Does my progress sync between devices?

No. Progress, ticks and pins stay in the browser where you read.

Can I keep a copy of an article?

Yes. Use **Download** for Markdown or plain text, or **Print**.

Are the demos accurate?

They are teaching models built for the article, computed in your browser. They illustrate the ideas faithfully but are not measurement instruments. See [Limits and accuracy](#).

Is there a feed?

Yes: <https://auricartisan.com/library/learn/rss.xml>.

Why do titles say "color"?

Article titles keep the spelling they were published with. The site's own interface text uses British spelling.

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [LEARN](#)

Learn: other material

Supporting material for the Learn library: glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages, privacy and release notes.

File	What it covers
Glossary	Terms used on the Learn page and in article chrome.
Shortcuts	Keys on the Learn page and in articles.
Limits and accuracy	What the articles, demos and progress tracking are and are not.
Related	Libraries and tools that put the articles into practice.
Privacy	What Learn remembers in your browser.
Release notes	User-facing history.

[Back to the Learn overview.](#)

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Learn shortcuts

Keys and pointer actions on the Learn page and in Learn articles.

Keys or action	Where	Effect
Type in Search titles and topics	Learn page	Filters the course as you type.
Select a category chip again	Learn page	Clears the category.
Escape	Demo panel	Closes the panel.
Escape	Download menu	Closes the menu.
Select Dock panel / Full screen	Demo panel	Docks or enlarges the demo.
Select More like this	End of article	Shows the next seven suggestions.

Your browser's own print shortcut works on articles as well as **Print**. The site-wide shortcuts also work. See [Site features](#).

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Learn glossary

Definitions of the terms used on the Learn page and in Learn articles' page furniture.

Each article also ends with its own glossary, **The terms, defined**, for the colour-science terms it teaches. This page covers the terms of the Learn library itself.

Term	Meaning
Article number	An article's place in the course, from 1 to 113.
Category	One of seven groups used to filter the course: Foundations, Physics, Vision, Colorimetry, Digital, Design, Print.
Course order	The order the articles were written to be read in, from what light is to printing.
Continue your journey	The personalised suggestions at the end of each article.
Docked	A demo panel placed beside the article so both can be seen.
Lab, live demo	An interactive demonstration inside an article, opened with Live demo .
Pin	A mark that keeps an article at the front of Continue your journey .
Quick check	The short quiz at the end of an article.
Read	An article you have scrolled at least 55% of the way through, in this browser.
RSS	A feed format that lets a news reader show new articles automatically.

WEBSITE > LIBRARY > LEARN

Limits and accuracy

What the Learn articles, demos and progress tracking are, and what they are not.

The articles

The articles are educational explanations of colour science, perception and practice. They are not standards documents; where an article describes a standard (such as WCAG or a CIE formula), the standard itself is the authority.

Articles on vision and light — for example colour vision deficiency or light and the body clock — are written to educate, not to diagnose or advise on health. Consult a professional for medical questions.

The demos

Demos are teaching models computed in your browser. They follow the published formulas their articles describe, but:

- colours on screen depend on your display, its settings and the light around you;
- simulations of colour vision deficiency show typical cases, not any particular person's sight;
- numbers are rounded for display.

Use the site's tools for measurement work (see [Related](#)).

Reading times and categories

Reading times are the authors' estimates. Three small categories (Computational, Measurement, Workflows) are folded into Colorimetry and Digital on the Learn page.

Progress tracking

"Read" means scrolled past 55% of the page in this browser. It does not know whether you actually read the text, and it is lost if the browser's site data is cleared.

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Privacy

What the Learn library remembers in your browser and what uses the network.

What stays in your browser

What	Why	How to remove it
How far you scrolled in each article, and when	To tick read articles, show your progress and offer Pick up where you left off .	Clear this site's data.
Articles you pinned in Continue your journey	To keep them at the front of the suggestions.	Unpin them, or clear this site's data.

None of this is sent to Auric Artisan or linked to an account.

What uses the network

- Pages, images and the Learn catalogue are downloaded from auricartisan.com.
- Demos run in your browser.
- **Download** builds the file in your browser.

Advertising and analytics follow your consent choices. See [Company and legal](#).

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Release notes

User-facing history of the Learn library.

- **4 May 2026** — Article 1, "What Color Is and How Humans See It", the course's cornerstone explainer.
- **0.9.9, 5 June 2026** — the release added Learn content alongside documentation and blog content (see the [Changelog](#)).

- **May to August 2026** — articles were published in course order, one a day for much of the period, reaching 113 articles; the most recent is dated 31 August 2026.
- **The current Learn page** presents the articles as a course in reading order, with categories, search, reading times, progress ticks and a resume link, and each article ends with personalised **Continue your journey** suggestions.

[WEBSITE](#) > [LIBRARY](#) > [LEARN](#)

Related

Libraries and tools that put the Learn articles into practice.

Put the ideas to work

- [Colour libraries](#) — measured colours, palettes, gradients, harmonies, shade scales and contrast pairs.
 - [Collections](#) — every Auric Artisan tool.
 - [Documentation](#) — how to use each tool.
 - [Accessibility and vision tools](#), starting with the URL Analyzer.
 - [Colour Science Lab](#).
-

Keep up

- [Blog](#) — shorter notes on what is being built.
- [Changelog](#) — what changed in each release.